WEDNESDAY • 11 NOVEMBER 2026
16 pages in 1 section
NEW DELHI
₹15.00
VOLUME XXXIII NUMBER 177

• PUBLISHED SIMULTANEOUSLY FROM:
• AHMEDABAD • BENGALURU • BHOPAL • BHUBANESWAR
• CHANDIGARH • CHENNAI • HYDERABAD • JAIPUR • KOCHI
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Irdai forms two working groups on risk-based capital framework



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M John Harrison becomes first 'bona fide' sci-fi Booker Prize winner

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Businesses were dissatisfied with UPA 2: Sonia Gandhi in memoir



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IN BRIEF

Only 2 applications in second round of coal gasification scheme

The government's ₹37,500 crore scheme to promote coal and lignite gasification received only two applications in its second round, both from state-run NTPC, compared with seven applications in the first round. The two applications from NTPC envisage the production of urea in one project and methanol and dimethyl ether (DME) in another, the Ministry of Coal said on Tuesday. The ministry has also opened the third round of the scheme, with January 11, 2027, as the deadline for submission of applications. Industry experts said the lack of assured buyers for gasification products, difficulties in securing financing, uncertainty over coal supply, and logistical costs were among the factors affecting investment decisions, reports SAKET KUMAR 4 ▸

Blackstone to buy 16% in IIFL Finance for ₹5K cr

US-based Blackstone will invest ₹5,000 crore (about $535 million) for a nearly 16 per cent stake in Nirmal Jain-promoted IIFL Finance through a preferential issue of shares. Along with Blackstone's investment through its Singapore-based investment vehicle, Ingot SG Pte, IIFL Finance is raising ₹6,414 (about $686 million) crore in primary capital, the non-banking finance company said on Tuesday. Promoters Nirmal Jain and Venkataraman Rajamani will invest ₹1,264 crore (about $135 million) through a preferential allotment of warrants, while Anchorage Capital will participate in the transaction with a primary equity investment of ₹150 crore (about $16 million), reports AATHIRA VARIER 6 ▸

Centre doubles open market rice sales target

To augment supplies and cool down domestic prices, the Centre has doubled its open market rice sale target to 5 million tonnes from 2.5 million tonnes for the 2026-27 financial year (FY27). According to a statement issued on Tuesday, 2.5 million tonnes of rice had already been sold to private parties through e-auctions under the Open Market Sale Scheme (Domestic) till October 31, against 1.1 million tonnes during the corresponding period of the previous financial year. To further increase supplies and taper down prices, another 2.5 million tonnes is targeted to be sold in the balance five months of this financial year, reports SANJEEB MUKHERJEE 4 ▸

RESULTS RECKONER
Quarter ended Sep 30, 2026;
Common sample of 2,359 companies
(Results available for 2,813 companies)

Sales		
Sep 30, 2025	₹38.37 trn	8.7%
Sep 30, 2026	₹47.62 trn	24.1%
Reported net profit		
Sep 30, 2025	₹4.16 trn	15.0%
Sep 30, 2026	₹5.35 trn	28.7%
Adj net profit (excl. extraordinary items)		
Sep 30, 2025	₹4.10 trn	14.7%
Sep 30, 2026	₹5.28 trn	28.7%

Profit bonanza for govt OMCs in Q2 despite crude oil turmoil

Earnings hit a 13-qtr high on improved refining margins, lower excise payout

KRISHNA KANT & SHUBHANGI MATHUR
Mumbai/New Delhi, 10 November

A sharp jump in refining margins enabled state-owned oil marketing companies (OMCs) to report better-than-expected earnings in the July-September quarter of this financial year (Q2FY27), despite skyrocketing crude oil prices amid the West Asia crisis.

Higher refining margins translated into higher operating or Ebitda (earnings before interest, taxes, depreciation and amortisation) margins that more than offset losses on retail sales of transport and cooking fuel, showed a *Business Standard* analysis.

The companies also benefited from a cut in excise duty on petrol and diesel in March, the benefit of which they did not pass on to consumers. The duty cut led to a sharp year-on-year decline in their indirect tax outgo without any change in retail fuel prices, expanding OMCs' marketing margins.

Indian Oil Corporation Ltd (IOCL), Bharat Petroleum Corporation Ltd (BPCL) and Hindustan Petroleum Corporation Ltd (HPCL) reported combined net profit (adjusted for exceptional gains and losses) of ₹29,896.1 crore in the September quarter of FY27, up 66.2 per cent year-on-year from ₹17,990.4 crore in the year-ago period and the highest in the last 13-quarters.

In comparison, these companies had reported combined adjusted net loss of ₹17,652.7 crore in the April-June quarter of FY27.

These companies' gross sales revenue (including excise duty) — that reflects the retail prices of their key products such as diesel, petrol, liquefied petroleum gas (LPG) and aviation turbine fuel (ATF) — was up 28.9 per cent year-on-year to ₹5.64 trillion in Q2FY27, up from around ₹4.38 trillion in the comparable year-ago period. But quarterly gross sales were down 3.7 per cent sequentially from a record high of ₹5.86 trillion in the June quarter.

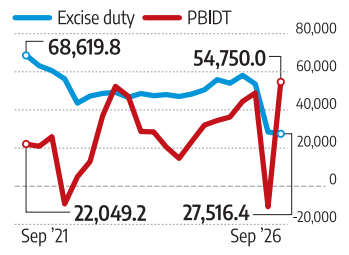
OMCs' combined net sales (gross sales net of excise duty) was at around ₹5.37 trillion in the September quarter of FY27 — up 39.9 per cent from around ₹3.84 trillion a year ago, but down 3.7 per cent from record quarterly high of ₹5.58 trillion in the Q1FY27.

The companies' combined excise duty payout nearly halved on a year-on-year basis to ₹27,516.4 crore in the quarter under review, from ₹54,018.8 crore a year ago. The combined excise duty payout by these firms was the lowest in at least 21 quarters.

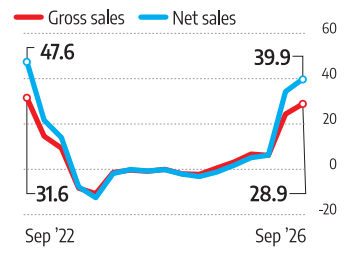
Before the duty cut in March, OMCs had on average spent around ₹52,350 crore on excise duty every quarter, between September 2021 and December 2025. Turn to Page 6 ▸



Backed by excise relief
(₹ crore)



On recovery track
% Y-o-Y chg



PBIDT: Profit before interest, depreciation, and taxes; Note: Combined consolidated figures for Indian Oil, BPCL and HPCL
Source: Capitaline, Compiled by *Business Standard* Research Bureau

Foreign investors return, signalling a longer India bet

ANJALI KUMARI & KAIRAVI LUKKA
Mumbai, 10 November

Foreign capital is flowing back into Indian financial markets, reversing a prolonged spell of weakness across equities, the rupee and government bonds. Stocks have rallied, the currency has strengthened and bond yields have eased as overseas investors return to domestic assets, including government securities through the Fully Accessible Route (FAR).

Foreign investors have reversed a 10-month selloff in Indian equities, pouring nearly ₹54,000 crore into domestic stocks in the first nine days of November. The sharp turnaround in foreign portfolio investor (FPI) flows, accompanied by a reduction in bearish derivatives positions, suggests that overseas investors are reassessing their exposure to Indian assets.

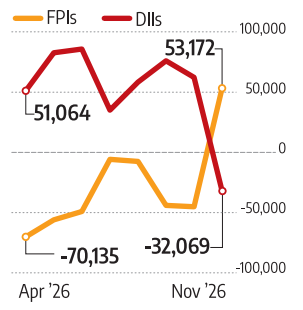
Between January and October, FPIs withdrew ₹4.48 trillion from Indian equities, weighing on the rupee and leaving the Nifty 50 down 2 per cent over the previous year. Bond yields also remained elevated as foreign investors favoured markets offering higher returns. But the direction of flows has changed sharply this month.

FPIs bought shares worth ₹53,172 crore between November 1 and 9. They had been net sellers in every month of 2026 and also FY27 so far, including withdrawals of ₹45,162 crore in October and ₹44,013 crore in September.

The reversal has extended to government debt. Foreign investors bought ₹7,480 crore of government securities under the FAR in the first nine days of November, according to Clearing Corporation of India data. This is the highest monthly inflow since July, when they purchased ₹7,581 crore, and follows two consecutive months of net selling, with outflows of ₹9,192 crore in September and ₹5,609 crore in October. Turn to Page 7 ▸

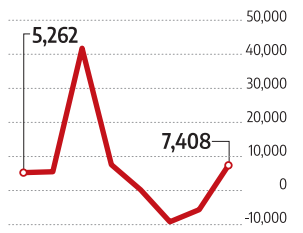
The turn of the tide

Net investment in equity (₹ crore)



Data as of November 9
Source: Exchange
Compiled by *Business Standard* Researchu Bureau

Net FPI investment in government securities via FAR (₹ crore)



Data as of November 9
FAR: Fully accessible route
Source: CCIL



Brokerages pick their likely winners for Samvat 2083 as November rally adds a festive glow to equities, report KRISHNA KANT & RAM PRASAD SAHU

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■ Wall St falls as hot inflation data fuels rate-hike jitters
■ Leading MFs' commission payout surged 12% in FY26

Unemployment rate for urban youth at 6-qtr high

HIMANSHI BHARDWAJ
New Delhi, 10 November

Unemployment among India's urban youth aged 15 to 29 rose to a six-quarter high of 18.9 per cent in the July-September quarter (Q2) of 2026-27, from 18.2 per cent in the previous quarter, according to the quarterly bulletin of the Periodic Labour Force Survey (PLFS) released by the National Statistics Office (NSO) on Tuesday.

However, combined youth unemployment (rural and urban) fell to 15.3 per cent in Q2 from 15.9 per cent in the previous quarter because the rate among rural youth declined from 14.7 per cent to 13.6 per cent during the period.

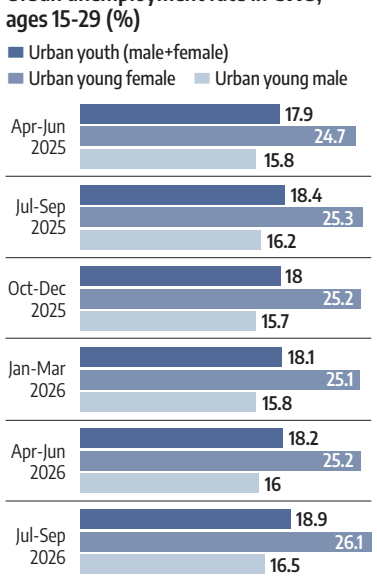
In urban India, young women recorded a higher unemployment rate than men. For young women, in terms of the current weekly status (CWS), the unemployment rate climbed to a six-quarter high of 26.1 per cent from 25.2 per cent in Q1. For young urban men, too, the rate was at a six-quarter high of 16.5 per cent in Q2, up from 16 per cent in Q1.

For the broader age group of those aged 15 and above, the unemployment rate fell to 5.1 per cent in Q2 from 5.4 per cent in the previous quarter. Rural unemployment in the same age group declined to 4.3 per cent from 4.8 per cent, while the urban rate was at a four-quarter high of 6.8 per cent.

The PLFS methodology was revamped in January 2025 to provide monthly and quarterly estimates of key labour market indicators for both rural and urban India under the CWS framework. Under the CWS approach, a person is considered unemployed if they did not work for even one hour on any day during the reference week but had sought work or were available for work for at least one hour on any day during the period.

Joblessness rate highest in Kerala
Of the 20 states for which data was provided, Kerala recorded the highest unemployment rate for people aged 15 years and above, at 8.7 per cent. Turn to Page 7 ▸

Steady increase over 4 qtrs
Urban unemployment rate in CWS, ages 15-29 (%)



CWS: Current weekly status; Source: NSO

■ Compliance relief drives 80% surge in company strike-offs P4 ▸

Govt targets ₹6K cr in FY27 from sale of MTNL's land assets

KRITY AMBEY
New Delhi, 10 November

FIVE PROPERTIES OWNED BY MTNL IN MUMBAI, VALUED AT ABOUT ₹4,000 CRORE, HAVE ALREADY RECEIVED APPROVAL FROM THE ALTERNATIVE MECHANISM

The central government is considering monetising non-core assets worth up to ₹6,000 crore owned by debt-laden Mahanagar Telephone Nigam Limited (MTNL) this financial year, in an effort to raise funds for repaying part of the state-owned telecom company's liabilities, according to two officials familiar with the matter.

It also plans to build a pipeline of MTNL assets for monetisation over the next two years, one of the officials said. Assets worth up to ₹6,000 crore have so far been identified, with the monetisation process at an advanced stage, the second official added.

Five properties owned by MTNL in Mumbai, valued at about ₹4,000 crore, have already received approval from the Alternative Mechanism (AM), a body delegated authority by the Union cabinet to clear such proposals, the official said. The National Land Monetisation Corporation (NLMC), the government's specialised asset-sale agency, will oversee the process.

Last week, the inter-ministerial group (IMG) on asset monetisation, comprising representatives from the finance ministry's Department of Public Enterprises (DPE) and the communications ministry's Department of Telecommunications (DoT), also recommended a fresh tranche of MTNL assets worth ₹1,100 crore for Cabinet approval.

Email queries sent to the finance ministry, the communications ministry and MTNL remained unanswered until the time of publication.

The proposed sales form part of the government's wider effort to manage MTNL's debt. The company's liabilities rose to about ₹40,000 crore in 2025-26 (FY26), leaving it struggling to meet its financial obligations.

MTNL has defaulted on loan repayments to several major public sector banks, including State Bank of India, Punjab National Bank, Bank of India, Indian Overseas Bank, Union Bank of India, Punjab & Sind Bank and UCO Bank. Turn to Page 7 ▸

PAGE 4

Storm clouds gather over climate finance and trade negotiations

The gloves were off even before the 31st session of the Conference of the Parties (COP31), the world's biggest UN-led climate summit, kicked off in Antalya, Türkiye, on November 9.

S DINAKAR reports

PAGE 10

Gray market gold flows swell amid calls for duty review

Gold smuggling jumped over 16-fold to 50 tonnes in July-September, accounting for 37 per cent of quarterly supply. The domestic market discount signals active illicit channels, while jewellers hope a review of the 15 per cent Customs duty will curb their appeal, report SHILPA RANGARAJAN & PRAVIN PALANDE

From runways to highways: Bus travel gathers pace amid soaring airfares

HEMLATA SAMANT
New Delhi, 10 November

India's intercity bus market is gaining momentum, as airfares climb and confirmed train tickets become harder to secure during peak travel periods. Once regarded largely as a fallback for journeys between cities, buses are emerging as a more compelling option for short- and medium-haul travel. For online travel platforms and fleet operators, the shift is opening up a significant business opportunity.

The change is being driven by more than just price. Better-quality buses, expanding sleeper services and improving highway infrastructure are making road travel more comfortable and reliable. Together, these factors are reshaping how travellers approach journeys of 200-500 kilometres.

Online travel aggregators (OTAs) and intercity bus platforms, including Ixigo's AbhiBus, MakeMyTrip, FlixBus India and EaseMyTrip, are reporting strong growth in bookings and passenger volumes. AbhiBus recorded a 31.5 per cent year-on-year increase in bookings across its leading routes during the 25-day travel window around Dussehra 2026, compared with the corresponding period in 2025.



Cost-driven? Bus travel trend
Oct '24-Mar '25 | Oct '25-Mar '26

Passengers travelling / seats sold	Gross ticketing value	Avg ticket price
118.55 mn	₹11,799 cr	₹995
147.19 mn	₹14,216 cr	₹966

Source: Redbus India Bus Track Report (May 2026)

Airfare trend across popular routes
For Sep-Nov 2026 period
Source: Easemytrip

Route	% Y-o-Y increase
Delhi-Hyderabad	68
Mumbai-Kolkata	51
Delhi-Goa	39
Mumbai-Bengaluru	37

Leisure corridors led the growth, with bookings rising about 63 per cent.

Destinations such as Goa, Dehradun, Mangaluru, Kochi, Kozhikode and Siliguri saw particularly strong demand. Pilgrimage routes, including Tirupati, Varanasi and Rishikesh, grew 43 per cent, while major metro corridors such as Bengaluru-Hyderabad and Hyderabad-Mumbai recorded 39 per cent growth.

"Bookings grew on each of these routes, and 35 of them recorded growth above 50 per cent," said Rohit Sharma, chief operating officer at AbhiBus. The company also reported sharp increases in bookings in several markets where airfares had risen steeply.

Outbound bookings grew by more than 122 per cent in Jharsuguda, 95 per cent in Dharamshala and 66 per cent in Thiruvananthapuram. Bhubaneswar and Varanasi recorded increases of more than 65 per cent and 63 per cent, respectively. Inbound bookings also rose in Kolkata, Dharamshala, Ludhiana, Mysuru and Puducherry.

EaseMyTrip, too, reported strong momentum, with passenger volumes in its intercity bus segment growing by more than 20 per cent in the recent period. "Higher airfares and limited availability of confirmed train tickets are influencing travel decisions, particularly during peak holiday and year-end periods. For journeys within approximately 200-500 kilometres, buses offer a practical alternative, allowing travellers to manage costs while retaining flexibility," said Rikant Pittie, chief executive officer and cofounder of EaseMyTrip. Turn to Page 6 ▸

QUICK READ

Adani group to invest over $120 bn in capex over five years



Adani group plans to invest more than $120 billion in capital expenditure over the next five years across its core infrastructure businesses and emerging growth platforms, its executives told *Fortune India* in an interview on Tuesday. The group, one of India's largest conglomerates, has been expanding aggressively across infrastructure and energy, with investments spanning ports, airports, power, renewables and other sectors. "Over the next five years, we plan to invest about $120 billion, over $20 billion a year across all our businesses," Pranav Adani, director at the group's flagship firm Adani Enterprises, said. REUTERS

CCI clears Advent International's ₹3.1K cr infusion in Yatharth Hospital

The Competition Commission of India has cleared a proposed ₹3,150-crore investment by US private equity firm Advent International in Yatharth Hospital & Trauma Care Services, paving the way for the investor to acquire a 24.9 per cent stake in the hospital chain. Yatharth Hospitals announced on September 17, 2026, that Advent International (Advent), a leading global private equity investor, entered into a definitive agreement to invest ₹3,150 crore in the company. The investment is likely to bring fresh funds directly into Yatharth, which plans to use the capital to expand its hospital network. Unlike a deal where an investor buys shares from existing owners, this transaction involves a primary capital infusion, with the money going to the company. Yatharth operates nine multi-specialty hospitals with around 2,800 beds. It plans to increase its capacity to over 5,000 beds over the next three years. OUR BUREAU

Dabur hints at price hikes amid inflation

FMCG major Dabur India is looking for calibrated price increases across its portfolio to offset elevated input-cost inflation while stepping up cost optimisation and improving its product mix to protect margins and sustain growth. The company is navigating an inflationary environment, with rising crude oil prices amid the West Asia conflict adding to cost pressures across the supply chain, said Dabur India CEO (India Business) Herjit Bhalla during the post-earnings investor call last week. PTI

Int'l air passenger traffic rose to 78.7 mn in FY26

India's international air passenger traffic rose a little over 6 per cent to 78.7 million even as the share of Indian carriers in the overseas traffic declined to 44.4 per cent in the year ended March 2026, according to official data. As per the Handbook on Civil Aviation Statistics for 2025-26 released by the Directorate General of Civil Aviation, a total of 2,218 aircraft were registered with the regulator as on March 31 this year. While scheduled airlines had 985 planes, the non-scheduled operators had 425 aircraft. PTI

MRF Q2 profit falls 23% to ₹417 cr



Tyre maker MRF Ltd on Tuesday posted a 22.8 per cent drop in net profit to ₹417.19 crore for the July-September quarter despite double-digit revenue growth, as higher raw material costs hit the operating performance. The Chennai-based company clocked ₹540.13 crore in consolidated net profit a year ago, according to an exchange filing. Its revenue from operations rose 17.4 per cent to ₹8,660.19 crore compared to ₹7,378.72 crore in the year-ago period, it added. "The company delivered strong double-digit sales growth in the second quarter. We were able to capitalise on sustained demand for the company's products from both OE and replacement segments," MRF said. PTI

JLR to launch its first EV in India in 2027, says country MD & CEO

Jaguar Land Rover (JLR) sees India as a key growth market and plans to introduce its first electric vehicles here in 2027, including the Range Rover Electric and Range Rover Sport Electric, as the luxury automaker looks to tap emerging opportunities in the premium EV segment, its India Managing Director and CEO Rajan Amba said. In an interview to *PTI*, Amba shared that the company will also introduce the new Jaguar GT next year, with the product launches spread across different periods. "Electric is the way forward," he said, adding that the timing was appropriate for the company to enter the Indian electric vehicle market. PTI

Smaller cities drove 55% of incremental PV sales till Oct

SOHINI DAS
Mumbai, 10 November



The market for passenger vehicles (PVs) owes a lot to smaller cities and towns, which emerged as the biggest contributors to its expansion between January and October.

Those areas accounted for more than half the incremental registrations, around 55 per cent, even as rural India recorded the fastest growth in percentage terms.

According to data from market analytics firm JATO Dynamics, non-metro urban markets added 389,401 vehicles during the 10-month period. This was more than the combined addition of 161,965 in rural markets and 155,698 in metros.

Registrations in non-metro urban markets rose 17.5 per cent year-on-year to 2.61 million units from 2.22 million in the corresponding period last year. These markets have a share of 57.3 per cent of India's total PV registrations, underlining the importance of smaller cities and towns to automobile manufacturers.

Overall PV registrations grew 18.4 per cent to 4.56 million units during January-October, as against 3.85 million a year earlier.

While rural India led growth at 27 per cent, its share in registrations stood at 16.7 per cent. Metros, meanwhile, recorded 15.1 per cent growth and accounted for 26 per cent of the market.

Ravi Bhatia, president of JATO Dynamics, said the January-October data presented a different picture from October in isolation. "Rural India is leading in growth rates, but non-metro urban India remains the biggest engine of absolute market expansion," he said.

The strong 10 month performance of smaller cities is significant against a sharp decline in October registrations. These markets recorded an 18 per cent year-on-year fall during the month, compared with declines of 8.3 per cent in metros and 9.2 per cent in rural markets.

Non-metro urban markets, however, accounted for 57.5 per cent of October registrations.

"Demand in smaller cities has remained reasonably strong this year, particularly for sport utility vehicles and higher variants. However, customers are becoming more careful about their purchases. Financing costs and monthly instalments are important considerations, especially for first-time buyers. The numbers for October may also reflect the shift in the festival calendar, so we need to look at sales in November before drawing conclusions," said a PV dealer in Indore.

Bhatia had earlier highlighted the possibility of affordability pressures affecting aspiring buyers in smaller cities, where demand may be more sensitive to rising vehicle prices, equated monthly instalments (EMIs) and ownership costs.

Unlike metros, which benefit from a greater concentration of wealth and replacement demand, smaller cities have a large base of aspirational buyers who may be more sensitive to increases in the cost of car ownership. Rural markets, on the other hand, have relatively low car penetration, providing scope for first-time purchases.

However, the strong January-October performance suggests that the decline in October cannot yet be treated as evidence of a sustained slowdown in smaller cities. Diwali taking place in November this year as against in October last year also complicates year-on-year comparisons, making the combined festival-period performance important in assessing the underlying demand trend.

For automakers, the numbers underline the importance of non-metro urban markets, which continue to generate the largest addition to PV registrations despite growing more slowly than rural India.

"Metros are relatively mature markets, where a significant part of demand comes from replacement purchases. Smaller cities still have a large pool of households buying their first car, while existing owners are also upgrading their purchases. This combination is helping these markets contribute more to sales growth," the dealer quoted above said.

The question now is whether October's weakness was largely a festival calendar distortion or an early indication of pressure on the aspirational middle-class buyer in smaller cities.

Registrations by city classification

City classification	Jan-Oct 2025	Jan-Oct 2026	Growth (in %)
Urban	2,220,099	2,609,500	17.5
Metro	1,028,332	1,184,030	15.1
Rural	600,519	762,484	27.0
Total	3,848,950	4,556,014	18.4

Source: JATO Dynamics

myTVS plans West Asia foray by April '27

SHINE JACOB
Chennai, 10 November



TVS Automobile Solutions MD G Srinivasa Raghavan said the firm expects revenue to cross ₹2,000 crore in the current financial year

Multi-brand aftermarket chain myTVS, a part of the $3 billion TVS Mobility group, will foray into the West Asian market by April 2027, with UAE-based Crescent Enterprises as its strategic partner in the region, a senior company executive told *Business Standard*.

This comes a month after TVS Automobile Solutions, the owner of the myTVS brand, announced that it had raised ₹425 crore in a Series-D funding round led by CE-Invests, the strategic investment arm of Crescent Enterprises.

"The West Asia launch should happen in the first quarter of the next financial year, by April 2027. Crescent will be our partner of choice for this expansion. Since it also has a stake in myTVS, the interests are aligned. That is what makes it a strategic partnership," said G Srinivasa Raghavan, managing director, TVS Automobile Solutions.

"West Asia and North Africa are a big focus with Crescent. We are talking to other partners from different regions. There is a lot of interest from large distributors and aftermarket players globally, who want access to our technology model," he added.

Prior to CE-Invests, myTVS had raised approximately ₹690 crore, comprising ₹203 crore from Lingotto (Exor) in 2022 and ₹487 crore from Castrol in 2023. The investment from CE-Invests will support myTVS' growth in India, and help take its technology-led model into the global market.

The firm expects its revenue to cross ₹2,000 crore during the current financial year and aims to double it over the next three years. "We are growing at 30 per cent," Raghavan said.

He said the company had transformed into a vertically integrated layer, with an ecosystem spread across vehicle servicing, collision repairs, electric vehicles, emergency assistance and home services, as it is targeting to bring together the fragmented garage market. "We have become a fully vertically integrated platform. Today, we have myTVS Service, myTVS Express, myTVS Collision Repair for insurance companies and myTVS Electric. We will soon launch myTVS Luxury. We also have myTVS Mobility for emergency assistance and home services," he added.

myTVS at present has around 1,200 centres, of which about 140 have electric vehicle capabilities and around 650 are collision repair workshops. Around 900 centres offer both collision repair and vehicle servicing. In addition, around 18,000 independent garages use its technology and parts.

"We are creating one of the largest livelihood entrepreneur ecosystems in the country. Our objective is to transform unorganised garages into organised businesses. Unlike other digital platforms that compete with the supply chain, we consciously decided that we would not compete with the supply chain but upgrade and digitalise it," Raghavan said.

India to lead CNH's global software ops

DEEPAK PATEL
New Delhi, 10 November



CNH, the global manufacturer of agricultural and construction equipment, plans to make India the leadership base for its global software operations as it consolidates technology teams spread across different regions. Its global capability centres (GCCs) will operate from India and Brazil, but its leadership will be based in India, its global chief information officer (CIO) Luis Abreu has told *Business Standard*.

The firm also plans to bring all its in-house software development under the India GCC. This will expand India's role from supporting global technology projects to building and managing technology used across CNH's five global regions.

"India is becoming the engine room of CNH's global information technology (IT). Until recently, our India Technology Centre in Gurgaon focused mainly on product engineering and R&D (research and development). With the launch of our IT GCC, India now builds and runs technology for CNH worldwide, not just for the Indian market," Abreu informed.

CNH currently has six to seven software factories across Latin America, North America, and its global IT functions. These teams often work separately. The company plans to bring them under one leadership, with common technology solutions and standards.

"The GCC will operate from India and Brazil, with the GCC leadership based in India. As we do that, roles currently based in one region can move to India. We will decide case by case, area by area, based on the skills each function needs," the CIO stated.

He also said India's share of CNH's global in-house IT team will rise from about 14 per cent to 28 per cent by 2028. Later, it could go up to 50 per cent.

CNH's global IT function has about 500 employees across India, Asia-Pacific, North America, and South America. It is also supported by 1,200-1,500 people from technology partners (third party vendors). The wider Gurgaon technology centre has around 600 people across R&D and IT, besides satellite offices.

The company plans to increase its directly employed India IT workforce from about 70 to 140 by 2028. Abreu said the expansion would come from new capabilities such as software development, data and artificial intelligence (AI), as well as roles shifted from other regions. CNH does not plan to double its global IT headcount.

> "OUR GOAL IS FOR A TEAM OF 500 TO DELIVER WHAT 700 TO 750 PEOPLE WOULD DELIVER TODAY. AI IS THERE TO GIVE OUR PEOPLE MORE POWER, NOT TO REPLACE THEM"
>
> Luis Abreu
> Global CIO, CNH

"AI is how we grow output without growing headcount at the same pace. Our goal is for a team of 500 to deliver what 700 to 750 people would deliver today. AI is there to give our people more power, not to replace them," he noted.

About 70 per cent of CNH's global IT team has been trained on AI tools such as Claude and GitHub Copilot. Only projects with clear business value and returns are taken into production, Abreu said. Autonomous AI agents in IT operations remain in controlled pilots, although around 80 per cent of infrastructure-monitoring activities have been automated.

CNH is also using AI in customer and dealer services. Its Dealer Ops tool has reduced the time taken to answer customer queries by about 90 per cent, according to Abreu. Its AI Contact Centre handles routine employee IT requests, such as password resets and access approvals. More complex problems are passed to specialists.

The company has developed other AI tools for its software teams. For example, Scaffold IQ converts business requirement documents into technical specifications, architecture diagrams, and an initial code base. "Manufacturers like CNH are turning into technology companies. Five years ago, a tractor or an excavator was mainly judged on its mechanical performance. Today our machines are connected and send operating data back from the field, and both farmers and builders use that data to run their businesses," Abreu noted.

More on business-standard.com

Adani Power fast-tracks groundwork for ₹30K crore Odisha project

HEMANT KUMAR ROUT
Bhubaneswar, 10 November

Adani Power Limited has fast-tracked preparatory work for its proposed 2,400 megawatt (Mw) ultra-supercritical thermal-power project in Odisha, with the ₹30,181 crore investment entering the environmental-clearance stage.

The proposed project, Nilanchal Ultra Super Critical Thermal Power Plant (USCTPP), to be developed as three coal-based units of 800 Mw each in Rahangol and Kandarei villages of Kataka district, is expected to strengthen India's power-generation capacity.

The plant will use ultra-supercritical technology, which operates at steam temperatures and pressures higher than conventional subcritical thermal-power plants, enabling greater efficiency in converting coal into electricity.

According to project documents, reviewed by *Business Standard*, the proposed plant will require 331.49 hectares, comprising 315.51 hectares of non-forest land and 15.984 hectares of forest land.

It is expected to consume 9.67 million tonnes of coal annually. The project site, located at 72-92 metres above sea level, is around 9 km from the Mahanadi river.

The plant is estimated to require around 42 million cubic metres (MCM) of water annually. The Mahanadi has been identified as the source, and the company has applied to the Odisha Water Resources Department for allocating the required quantity.

"The water will be drawn through an intake structure and pumping station near the river and transported to a raw water reservoir within the plant premises. The project will use a water-cooled condenser system," read the draft environment-impact assessment (EIA) report.

According to official sources, the Odisha State Pollution Control Board has issued a public-hearing notice, inviting objections, suggestions and comments from stakeholders after the EIA is conducted.

The company is undertaking additional studies, including a source-sustainability assessment for withdrawing water from the Mahanadi.

The EIA report has earmarked a substantial part of the investment for environment protection and management. A capital provision of ₹1,908 crore has been made for environmental protection while a recurring expenditure of ₹82 crore annually has been proposed for operating and maintaining environmental management.

A company executive said the preliminary groundwork for the proposed project had been done. The project has now moved into the public consultation stage, with the OSPCB scheduling the public hearing for December 18.

"We will take forward the subsequent regulatory processes based on the outcome of the public hearing and the environmental appraisal," he said.

Smartphone volumes slumped this Diwali season amid price surge

SURAJEET DAS GUPTA
New Delhi, 10 November

Despite an uptick in demand for premium smartphones between Dhanteras and Diwali this year, retailers — looking for a blockbuster festival season — found that the late surge in numbers was not enough to neutralise the sharp pre-Diwali slump in smartphone volume sales they suffered.

This resulted in an overall fall in mobile sales (volume) of 20 per cent during Diwali 2026, as higher global memory chip rates pushed up smartphone prices.

Kailash Lakhyani, chairman, All India Mobile Retailers Association (AIMRA) — which represents 250,000 mobile retailers across the country — held a meeting with members on Tuesday.

He said: "While retail value matched last year's Diwali levels, sales volumes dropped by 18-20 per cent between this season and the one last year. Pre-Diwali sales (volume) — seven days before Dhanteras — saw sales slump 40 per cent, but it was partly made up by the Dhanteras to Diwali period. This was when market footfall in mainline retail markets was notably strong."

Muted demand



- Pre Diwali period sales could not make up despite uptick in volumes of smartphones between Dhanteras and Diwali
- Online sales have fallen sharper than retail sales
- Tier-III and beyond cities show highest growth in sales
- Between 46-60 per cent mobile phones sales supported by finance schemes

The trend is endorsed by Counterpoint Research which said that there was a 20 per cent fall in mobile sales in the pre-Diwali period till October 29. There was a slight uptick post that. However, overall sales were still low.

However, Counterpoint Research Director Tarun Pathak said that in the last 10 days — between October 30 to Diwali day (November 9) — compared to the previous year's 10 days to Diwali ended October 20, there was some uptick in sales in eastern and central India primarily for premium phones but the tide was still mainly negative across the country.

Pathak said: "Most of the consumers decided to push forward their purchases. The drop was sharper online. Tier-III and smaller cities saw the fastest growth in sales. But as much as 46 per cent of the phone sales were through financing."

According to the AIMRA, the bulk of consumer purchases across the country clustered around the ₹30,000 to ₹60,000 price band where the highest volume of transactions took place.

Lakhyani said the market also saw mainline retailers openly procuring heavily-discounted ecommerce phone inventory at an average price of ₹11,500 and flooded them in their physical counters to sustain festival sales.

Distribution costs for online sales are substantially lower than those for physical retail outlets.

He also acknowledged increased pressure on small retailers. "Small retailers who relied on the sub ₹20,000 phone have been under major pressure. Walk in buyers looking for a sub ₹15,000 phone frequently walked away without buying or going in for a pre-owned phone."

But, according to his members, 60 per cent of the phones were sold through financing schemes, with a sizeable share being cash sales.

However, large format retailers and modern trade outlets posted healthy numbers.

These were bolstered by large pre-procurement of phones at lower prices, which helped them offer discounts of around 12-15 per cent, making it an attractive option for consumers.

NEW DELHI - This newspaper is published by **Nandan Singh Rawat** from Nehru House, 4, Bahadur Shah Zafar Marg, New Delhi-110002 on behalf of **Business Standard Private Limited**, edited by **Vikas Dhoot** and printed by **Neetendra Kr. Srivastava at Jagran Prakashan Limited, D-210, 211 Sector 63 Noida . (U.P) - 201301** and by **Prithwis Das** at **DB Corp Ltd at 10, JLN Marg, Malviya Nagar, Jaipur – 302015,** having **PRGI Registration No.57376.** Readers should write their feedback at feedback@bsmail.in Ph. 011-23720202, Fax :+91-11-23720201

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QUICK READ

India, US decide to jointly act against emerging drug threats

India and the US agreed to undertake coordinated action to address emerging narcotic threats during a recently concluded high-level meeting in New Delhi. The Narcotics Control Bureau (NCB) hosted the 2nd India-United States of America Drug Policy Executive Working Group Meeting on November 2-3, the federal anti-narcotics agency said in a statement on Tuesday. The Indian delegation was led by NCB Director General (DG) Anurag, while the US side was headed by Debbie Seguin, Acting Deputy Director, Office of National Drug Control Policy (ONDCP). Pursuant to the terms of reference of the India-US Drug Policy Framework, the meeting reviewed bilateral cooperation in combatting illicit drug trafficking and identified priority areas for strengthening intelligence sharing, coordinated law enforcement action, precursor control, pharmaceutical supply chain integrity, and drug demand reduction, the statement said. PTI

Eligible drought-hit farmers to get minimum ₹5K relief in Karnataka

Karnataka Deputy Chief Minister G Parameshwara on Tuesday said every eligible drought-affected farmer in the state would receive a minimum assistance of ₹5,000, clarifying that those who received ₹2,000 or ₹2,500 as the first instalment would be paid the remaining amount in subsequent instalments. Addressing concerns over some farmers receiving ₹2,000 instead of the expected ₹2,500 under the first instalment of drought relief, he said the amount paid so far was not the final assistance. Several farmers who had received a lesser amount in the first instalment had raised concerns, while the opposition BJP had also targeted the Congress government on the issue. Parameshwara said the state government, through an order dated October 23, had authorised the release of ₹2,500 per eligible farmer as the first instalment of the input subsidy. PTI

Social activist Sanjit Bunker Roy dies

Renowned social activist and Barefoot College founder Sanjit Bunker Roy, who turned a small Rajasthan village into an internationally recognised centre for rural development and women's empowerment, died at his home in Tilonia in Rajasthan's Ajmer on Tuesday morning. He was 81. Roy, who spent more than five decades working to make rural communities self-reliant, breathed his last at 6.15 am in the presence of his wife, noted social activist Aruna Roy, and others close to him. His death was announced by the Social Work and Research Centre (SWRC), popularly known as Barefoot College, which he founded in 1972. PTI

Goyal: On track to achieve $1 trn exports target

India is well on track to achieve the $1 trillion exports target for the current financial year, Commerce and Industry Minister Piyush Goyal said on Tuesday. He said that during April-September 2026-27, the country's exports of goods and services have already reached $480 billion. "So, 48 per cent we have achieved...we are well on track to achieve the target....the target is sacrosanct...we have to achieve that," he said at the curtain-raiser event on Bharat Mobility Global Expo 2027. He also suggested that the automobile industry focus on global markets and boost exports besides the domestic market. PTI

As Delhi gasps for clean air, Parl panel skips hearing on air pollution

As Delhi struggles with polluted air, a Parliamentary committee has decided to drop the key issue of air pollution in NCR from the agenda of its November 17 meeting, prompting a Congress member to raise strong objections with the panel chairperson. The Parliamentary Committee on Home Affairs had earlier decided to hear the views of the Ministry of Home Affairs and agencies concerned on the issue and hold a discussion. The panel circulated the agenda for the meeting, which included the air pollution issue, among its members on November 5, but dropped the topic from its revised agenda. Congress member Ajay Maken has raised strong objections to the omission of the air pollution issue. PTI

Only 2 applications in 2nd round of coal gasification scheme

SAKET KUMAR
New Delhi, 10 November

The government's ₹37,500 crore scheme to promote coal and lignite gasification received only two applications in its second round, both from state-run NTPC, compared with seven applications in the first round. The two applications from NTPC envisage the production of urea in one project and methanol and dimethyl ether (DME) in another, the Ministry of Coal said on Tuesday.

The ministry has also opened the third round of the scheme, with January 11, 2027, as the deadline for submission of applications.

Industry experts said the lack of assured buyers for gasification products, difficulties in securing financing, uncertainty over coal supply, and logistical costs were among the factors affecting investment decisions.

High capital expenditure (capex) involved in setting up these projects makes assured demand for their products essential for commercial viability, according to Amrit Lal Meena, chairman of the Gasification Technology and Research Council (GTRC), an industry body.

"Coal gasification projects require substantial investment. Capital grants help, but long-term offtake arrangements for syngas and downstream products are critical, particularly for producers selling in the open market," Meena told *Business Standard*, adding that lower international gas and chemical prices could weaken their competitiveness.

He also said that public sector companies could provide offtake assurances for products manufactured through coal gasification. "Public sector energy, fertiliser and chemical companies could anchor demand through long-term purchase agreements. The ethanol programme illustrates how blending targets, supported by oil marketing companies' procurement, can create a predictable market," Meena said.

According to Atanu Mukherjee, chief executive officer (CEO) of Dastur Energy that provides consultancy for coal gasification projects, NTPC's continued participation is encouraging but financial incentives need to be complemented with other schemes for creating commercially viable and bankable gasification projects. He proposed a government-supported partial credit guarantee mechanism to share a defined portion of lenders' risks. "Such a framework could improve access to debt, lower financing costs, and encourage greater private investment," Mukerjee said.

Meena said that coal gasification projects should be included in the harmonised list of infrastructure. "Explicit inclusion in the Department of Economic Affairs' Harmonised Master List of Infrastructure Sub-sectors could improve access to suitable financing," he said.

Logistical costs and dependence on imported plant machinery and technology, particularly from China, are other concerns. "Efficient coal and product logistics, alongside clear procedures for overseas technology and equipment sourcing, including from China, and support for indigenous technologies, would further strengthen project viability," Meena said.

The first round of the scheme had attracted seven applications from five companies: NTPC, Adani Enterprises, Talcher Fertilisers, Gallantt Ispat, and Shyam Sel & Power. Adani Enterprises had submitted three project applications, all targeting urea production, while Talcher Fertilisers proposed another urea project. NTPC had applied for a synthetic natural gas project, Gallantt Ispat for direct reduced iron (DRI) and syngas, and Shyam Sel & Power for syngas production.

The scheme was approved by the Union Cabinet in May 2026 with a financial outlay of ₹37,500 crore. It aims to support the development of 75 million tonnes (mt) of coal gasification capacity by 2030, contributing to the country's broader target of achieving 100 mt of such capacity by the same year.



Nuts and bolts

The two applications by NTPC:

- Project 1: Focus on production of urea
- Project 2: Production of Methanol and dimethyl ether

Third round of the scheme opened

Deadline for submitting applications: January 11, 2027

Factors affecting investment decision according to industry experts:

- Lack of assured buyers for gasification products
- Difficulty in securing financing
- Uncertainty over coal supply and logistical costs

Govt doubles open mkt rice sale target to ease supplies

SANJEEB MUKHERJEE
New Delhi, 10 November

To augment supplies and cool down domestic prices, the Centre has doubled its open market rice sale target to 5 million tonnes from 2.5 million tonnes for the 2026-27 financial year (FY27).

According to a statement issued on Tuesday, 2.5 million tonnes of rice had already been sold to private parties through e-auctions under the Open Market Sale Scheme (Domestic) from April till October 31 , against 1.1 million tonnes during the corresponding period of the previous financial year.

To further increase supplies and taper down prices, another 2.5 million tonnes is targeted to be sold in the balance five months of this financial year.

Sources said the decision to supplement rice supplies from the government's own inventories comes at a time when rice prices in the retail markets have been rising due to expectations of a production shortage particularly in the southern states due to low rainfall.

"In the southern states of Karnataka, Andhra Pradesh, Telangana, Tamil Nadu, and Kerala, rice production is estimated to be around 30 per cent down due to drought and low rains, while overall India production is expected to be around 10 per cent less than last year," a senior industry official said.

He said the shortage is particularly severe in premium rice varieties such as *ponni*, *sona masuri,* etc., which are grown majorly in northern Karnataka and farmers are moving away from growing high-yielding varieties than fine rice.

India's rice stocks in the Central pool as on October 1, 2026, were around 38 million tonnes against a buffer stocking norm of 10.25 million tonnes (almost 280 percent more). The central government could dip into this to cool down rice prices in the retail markets.

Meanwhile, on November 6, the government had made it mandatory for all traders, wholesalers, retailers, large chain retailers and processors or millers across the country to disclose their rice and paddy stocks every Friday on the Food Stock Portal.

The directive requires all entities to declare stocks under six categories: basmati rice, non-basmati premium rice, non-basmati rice, parboiled rice, broken rice, and paddy.

Entities failing to register on the portal or violating prescribed stock limits will face punitive action under sections 6 and 7 of the Essential Commodities Act, 1955, the statement said.

In another measure aimed at improving availability, particularly in southern states, the Centre has permitted Andhra Pradesh, Karnataka, Kerala, Tamil Nadu and Telangana to impose stock limits on rice and paddy wherever necessary.

The stock limits will remain in force until January 31, 2027, with the Centre and state governments jointly monitoring their implementation to prevent hoarding and black marketing.

The government has also decided to allocate additional quantities of Bharat Rice to three agencies — the National Agricultural Cooperative Marketing Federation of India (NAFED), the National Cooperative Consumers' Federation of India (NCCF) and Kendriya Bhandar.



PHDCCI seeks zero duty on LNG, naphtha in Budget

The PHD Chamber of Commerce and Industry (PHDCCI) has proposed eliminating basic Customs duty on liquefied natural gas (LNG), naphtha and certain heavy petroleum feedstocks, while seeking lower duties on petroleum coke used in aluminium manufacturing, as part of its pre-Budget recommendations for 2027-28.

The industry body has also called for the continuation of the existing Customs duty framework on steel scrap beyond March 2028, arguing that competitive access to critical industrial inputs is essential to lowering manufacturing costs and improving India's global competitiveness. The suggestions were submitted during a pre-Budget meeting with officials of Tax Research Unit under the Department of Revenue, Ministry of Finance, on Tuesday. OUR BUREAU

Compliance relief drives 80% surge in company strike-offs

SHUBHAM KUMAR
New Delhi, 10 November

More than 21,800 companies were struck off the government's register between April and October of FY27, nearly 80 per cent more than the same period in FY26, according to data from the Ministry of Corporate Affairs (MCA).

This is because a government scheme offering steep concessions on pending compliance fees and closure charges encouraged thousands of inactive businesses to exit formally. The seven-month figure is already higher than the total number of companies struck off in each of the previous three full financial years: 16,464 in FY24, 15,837 in FY25 and about 16,850 in FY26.

The surge coincides with the MCA's Companies Compliance Facilitation Scheme (CCFS), which ran from April 15 to September 15.

The scheme allowed companies to clear pending filings by paying only 10 per cent of accumulated additional fees. It also reduced the fee for applying for closure to 25 per cent of the normal charge, lowering the cost of exiting the corporate register. By July 13, about 92,859 companies had availed of the scheme, and 11,829 had applied to be struck off, the ministry told the Lok Sabha earlier this year.

Queries sent to the MCA remained unanswered until going to press. Rishi Agrawal, chief executive officer (CEO) and cofounder of TeamLease RegTech said the concessions encouraged companies that had remained inactive for years to seek closure.

Applications filed during the initial months of the scheme were reflected in the August and September figures because companies are counted as struck off only after the Registrar publishes a notice and allows 30 days for objections, he said. Strike-off numbers remained near 1,700 a month in April and May and bumped up to 3,797 in August and 4,933 in September.

Even after the scheme closed, 4,351 companies were struck off in October, according to data released by the ministry.

Companies seeking voluntary closure must first clear pending financial statements and annual returns up to the end of the financial year in which they ceased operations.

"Late fees are ₹100 a day per form, with no upper cap; so a few years of neglect added up to a scary number. Many founders just let the company sit there," Agrawal said.

Jigar Shah, a practising company secretary, said the number of companies approaching him for closure had increased manifold this year. Most were small private companies and startups.

The cost of maintaining a firm extended beyond filing fees, with several businesses having accumulated years of pending annual filings, auditor appointments and other statutory defaults, Shah added.

More than 660,000 companies, or over a third of those required to do so, did not file their financial statements for 2024-25. It is up from 22.9 per cent in 2020-21, the ministry informed the Lok Sabha.

COP31's first forecast: Storm clouds gather over climate finance and trade negotiations

S DINAKAR
Antalya (Türkiye), 10 November

The gloves were off even before the 31st session of the Conference of the Parties (COP31), the world's biggest United Nations (UN)-led climate summit, kicked off in Antalya, Türkiye, on November 9. Nearly 100,000 delegates are expected to descend on the resort town over the next 10 days. Set on Türkiye's Mediterranean coast in the country's southwest, Antalya is a Soviet-era-style town dotted with dull grey apartment blocks and flanked by the towering Taurus Mountains.

The rancour between the Umbrella Group of developed nations, which includes Australia, Canada, and the UK, the European Union (EU), and the Group of 77, and China, a coalition of developing countries, over climate finance and the COP agenda spilt over into Monday, delaying the inauguration ceremony by more than an hour.

The EU opposed including a climate finance work programme and trade on the agenda, three officials involved in the talks said. Trade has become a sore point, a senior Sri Lankan official said, adding that substantive negotiations could not take place on the opening day because the agenda remained incomplete.

"There was a huge battle and a push from the EU and the Umbrella Group, who were resisting the adoption of an agenda with the Work Programme on Climate Finance," said Meenakshi Raman, head of programmes at the Malaysia-based nonprofit Third World Network. "Since this is an implementation COP, it's time to sit at the table in good faith and negotiate what developed countries can or cannot provide, and explain why they are unable to ensure the provision of climate finance."

While disagreements between the developed and developing worlds are common at COPs, the backdrop to this year's summit has been shaped by the nine-month-old West Asian war, which sent fossil fuel prices surging; the rise of power- and water-hungry data centres; and protests against Western governments, as ongoing conflicts have weakened Europe politically and fiscally, officials at the event said.

An EU official, citing the latest Organisation for Economic Co-operation and Development report, told *Business Standard* that the bloc provided a third of the $136.7 billion in public climate finance extended to developing countries last year, exceeding the initial target of $100 billion a year agreed in 2009 at COP15. Last year, COP parties set a new collective quantified goal of $300 billion annually by 2035, with a broader group of contributors expected to begin contributing this year.

The World Meteorological Organization's (WMO's) State of the Climate Update 2026 shows that each of the past 12 years has been among the warmest on record, with the past four ranking as the warmest, WMO Secretary-General Celeste Saulo said at the summit.

"No single COP is a silver bullet that can stop climate change overnight," said UN Climate Change Executive Secretary Simon Stiell, seeking to manage expectations from the summit.

Host Türkiye is focusing on the voluntary Action Agenda target of achieving 35 per cent electrification globally (of the total energy mix) by 2035, said Ed King, an international climate expert.

COP31 President Murat Kurum called for the summit to become an "implementation COP", focused on meeting the annual climate finance target of $300 billion by 2035.

Ali Mohamed, Kenya's climate change envoy and head of delegation, said Africa supported the 35-by-35 electrification pledge, provided investments and technology were forthcoming. Most investments, however, were flowing to Europe and the US, he said.

India keeps its cards close

India, the world's fastest-growing major economy and the third-largest emitter of greenhouse gases, has kept a low profile at the event. While most countries, big and small, including Bangladesh, Nepal and Togo among others, have set up national pavilions, India decided against having one, an official at the event said. China, by contrast, has once again brought one of the largest delegations and set up a sprawling pavilion, showcasing its clean energy technologies and entertaining visitors with a dancing robot.

Prime Minister Narendra Modi will not attend the Antalya Leaders' Summit for heads of state on Wednesday. Türkiye had claimed that more than 100 leaders would attend COP31 but has so far disclosed the attendance of only Brazilian President Luiz Inácio Lula da Silva. Environment, Forest and Climate Change Minister Bhupender Yadav is expected to arrive on Monday and will stay on to chair a panel on climate mitigation, the official said.

India's attempts to secure climate finance commitments from developed countries, or so-called historical polluters, on the basis of "climate equity" have repeatedly been stymied by the Umbrella Group and the EU at recent COPs, the official said.

The EU has adopted a hawkish stance, threatening to derail COP31 even before it began, two African officials said.

Oil dependence is bad for climate: UN chief

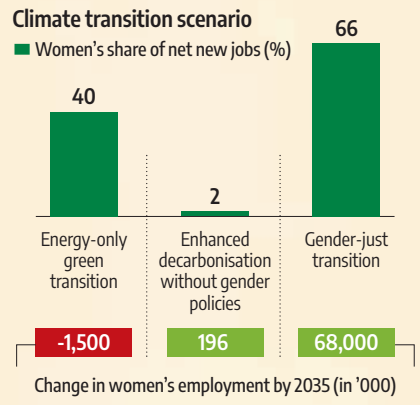
United Nations Secretary-General Antonio Guterres, at the COP31 climate conference, took aim at oil companies making billions of dollars in profits while families, businesses and governments suffer . "Fossil fuels are not only driving the climate crisis. Dependence on them carries a steep economic and security price as the crisis in the Middle East has laid bare," he said. REUTERS

UN: Climate crisis may push 141 mn more women into extreme poverty

Climate change could push up to 141 million additional women and girls into extreme poverty by 2050 under a worst-case scenario, while a 1 degree Celsius rise in average temperatures is associated with women losing 34 per cent more of their total income than men, according to a UN Women fact sheet.

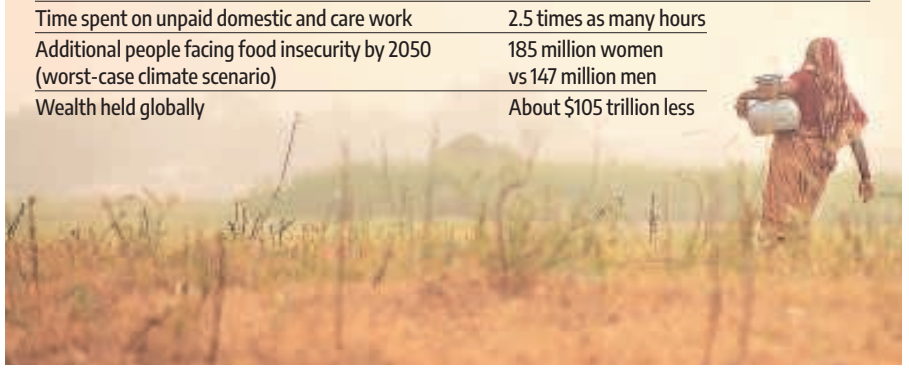
The report titled '*Gender Equality in the Age of Climate Crisis*' said at least 1.5 billion women and girls already live in climate hotspots, where high exposure to extreme weather events intersects with precarious livelihoods and deep gender inequalities.

The report said climate change was also expected to widen the gender gap in food insecurity, potentially affecting an additional 185 million women and girls by 2050, compared with 147 million men and boys, under a worst-case scenario. AUHONA MUKHERJEE



Women and girls bear a heavier economic and care burden

Indicator	Compared to men and boys
Income lost per 1°C rise in average temperature	34% more
Time spent on unpaid domestic and care work	2.5 times as many hours
Additional people facing food insecurity by 2050 (worst-case climate scenario)	185 million women vs 147 million men
Wealth held globally	About $105 trillion less



PhysicsWallah to deploy up to ₹200 cr for acquisitions this yr

Q&A Education technology (edtech) company PhysicsWallah is looking to acquire two to three firms in the current financial year of 2026-27 (FY27) as it seeks to expand its online business into new categories and strengthen its capabilities in artificial intelligence (AI), said **Prateek Maheshwari**, its cofounder. In a video interview with **Udisha Srivastav**, Maheshwari also spoke about the company's acquisition pipeline, its plans to expand in South India, investments in AI and technology, and the performance of its newer examination and skilling categories. Edited excerpts:

PhysicsWallah's online business has reported strong growth, while the offline segment grew by just around 9 per cent. What is holding back the growth of the offline business?

■ The 9 per cent figure is a blended number. If you break it down, the Vidyapeeth growth is still very promising at 15-20 per cent. However, our offline businesses Xylem and Utkarsh have degrown, bringing the overall growth rate down to around 9 per cent.

The primary reason for the decline is the shrinking examination market — largely driven by paper leaks and poorly managed exams — and a cyclical lull in government notifications. The latter typically occur once every three years, as was the case this year. In contrast, our online business has shown robust growth, expanding by 29.3 per cent in the first half (H1) of FY27.

What is PhysicsWallah's annual investment in technology, particularly in AI, Cloud infrastructure, and product development?

■ We have a robust team of 500 people across technology, engineering, and product. We spend close to ₹250 crore annually on Cloud, AI, and humanpower. There has been a slight increase in overall AI costs. We are also investing in developing new products, which have to go through a beta phase and involve training and people costs. Our AI costs have increased by a few



million dollars, partly because AI-led doubt-resolution has taken over some of the work previously done by humans.

What kind of companies are you looking to acquire?

■ We are looking at expanding our online business into categories and capabilities

> "WITH OUR CURRENT PRODUCT ENHANCEMENTS, STRUCTURED, HIGH-QUALITY LEARNING WILL BECOME ACCESSIBLE TO STUDENTS IN THE SOUTHERN PART OF THE COUNTRY AS WELL"
>
> Prateek Maheshwari
> Cofounder, Physics Wallah

that we currently do not have within the company. This is essentially a categorical expansion of our online business.

We are in advanced discussions with the promoters of a few online companies. There is also an AI-first product that could fit into our overall strategy. These acquisitions would add a new dimension to our growth. The objective is to expand our capabilities in areas where we currently do not have a presence.

How much capital are you planning to deploy for these acquisitions, and how many companies are you looking at?

■ The total capital deployment this year will be up to ₹200 crore. We had also earmarked ₹300 crore from our IPO (initial public offering) proceeds for unidentified mergers and acquisitions, as mentioned in our prospectus. We are looking at deploying capital across two to three companies.

PhysicsWallah has established a strong presence in the Hindi-speaking market. What are the challenges in penetrating deeper into South India?

■ One challenge is that the online learning ecosystem is not sufficiently developed in the region. Students in southern states have traditionally been more inclined towards offline learning. We, therefore, need to build brand awareness and establish the habit of online tutoring.

It was a chicken-and-egg problem. There were not enough good teachers and quality content available online, which meant there were fewer students adopting online learning. With our current product enhancements, structured, high-quality learning will become accessible to students in the southern part of the country as well.

Will you adopt a different pricing strategy for South India compared with the northern markets?

■ We will maintain uniform pricing across the country. However, our earlier observations suggest that the average spending by students in southern states is higher than that of students in northern states, primarily because of differences in per capita income. While the pricing will remain the same, we anticipate that the adoption of higher-priced products will be greater in South India.

More on business-standard.com

Amazon's new shopping list for sellers: AI agents, lower fees, small towns

PEERZADA ABRAR
Bengaluru, 10 November

Amazon says the next step for its 2 million sellers in India will be artificial intelligence (AI) agents that identify business opportunities and act on sellers' behalf, as its new seller-services leadership seeks to make the marketplace a long-term growth partner for small businesses.

"The next shift is agentic AI," Abhijit Kamra, director, emerging markets: seller experience and smart commerce, Amazon, told *Business Standard*. Sellers will have the final say on decisions that matter, he said.

The plan comes as smaller towns drive Amazon's festival sale. More than 70 per cent of businesses participating in this year's Amazon Great Indian Festival (AGIF) came from Tier-II and Tier-III cities, the company said. Amazon said it wants to move "from being a marketplace where businesses sell to becoming a long-term partner". Its priorities include making selling simpler and more lucrative, offering predictable costs and helping sellers build brands.

"We believe that when our sellers succeed, we succeed," said Sachin Kaushik, vice-president, selling partner services, Amazon India.

Amazon aims to bring the benefits of AI to 15 million small businesses by 2030. Interactions with its Selling Partner AI, available round the clock in English and Hinglish, have grown 7.5x year-on-year (Y-o-Y). More than 200,000 sellers use AI-powered



AMAZON AIMS TO BRING THE BENEFITS OF AI TO 15 MILLION SMALL BUSINESSES BY 2030, THE COMPANY SAID

listing tools, which can reduce routine listing time by up to 70 per cent, the company said.

Datum Intelligence projects that online festival sales will grow by up to 29 per cent this year, reaching as much as ₹1.55 trillion ($17.6 billion), compared with ₹1.2 trillion in 2025.

Boston Consulting Group expects India's ecommerce market to grow from $120-140 billion currently to $280-300 billion by 2030, while the number of online shoppers is projected to rise from 300 million in 2025 to 440 million.

Amazon said shopping volumes during AGIF rose by more than 50 per cent Y-o-Y. In the first week, seller sales grew 3.5x compared with business as usual, while new sellers recorded over 2.5x growth in units sold. Participation by small and medium businesses (SMBs) rose nearly 30 per cent Y-o-Y to a record. The number of SMBs crossing ₹10 lakh in sales grew over 4.6x. New sellers crossing ₹1 lakh in sales grew 2.4x, while those crossing ₹10 lakh grew more than 4x.

Over 50 per cent of Amazon's sellers are based outside metropolitan cities. Its Karigar and Saheli programmes have impacted over 1.8 million artisans and weavers and over 1.8 million women entrepreneurs, respectively. Local shops on Amazon covers more than 350,000 neighbourhood businesses. New partners this year include the Army Women's Welfare Association, Maharashtra's Mahila Arthik Vikas Mahamandal, and National Cooperative Organics.

During AGIF's first week, select women entrepreneurs under Saheli recorded a tenfold spike in sales, while Karigar sellers recorded growth of more than 1.5x compared with business as usual.

"We're also seeing inspiring stories from women entrepreneurs in Churu and Bhopal to artisans in Jodhpur and Saharanpur, who are reaching customers beyond their local markets," said Aruna Daryanani, director, selling partner services, Amazon India.

This year, Amazon expanded zero referral fees to more than 125 million products priced below ₹1,000 and lowered Easy Ship fees.

"By continuing to reduce selling costs and simplify processes, we are helping businesses list more selections, offer sharp and attractive prices and reinvest in their businesses," said Vikram Deshpande, director, product management, Amazon India.

Qantas to axe 850 jobs in offshoring deal with Accenture

REUTERS
10 November

Australian airline Qantas said on Tuesday that it would cut 850 jobs in the country and outsource some corporate functions to consulting firm Accenture as it adapts to the increased use of artificial intelligence (AI) in the airline industry.

In an email to staff, Qantas CEO Vanessa Hudson said the jobs would be cut "over the coming years", with the first round to happen by mid-2027. "I know this is hard news for some, and I'm sorry for the uncertainty it brings," Hudson said. The job cuts affect around 3 per cent of Qantas' Australian workforce of 28,000.

The first phase of the cuts would affect finance, procurement, human resources and marketing staff. Some roles would be shifted to Accenture and performed by teams that would be "mostly" based in India.

The airline, Australia's flag carrier, said the move was in response to rapid changes in the industry due to AI, and the Accenture partnership would help it overhaul its legacy systems and simplify some corporate functions.

"Through a partner we can access the data and AI skills that every industry in the world is competing for, because we cannot hire at the pace this work needs," Hudson said.



quick scroll @BS

India not a refuge but 'compelling' AI opportunity: Anand Mahindra

Mahindra group Chairman Anand Mahindra (*pictured*) on Tuesday said India is not just a refuge from the AI hype but rather has "a compelling AI opportunity of its own". In a post on X, Mahindra cited the nation's software talent, systems integration expertise and enormous domestic market for AI use cases, to make his point: "surely India has a promising hand to play?" "Perhaps India isn't just a refuge from the AI hype. It may have a compelling AI opportunity of its own," he wrote. And if so, he argued, the renewed interest in Indian equities "may have more staying power than we think". In his post, Mahindra said he had earlier flagged the irony of India returning to favour with global investors partly because it was seen as being outside the supposedly



overheated AI trade. "But perhaps there's another way to look at it," he said. Mahindra acknowledged that India does not make the most advanced chips or lead the race in foundational large language models. Drawing on James Carville's famous line "It's the economy, stupid!", he said the AI version should be "It's the ecosystem, stupid!". The real explosion of applications, domain expertise and enterprise-wide deployment may still lie ahead, he said. PTI

Cognizant commits over 25,000 professionals to Claude delivery

Cognizant on Tuesday announced the formation of the Claude Frontier Capability Group, with over 25,000 professionals committed to delivering Claude for clients. The group is focused on execution, transformation and client success, with the scale to take AI from pilot to production across enterprises' core operations, said the firm in a press statement. It is also introducing a managed services model for Claude. Under the model, Cognizant manages the operation of Claude-powered systems in production on clients' behalf, so they can focus on the business results it makes possible. Both initiatives draw on Cognizant's Frontier workforce model, through which it is developing Frontier Certified Engineers and Frontier Business Operators credentialed directly by frontier-model firms. Enterprises have access to frontier AI capability but continue to face challenges in delivering value to the business. OUR BUREAU

ROSSELL INDIA LIMITED

Regd. Office: Jindal Towers, Block 'B', 4th Floor, 21/1A/3, Darga Road, Kolkata-700 017
CIN: L01132WB1994PLC063513; E-mail: corporate@rosselltea.com; www.rossellindia.com

EXTRACT OF UNAUDITED FINANCIAL RESULTS FOR THE QUARTER AND HALF YEAR ENDED 30TH SEPTEMBER, 2026 *(Rs. in lakhs)*

Sl No.	Particulars	Quarter Ended			Half Year Ended		Year Ended
		30.09.2026	30.06.2026	30.09.2025	30.09.2026	30.09.2025	31.03.2026
		(Unaudited)	(Unaudited)	(Unaudited)	(Unaudited)	(Unaudited)	(Audited)
1.	Total Revenue from Operations	9,157	3,678	8,085	12,835	12,442	22,620
2.	Net Profit/(Loss) for the period (before Tax, Exceptional and/or Extraordinary items)	3,499	536	3,031	4,035	3,917	1,774
3.	Net Profit/(Loss) for the period before tax (after Exceptional and/or Extraordinary items)	3,499	536	3,031	4,035	3,917	1,750
4.	Net Profit/ (Loss) for the period after tax (after Exceptional and/or Extraordinary items)	2,728	381	2,736	3,109	3,537	1,586
5.	Total Comprehensive Income for the period [Comprising Profit/ (Loss) for the period (after tax) and Other Comprehensive Income (after tax)]	2,705	358	2,719	3,063	3,491	1,139
6.	Paid-up Equity Share Capital	754	754	754	754	754	754
7.	Reserves (excluding Revaluation Reserve)						19,221
8.	Earnings Per Equity Share (of Rs. 2 each)						
	- Basic (Rs.)	7.24	1.01	7.26	8.25	9.38	4.21
	- Diluted (Rs.)	7.24	1.01	7.26	8.25	9.38	4.21

Note :

1. The above is an extract of the detailed format of Quarterly Financial Results filed with the Stock Exchanges under Regulation 33 of the SEBI (Listing Obligations and Disclosure Requirements) Regulations, 2015. The Unaudited Financial Results and the extract were reviewed by the Audit Committee and approved by the Board of Directors of the Company at the Meeting held on 10th November, 2026. The full format of the Financial Results for the Quarter and half year ended 30th September, 2026 are available on the Stock Exchange websites, www.nseindia.com and www.bseindia.com as well as on the Company's website, www.rossellindia.com.

Place : Kolkata
Date : 10th November, 2026

For and on behalf of the Board of Directors
of ROSSELL INDIA LIMITED
Sd/-
MANISH SHAW
COMPANY SECRETARY
MEM. NO. A48460

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Business Standard Insight Out

Blackstone to pick up 16% in IIFL Finance for ₹5,000 cr

AATHIRA VARIER
Mumbai, 10 November



Big push

- Promoters Nirmal Jain and Venkataraman Rajamani to invest ₹1,264 crore through a preferential allotment of warrants
- Anchorage Capital to invest ₹150 crore
- Fundraiser to strengthen IIFL's CAR, improve cost of funds, accelerate growth in gold finance

US-based Blackstone, the world's largest alternative asset manager, will invest ₹5,000 crore (about $535 million) for a nearly 16 per cent stake in Nirmal Jain-promoted IIFL Finance through a preferential issue of shares.

Along with Blackstone's investment through its Singapore-based investment vehicle, Ingot SG Pte, IIFL Finance is raising ₹6,414 crore (about $686 million) in primary capital, the non-banking finance company said on Tuesday.

Promoters Nirmal Jain and Venkataraman Rajamani will invest ₹1,264 crore (about $135 million) through a preferential allotment of warrants, while Anchorage Capital will participate in the transaction with a primary equity investment of ₹150 crore (about $16 million).

As on September 30, 2026, promoters' stake in the non-banking finance company (NBFC) was 24.76 per cent.

Last year, Blackstone invested over ₹6,000 crore in Federal Bank for 9.99 per cent stake in the lender, marking its first investment in the Indian banking sector. Previously, the global alternative asset manager acquired a controlling stake in Aadhar Housing Finance in 2019 and a majority stake in ASK Investment Managers in 2022.

According to IIFL Finance, the funds from the capital infusion will strengthen its capital adequacy ratio (CAR), improve its cost of funds, accelerate growth in its gold finance business, and support its ambition to become one of India's largest diversified retail NBFCs

IIFL Finance's consolidated cost of borrowing in the July-Septmber quarter was 9.02 per cent, inching up 3 bps from the preceding quarter.

Gold loan's share was 53 per cent of IIFL Finance's ₹1.24 trillion consolidated assets under management (AUM) as on September 30, 2026.The lender said it expects to benefit from Blackstone's global scale, network and operational expertise, including in technology, data, and artificial intelligence (AI). It added that this would help it scale its secured lending businesses, attract and retain high-quality talent, and strengthen its overall franchise.

"The investment strengthens our balance sheet and gives us the headroom to scale our franchises, invest further in technology, and deepen our co-lending partnerships with banks, while staying disciplined on risk and capital," Nirmal Jain, founder & managing director, IIFL Finance said.

IIFL Finance said the proposed appointment of Blackstone representatives to its Board is expected to further strengthen governance standards and oversight, while preserving the Company's entrepreneurial culture and focus on execution.

"Building great businesses has been central to our approach over more than two decades of investing in India, and we look forward to partnering with Nirmal, Venkat and the management team to support IIFL Finance's continued growth," said Mukesh Mehta, chief investment officer for India Private Equity and senior managing director, Blackstone.

Trilegal is acting as legal counsel to the Company, and Khaitan & Co. are acting as legal counsel to Blackstone.

Fairfax Financial Holdings — through its subsidiary FIH Mauritius Investments — held a 13.64 per cent stake in IIFL Finance as of September 30, 2026. Fairfax is looking to exit its investment in the NBFC as it prepares to acquire a 60.72 per cent stake in IDBI Bank for $5.5 billion (about ₹550 crore).

The latest fundraise by IIFL Finance is part of a broader trend of large global investors committing significant capital to India's non-banking financial company (NBFC) sector.

In March 2025, private equity major Bain Capital agreed to invest ₹4,385 crore in Manappuram Finance for an 18 per cent stake through a preferential allotment of shares and warrants.

Irdai forms two working groups on risk-based capital framework

AATHIRA VARIER
Mumbai, 10 November

Two working groups have been formed to develop a framework to align the proposed risk-based capital (RBC) regime with Indian Accounting Standards (Ind AS).

Announcing their formation on Tuesday, the Insurance Regulatory and Development Authority of India (Irdai) said the groups, comprising representatives from life and non-life insurers, had been given a month to prepare an exposure draft of the RBC regulations and an accompanying approach paper.

The life insurance group includes chief financial officers or appointed actuaries of Life Insurance Corporation, SBI Life, HDFC Life, ICICI Prudential Life, Bajaj Life, Tata AIA, Kotak Life, Bandhan Life and Aditya Birla Life, along with Munich Re and the Institute of Actuaries of India.

The non-life group comprises similar representatives from New India Assurance, ICICI Lombard, Bajaj General, SBI General, Tata AIG, Niva Bupa, IndusInd General and Kiwi General, along with Swiss Re and the Institute of Actuaries of India.

Irdai said the two groups would work in close coordination, with joint meetings wherever issues common to life and non-life insurers arose, to ensure a consistent approach across the industry.

All deliberations, data, drafts and documents of the groups will remain confidential.

The move is aimed at using Ind AS financial statements as the starting point for calculating capital requirements under the proposed RBC framework, with defined adjustments wherever required for prudential purposes.

Currently, insurers follow a factor-based solvency regime. Under the proposed RBC framework, an insurer's capital requirement will be linked to the risks it carries and measured using an economic, or market-consistent, balance sheet.

Irdai said running the two frameworks on separate and unconnected bases could increase compliance costs for insurers, create reconciliation complexities, and lead to inconsistent outcomes and regulatory arbitrage. Both frameworks share common measurement principles, including estimates of future cash flows, discounting and explicit allowances for risk.

The working groups will examine the valuation of assets and liabilities, determining available and required capital, risk modules, calibration standards, and aggregation and diversification benefits.

They will also assess the treatment of key components such as debt securities and expected credit loss (ECL), the contractual service margin (CSM), risk adjustment for non-financial risk, insurance acquisition cash flows, reinsurance contracts and property valuation.

The exercise will also cover differences between Ind AS and the prudential requirements of the RBC framework, including the construction of risk-free yield curves, discounting methodologies, illiquidity premiums and alignment the RBC risk margin with the Ind AS risk adjustment.

The groups will prepare templates for insurers to submit RBC-related data to the regulator, covering the RBC balance sheet.

DATANOMICS

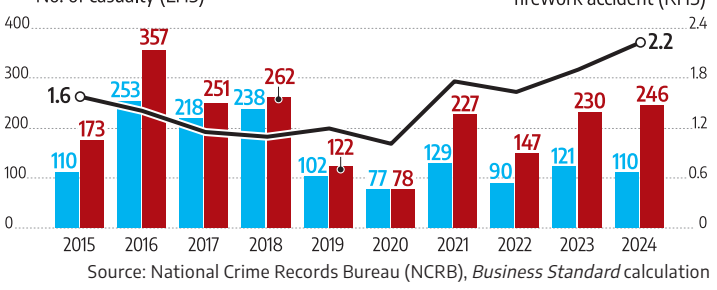
Not just Diwali, most mishaps occur at firecracker units in 2026

JAYANT PANKAJ



A 10-year-old boy died in Delhi on November 8 after a firecracker exploded in his hand. At the outset, it seems such incidents are more frequent during the Diwali period, but the festival is not the only reason for such mishaps. The number of firework accidents rose from 110 in 2015 to 238 in 2018, before fluctuating during and after the Covid-19 period. In 2024, 110 such cases were recorded. During this period, the annual number of casualties ranged from 147 to 357. More than half of the deaths recorded between 2015 and 2024 occurred in just four states: Tamil Nadu, Uttar Pradesh, Bihar, and Madhya Pradesh. The high number of deaths in Tamil Nadu may be because most units are located in Sivakasi. This suggests that casualties due to firework mishaps may not necessarily happen at the consumer end, but even at factories. In 2026, almost every month has witnessed at least one firework-related accident in different parts of the country. Also, this year has seen major incidents involving nine firecracker factories—mostly illegal—and a house storing crackers, together claiming 92 lives.

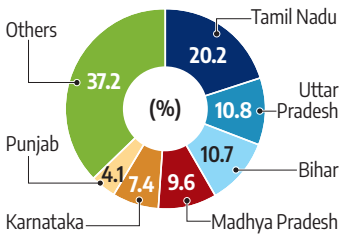
Highest avg no. of casualties per accident in 2024



Source: National Crime Records Bureau (NCRB), *Business Standard* calculation

Tamil Nadu accounts for one in five deaths

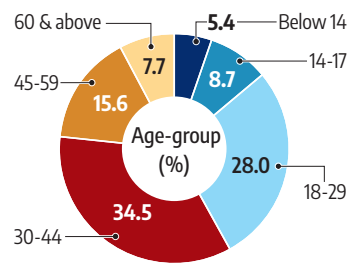
States' share in deaths due to fireworks from 2015 to 2024



Note: Tamil Nadu tops as it is India's largest firecracker manufacturing hub
Source: NCRB, *Business Standard* calculation

Adults primary victims of firework deaths

Agewise share of firework accident victims from 2015 to 2024



Source: NCRB, *Business Standard* calculation

Major firework mishaps this year

Date	State	Accident description	No. of deaths
Jan 22	Bihar	Siwan illegal firecracker unit explosion	1
Feb 16	Rajasthan	Blast at illegal firecracker unit	8
Mar 1	Andhra Pradesh	Explosion occured at firecracker manufacturing unit	20
Apr 19	Tamil Nadu	Fireworks manufacturing unit blast	23
May 15	Madhya Pradesh	Firecracker factory blast in Dewas	3
Jun 9	Rajasthan	Blast at illegal firecracker warehouse in Jaipur	7
Jul 18	Gujarat	Blast inside illegal firecracker factory	8
Aug 13	Tamil Nadu	Fire accident in fireworks unit at Sivakasi	2
Aug 31	Uttar Pradesh	Kaushambi firecracker unit blast	13
Oct 23	Bihar	Blast at house storing firecrackers in Siwan	7
Nov 8	Delhi	10-year-old boy died in Delhi's Narela on Diwali	1

Source: Media reports, *Business Standard* calculation

Medical device PLI scheme extended by 8 yrs; focus shifts to components

SANKET KOUL
New Delhi, 10 November

The Department of Pharmaceuticals (DoP) has extended the production-linked incentive (PLI) scheme to promote domestic manufacturing of medical devices by eight years, until 2035-36.

Inviting fresh applications under the extended scheme, DoP said that the roughly ₹2,700 crore outlay available under the existing scheme would be utilised for the purpose. "Applicants can submit applications through an online portal, which will be operational in the next 10 days," officials aware of the matter said. They added that several eligibility conditions had been relaxed based on the learnings from the first phase of the scheme.

While DoP did not provide details, it said on Tuesday that the minimum sales threshold requirement for claiming incentives had been discontinued. Officials added that the minimum investment requirement of ₹180 crore had also been reduced to make the scheme more investor-friendly.

Similarly, applicants will now be allowed three years to set up manufacturing facilities across four distinct target segments (TS). This marks a departure from the earlier PLI framework, under which companies often had a very tight turnaround time — sometimes just one year or until a fixed commercial date — to commence production. Under the new framework, the four target segments will include medical consumables, disposables and implants (TS1), and critical components (TS2).

TS3 will cover high-end medical devices that are currently at a nascent stage of domestic manufacturing, while TS4 will include high-end medical devices that are presently only assembled in the country. "In TS3 and TS4, priority shall be given to value chain integration so that there is an overall increase in the competitiveness and quality of Made in India devices," DoP said in a statement.

The revised scheme will also introduce a tapering incentive structure, with rates of 5 per cent for TS1, 9 per cent for TS2 and TS3, and 6 per cent for TS4. This marks a change from the earlier flat incentive rate applicable to eligible incremental sales made by participants annually.

"The incentives now match the difficulty of manufacturing. Instead of one flat rate, higher rates go where manufacturing is hardest and import dependence is deepest," a Delhi-based medical technology (medtech) manufacturer told *Business Standard*.

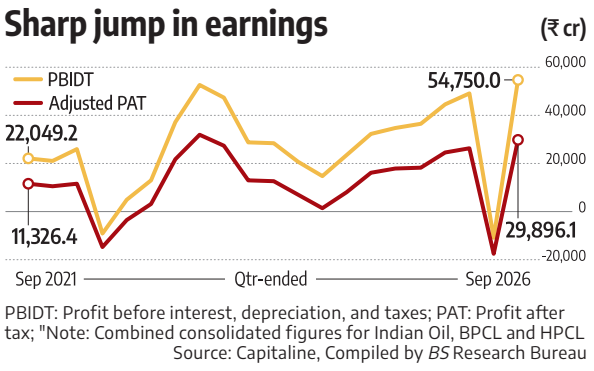
Announced in March 2020, the PLI scheme for medical devices has resulted in production worth over ₹16,000 crore, according to DoP. "The scheme has led to domestic manufacturing of over 60 high-end devices and components, including X-ray tubes and detectors, 1.5-tesla magnetic resonance imaging (MRI) machines, cath labs and dialysers, among others, to date," the department said.

Officials quoted above added that the objective of the revised framework was to promote deeper domestic manufacturing of medical devices, as well as the production of high-end equipment such as 3T MRI machines, PET-CT scanners, ultrasound consoles and high-throughput IVD analysers, which are currently not manufactured in the country.

FROM PAGE 1

Profit bonanza for govt OMCs in Q2 despite crude oil turmoil

Sharp jump in earnings



PBIDT: Profit before interest, depreciation, and taxes; PAT: Profit after tax; "Note: Combined consolidated figures for Indian Oil, BPCL and HPCL
Source: Capitaline, Compiled by *BS* Research Bureau

Their raw material costs were up 33.3 per cent in a year, while the purchase of refined product from independent refiners for retail sales was up 39.2 per cent — both growing slower than the rise in their net sales.

As a result, OMCs' combined operating profit was up 50.8 per cent year-on-year to ₹54,750 crore in the September 2026 quarter, from ₹36,304 crore a year ago and an operating loss of ₹10,789 crore in the June 2026 quarter.

The companies' Ebitda margin improved to 10.1 per cent of net sales in Q2FY27, from 9.4 per cent a year ago and -1.9 per cent in Q1FY27.

For comparison, OMCs' operating margin had been 6.5 per cent on average in the previous 20 quarters.

Their raw material expenses (including purchase of traded goods) improved to 84 per cent of net sales in Q2FY27, from 97.6 per cent in the June quarter this year and 83.3 per cent in the September quarter last year.

In the September quarter under review, OMCs reported a consolidated net profit of over ₹30,000 crore on account of refining gains.

Similarly, private player Reliance Industries Ltd's (RIL's) oil-to-chemicals (O2C) segment's earnings before interest and taxes (Ebit) stood at a record high of ₹22,347 crore in Q2FY27, against ₹12,560 crore a year ago and ₹14,170 crore Q1FY27.

The O2C segment revenue was up 44.2 per cent year-on-year to around ₹2.32 trillion in Q2FY27, from ₹1.61 trillion a year ago.

RIL Chairman and Managing Director Mukesh Ambani last month attributed the strong O2C business performance to tight fuel markets, improved downstream petrochemical deltas, and firm domestic demand.

The company's ability to optimise feedstock sourcing and product placement along with operations across the value chain enabled it to improve margin capture, Ambani said.

Crude oil prices in the September 2026 quarter increased 40 per cent year-on-year due to the West Asia crisis, whereas prices of transportation fuel in the international market were up 50-78 per cent. Prices of most downstream chemical products were up 25-35 per cent annually, on strong feedstock prices.

After IOCL results, Harshraj Aggarwal, analyst at Yes Securities, said that earnings outperformance was driven by strong refining margins and a sharp recovery in marketing profitability, supported by better integrated margins and recognition of ₹3,620 crore in LPG subsidy compensation from the government. "The overall performance reflects a strong operational recovery, although elevated LPG under-recoveries and forex losses continue to weigh on earnings," said Aggarwal.

The benefit of higher exports, however, is not uniform across the sector as private refiners have greater flexibility to divert supplies to export markets while state-run oil marketing companies (OMCs) primarily cater to domestic consumers.

The government has also imposed special additional excise duty (SAED) on petrol, diesel, and ATF as a policy tool to balance overseas sales with domestic availability amid volatility in global oil markets.

Commenting on RIL's performance, research firm Nomura said the company's Ebitda at ₹25,200 crore was against the estimate of ₹20,300 crore, in its strongest-ever quarter. "With cracks broadly stable quarter on quarter at multi-decade highs, the sequential jump came from a lower crude basket cost, better margin capture and higher throughput," it said.

From runways to highways: Bus travel gathers pace amid soaring airfares

COMPANIES ARE INVESTING IN ROUTE NETWORKS, OPERATOR PARTNERSHIPS, FLEET CAPACITY AND TECHNOLOGY TO DEEPEN SUPPLY AND CAPTURE A LARGER SHARE OF THE MARKET

The price advantage

The economics are becoming harder for travellers to ignore. Domestic airfares have risen by an estimated 20-40 per cent year-on-year across several major routes over the past year for the September-November travel period, reflecting higher aviation turbine fuel (ATF) costs, airline fuel surcharges, sustained demand and adjustments to route capacity.

Some routes have seen considerably steeper increases. Delhi-Hyderabad recorded a 68 per cent year-on-year rise in average fares, alongside an approximately 15 per cent decline in available seats. Mumbai–Kolkata fares climbed about 51 per cent, while Delhi–Goa and Mumbai–Bengaluru saw increases of 39 per cent and 37 per cent, respectively, according to EaseMyTrip.

Average bus fares in India, on the other hand, typically range from ₹850 to ₹1,050, depending on the route and time of year.

There are also signs that buses are becoming a more deliberate consumer choice rather than merely a cheaper substitute. In a FlixBus survey of respondents who had travelled between 100 and 1,000 kilometres in the preceding 12 months, 52 per cent said they had used an air-conditioned intercity bus, compared with 49 per cent who opted for air travel.

"We believe buses have the potential to be the first-choice option for many intercity journeys, rather than simply an alternative when other modes are unavailable," said Surya Khurana, managing director of FlixBus India.

For travel companies, the opportunity lies in turning this shift in preference into a larger, more organised market. FlixBus had increased its network capacity by 75 per cent the 2026 festival season compared with the corresponding Dussehra-to-year-end period last year. The expansion includes additional services on key corridors, particularly Delhi/Gurugram-Dehradun/Mussoorie, Bengaluru-Hyderabad, Bengaluru-Chennai, Delhi/Gurugram-Manali, Delhi/Gurugram-Katra and Chennai-Hyderabad.

MakeMyTrip, meanwhile, has reported growth in its bus business, which forms part of its ground transport segment. Last week, it also acquired Bengaluru-based bus shuttle service provider Quick Ride. "Ground transport continued to grow at a strong pace during the quarter. Supply additions, wider route coverage, and the continued development of India's highway infrastructure supported the category's structural growth," the management said during its earnings call following the announcement of its Q2FY27 results.

The expansion is not confined to ticketing platforms. Companies are investing in route networks, operator partnerships, fleet capacity and technology to deepen supply and capture a larger share of the market. Weekend getaways, winter holidays, long weekends and year-end vacations are expected to sustain demand beyond the traditional festival peaks.

Fleet improvements are another important tailwind. Operators are expanding their fleets and upgrading services, particularly through the addition of sleeper buses, while better highways are making longer road journeys more viable.

EaseMyTrip is seeking to build a broader presence in the segment through YOLO Bus, while developing electric mobility capabilities through Easy Green Mobility (EMTev). Its focus includes expanding route coverage, fleet capacity and operator partnerships.

"Under our 'Vision 2030 roadmap', we aim to establish an annual manufacturing capacity of 5,000 electric buses over the next five years. Our recent launch of electric bus operations in Bhopal marks an important step in taking this initiative forward," said Pittie.

AbhiBus sees the opportunity extending well beyond the current demand cycle. "We continue to see a strong long-term growth opportunity in the intercity bus segment, driven by expanding supply across private and state transport operators, improving highway infrastructure, growing adoption of online bus bookings and increasing consumer preference for convenient and reliable travel experiences," said Sharma.

Geographically, the demand is spreading across both leisure and pilgrimage corridors. In North India, routes connecting Delhi-NCR with Dehradun, Haridwar, Rishikesh, Mussoorie, Shimla, Chandigarh and Jaipur are gaining traction ahead of the coming season. In the South, Tirupati, Vijayawada, Guntur and Kakinada continue to attract pilgrimage and regional travellers, according to EaseMyTrip.

BS SUDOKU #5037

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7				5		2	4	8
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2		8				9		7
	1			8				
				9	2	4		
						6	8	

SOLUTION TO #5036

6	2	3	1	7	9	5	8	4
9	7	1	4	8	5	6	3	2
8	4	5	2	3	6	7	1	9
4	3	7	6	9	1	2	5	8
1	9	2	8	5	3	4	7	6
5	6	8	7	2	4	3	9	1
2	8	9	3	4	7	1	6	5
3	1	4	5	6	8	9	2	7
7	5	6	9	1	2	8	4	3

Hard:
★★★★
Solution tomorrow

HOW TO PLAY
Fill in the grid so that every row, every column and every 3x3 box contains the digits 1 to 9

Trying to set up safe food corridors in Black Sea: MEA

Says India has urged Russia, Ukraine to guarantee safety of shipping

ARCHIS MOHAN
New Delhi, 10 November

India on Tuesday said it is engaged with both Russia and Ukraine on safety of shipping in the Black Sea, particularly for their grains and energy export as well as on setting up "food corridors". Since July, New Delhi has urged Russia and Ukraine to guarantee safety of shipping for grains and energy exports, including of fertilisers, to ease the impact of El Niño on the countries of the Global South.

The MEA also dismissed as "fabricated and malicious" allegations levelled against National Security Adviser Ajit Doval and former R&AW chief Samant Goel in a civil lawsuit filed by Khalistani separatist Gurpatwant Singh Pannun in a US court.

On the US mid-term elections, the Ministry of External Affairs (MEA) said it were an internal matter of the country and unlikely to impact ties between New Delhi and Washington, and the India-US relationship enjoys strong bipartisan support from both the Republican and Democrats.

On New Delhi's recent engagements with Moscow and Kyiv, MEA spokesperson Randhir Jaiswal elaborated on Prime Minister Narendra Modi's telephonic conversation with Ukrainian President Volodymyr Zelenskyy, and External Affairs Minister S Jaishankar's with his Russian counterpart Sergey Lavrov. The two conversations took place on Monday, ahead of the three-way talks among Russia, Ukraine and the US, that kicked off in the United Arab Emirates on Tuesday.

INDIA DISMISSED ALLEGATIONS LEVELLED AGAINST NSA AJIT DOVAL AND EX-R&AW CHIEF SAMANT GOEL IN A LAWSUIT FILED BY KHALISTANI SEPARATIST GURPATWANT SINGH PANNUN IN US

"In keeping with this idea to bring peace, India has been engaged both sides with certain ideas such as safety of shipping in the Black Sea, addressing immediate concerns of Russia and Ukraine on grain and energy exports, and non-attack possibilities," Jaiswal said. "On the issue of food corridor, we have exchanged ideas," he said.

After his phone conversation with Modi on Monday, Zelenskyy said he discussed with the Indian PM Russia blocking grain exports through the Black Sea and that India is willing to "mediate" in establishing food corridors. At a meeting with Russian President Vladimir Putin in Bishkek in September on the sidelines of the Shanghai Cooperation Organisation, Modi called for an immediate end to the conflict and urged the Russian leader to shift from an "endless war towards the end of war".

Days later, Jaishankar travelled to Kyiv. Modi and Putin also met in New Delhi on the margins of the Brics Summit in mid-September. Last month, Putin said Modi has "good ideas" to find a mutually acceptable solution to the conflict.

In the first week of October, addressing the Kautilya Economic Conclave in New Delhi, Jaishankar said that India is mediating between Russia and Ukraine to ensure secure shipping of grains and fertilisers, as this is linked to the Global South's food security. In July, after attacks on merchant ships by both Russia and Ukraine resulted in the killing and injury of Indian sailors, Jaishankar raised the issue with the foreign ministers of Russia and Ukraine. The discussions revealed the nature of the ships' cargos, and that grain exports had almost come to a halt, he said.

FROM PAGE 1

Foreign investors return, signalling a longer India bet

FPIs have been net buyers of domestic debt in five of the seven months of the current financial year. Net purchases in FY27 have reached about ₹52,939 crore, including November, although much of the inflow came in June, when foreign investors bought ₹41,774 crore of government securities.

Their positioning in equity derivatives has also become less bearish. At Monday's close, FPIs' long-short ratio stood at 26.8 per cent, its second-highest level this year, behind the 29.2 per cent recorded on February 23, shortly before the Iran-US war began.

The ratio had remained below 15 per cent for most of the period since the conflict erupted. Foreign investors continue to hold more short than long positions, but the balance of their bets is now the least bearish since the war began.

The shift comes after a prolonged period in which India struggled to attract foreign capital, as investors sought higher returns across both equity and debt markets. The absence of a compelling artificial intelligence investment theme also left Indian equities at a disadvantage, as the AI-driven rally propelled markets in the US and across Asia excluding Japan to new highs.

The political outcome of the US mid-term elections, with Democrats winning control of Congress, has reduced the perceived risk of a further escalation in the West Asia conflict. The resulting easing in crude oil prices has helped temper concerns about an inflationary shock, a key determinant of the US interest-rate outlook.

A less inflationary global environment could improve the relative appeal of Indian assets. Domestic equities have become more attractive on valuation grounds after their recent underperformance, while government bonds offer foreign investors an opportunity to earn relatively high yields.

"Given India's healthy macroeconomic fundamentals, strong corporate earnings, a meaningful correction in valuations from their 2024 peak levels, and robust domestic liquidity, any moderation in the global AI trade could encourage a stronger and more sustained revival in FPI interest in relatively underperforming emerging markets such as India," wrote Deven Mistry and Aanshul Agarawal of Motilal Oswal Financial Services in a note to clients. "Continued improvement in FPI sentiment, coupled with easing geopolitical challenges, could help offset the headwinds that have weighed on Indian markets over the past two years and lay the foundation for a sustained market rally."



The renewed interest has coincided with a sharp rebound in domestic markets. The Nifty 50 rose 5 per cent over the past five trading sessions. The inflows have also supported the rupee, which gained 1.09 per cent against the dollar last week, moving past the ₹94-a-dollar mark to its strongest level in more than four months. A softer dollar index provided additional support to emerging-market currencies.

The bond market has also rallied, with yields falling across maturities last week. Long-dated securities recorded the steepest declines, flattening the yield curve. Foreign banks and private sector banks were the principal buyers, while public sector banks, mutual funds and primary dealers were net sellers.

"Foreign investors came in on the longer end after the fall in crude, and that helped the 10-year government bond yield fall sharply last week. The buying in the 2033 and 2036 bonds shows they are comfortable adding at these levels, but we need to see if the flows hold once oil settles," a market participant said. Conditions in the money market have eased as well. Banking system liquidity was in surplus by ₹2.3 trillion, equivalent to 0.8 per cent of net demand and time liabilities, as of November 6.

The liquidity surplus widened during the week following the reversal of a 29-day variable rate reverse repo (VRRR) auction worth about ₹25,560 crore. The Reserve Bank of India (RBI) also conducted a three-day VRRR auction for ₹25,000 crore, which attracted bids worth ₹18,130 crore.

However, festival-season demand and outflows towards excise duty and tax payments prompted the central bank to conduct a four-day variable rate repo (VRR) auction worth ₹50,000 crore to meet additional liquidity requirements.

The improvement in liquidity was reflected in short-term borrowing costs. The weighted average call rate (WACR), an indicator of overnight borrowing costs in the banking system, eased to 5.47 per cent from 5.64 per cent the previous week. The weighted average triparty repo rate declined to 5.52 per cent from 5.63 per cent, while the weighted average market repo rate fell to 5.46 per cent from 5.60 per cent.

Whether the improvement in sentiment translates into sustained foreign inflows will depend partly on this week's economic data. October consumer price inflation is expected to rise to 5.9 per cent, driven by higher food prices and an unfavourable base effect. Bond dealers expect the 10-year benchmark yield to trade in a range of 7.10-7.25 per cent.

"Volumes should stay thin in a holiday-shortened week, and the market will take its cue from October CPI," a dealer at a private bank said. "Oil and the US payrolls-driven Fed rate hike risk (will decide) the direction."

Global brokerages are also becoming more constructive on Indian equities. HSBC Global Investment Research upgraded India to 'overweight' this week, citing the country's market depth, domestic demand and relatively resilient macroeconomic backdrop.

"In an environment where investors are seeking to diversify away from concentrated AI exposure, India stands out for its market depth, domestic demand orientation and relatively resilient macro backdrop," its analysts wrote. "Valuations, previously a key concern, have moderated back towards historical averages, while corporate earnings have remained resilient despite the economy's dependence on energy imports." Citi raised its December 2027 Nifty 50 target to 28,000, implying an upside of 11.8 per cent from Monday's close of 25,044.65. The brokerage expects earnings to grow at about 15 per cent annually over FY26-28 and oil prices to remain "below prior fears". It also expects AI capital expenditure to moderate, arguing that the outcome of the US midterm elections and elevated interest rates could constrain spending and "aid flows into non-AI assets".

Financial markets were closed on Tuesday for Diwali Balipratipada.

Unemployment rate for urban youth at 6-qtr high

Punjab and Andhra Pradesh followed at 7.8 per cent each. At the other end of the spectrum, Karnataka had the lowest rate of 2.8 per cent, followed by Gujarat at 3.2 per cent and West Bengal at 3.4 per cent. Additionally, Kerala also had the highest youth unemployment rate (aged 15-29) among states, at 28.9 per cent, while Gujarat had the lowest rate at 7.9 per cent.

The labour force participation rate (LFPR), which is the percentage of the population that is either working or actively looking for work, improved during the quarter. The LFPR for persons aged 15 and above rose to 55.5 per cent from 54.6 per cent in Q2 of 2026-27. Similarly, the Worker Population Ratio (WPR), which represents the number of persons or person-days employed per 1,000 persons or person-days, rose to 52.7 per cent from 51.7 per cent in the previous quarter.

The data also pointed to a decline in casual employment. The share of workers engaged in casual labour fell to a six-quarter low of 18.4 per cent in Q2, from 19 per cent in the previous quarter. In rural and urban areas, the share of overall casual workers declined to six-quarter lows of 21.7 per cent and 10.7 per cent, respectively.

Further, the composition of employment in the quarter shifted towards self-employment in rural areas, whose share rose to 62.7 per cent of workers from 61.4 per cent. In urban areas, regular wage and salaried jobs gained ground, with their share edging up to 49.6 per cent from 49.3 per cent.

The split by sector continued to reflect the rural-urban divide, with most rural workers in agriculture and most urban workers in the tertiary sector. Agriculture's share of rural employment rose to 56.7 per cent in the September quarter from 52.9 per cent in the June quarter, while the shares of the secondary and tertiary sectors fell. In urban areas, the tertiary sector's share held steady at 62 per cent. Overall, 41.7 per cent of workers were employed in agriculture in Q2, up from 38.7 per cent in the previous quarter.

Govt targets ₹6K cr in FY27 from MTNL's land assets sale

The telecom public sector undertaking reported a net loss of ₹3,102 crore in FY26 on total income of ₹1,469 crore.

It raised ₹419 crore during the year through the sale of two properties, one in Mumbai and the other in New Delhi, to the National Bank for Agriculture and Rural Development (Nabard) and the Bihar government respectively.

Once the Cabinet approves the proposed monetisation, NLMC will approach prospective buyers. If a government entity expresses interest in acquiring a property, the transaction can be completed through private placement. Otherwise, NLMC will put the asset up for auction to attract buyers from the private sector, one of the officials said.

The government established NLMC in 2022 under the finance ministry as a specialised agency to monetise surplus land and buildings held by central public sector enterprises (CPSEs) and other government bodies. It was also tasked with facilitating the closure of CPSEs and streamlining the strategic disinvestment of government-owned companies.

Under the arrangement, assets are transferred to NLMC for holding, management and eventual sale. The corporation appoints independent agencies to value the properties.

Once the valuation is complete, the government and NLMC jointly determine a reserve price before the corporation approaches potential buyers.

NLMC also advises and assists government entities, including CPSEs, in identifying surplus non-core assets and monetising them in a professional and efficient manner to maximise returns.

Its remit therefore extends beyond assets formally transferred to the corporation to include those for which it provides advisory and transaction support.

Industry bodies welcome Tea Board panel proposal on minimum sustainable price

ISHITA AYAN DUTT
Kolkata, 10 November

A committee constituted by the Tea Board of India has recommended introducing a minimum sustainable price (MSP) for tea to address the widening gap between production costs and market realisations, a move welcomed by tea industry associations.

In July 2026, the Tea Board constituted a 10-member committee for MSP comprising representatives and stakeholders from the tea industry.

The committee recommended a composite index reflecting wage movements and the consumer price index (CPI) to determine the benchmark MSP. It also proposed periodic reviews of the benchmark to ensure the pricing framework aligns with changes in production costs and inflation.

If adopted, the benchmark for tea pricing, would have implications for both auction and private sales.

Industry associations said the Tea Board sent a report to the commerce ministry recommending an MSP for tea about 20 days ago.

On Tuesday, five tea industry associations — the Indian Tea Association (ITA), Tea Association of India (TAI), United Planters Association of Southern India (UPASI), Confederation of Indian Small Tea Growers Associations (CISTA) and Federation of Indian Tea Manufacturers Association (FITMA) — urged the commerce ministry to adopt the recommendations and ensure early implementation of the suggestions.

Suneel Singh Sikand, Chairman, ITA, said the recommendation for a MSP is an important policy intervention towards addressing the structural challenges confronting the Indian tea industry.

"Ensuring remunerative returns to producers is critical to sustaining operations, facilitating investment in replantation and productivity enhancement and securing the industry's long-term sustainability," he added.

The recommendation comes at a time when the tea industry is bracing for implementation of the Code on Wages, with labour costs accounting for about 60 per cent of the total cost of production.

Arijit Raha, secretary general of the ITA, said the implementation of the Code on Wages would lead to a substantial increase in wages for skilled and semi-skilled workers across the country, including those in the tea industry. "This would make it increasingly difficult for the industry to meet its obligations in the present environment. That is what the Tea Board has taken into consideration," he said.

Hemant Bangur, former chairman, ITA and TAI, said, the balance sheets of tea-producing companies are in the red and the cycle has been going on for last 20 years. "There is a structural problem in the tea industry. You have a large number of producers and few buyers."

Describing the market as dysfunctional, Bangur said market forces could operate effectively only in a fair and level-playing field, making intervention necessary.

"The intervention proposed is an MSP, which would enable us to run our estates sustainably," he said.

C K Dhanuka, chairman of Dhunseri Tea and Industries, and a long-time advocate of MSP for tea, urged the government to adopt the committee's recommendations.

"A minimum sustainable price will help bring realisations in line with costs, so that the industry can accommodate wage revisions, protect employment and the competitiveness of Indian tea," he said.

Bijoy Gopal Chakraborty, president, Confederation of Indian Small Tea Growers Associations (CISTA), said, "Small tea growers constitute a significant segment of India's tea industry and contribute substantially to domestic tea production. Their economic viability is intrinsically linked to the prices realised for green leaf."

Andhra clocks 74% conversion from investment proposals

SHINE JACOB
Visakhapatnam, 10 November

Andhra Pradesh has converted 526 of the 714 investment projects received since June 2024, achieving a conversion rate of nearly 74 per cent by project count. The converted projects represent investments worth ₹17.2 trillion, accounting for approximately 76 per cent of the State's total investment pipeline of ₹22.6 trillion, with an overall employment potential of 19,30,000 jobs, said a government statement on Tuesday.

The progress reflects the State Government's emphasis on translating investment commitments into projects on the ground, as Andhra Pradesh prepares to host the 31st CII Partnership Summit on November 12 and 13 in Visakhapatnam.

The two-day global summit, themed "Navigating the New World Order: Trade, Technology, Trust and Thought Leadership," is expected to bring together representatives from 58 countries, including overseas Ministers, international speakers, global investors and leading industry representatives.

The remaining 188 projects, worth ₹5.4 trillion, are at various stages of consideration, the statement added. Further, 303 projects involving investments of ₹7.1 trillion, with an employment potential of 7,70,000 jobs, have either been grounded or are scheduled for grounding.

STEEL AUTHORITY OF INDIA LIMITED
Bokaro Steel Plant
Bokaro - 827001, Jharkhand, India

NOTICE INVITING EXPRESSION OF INTEREST (EOI)

Notice No: BSL/TA/SEC/2026/EOI-01
Date: November 10, 2026

Subject : Expression of Interest (EOI) for the Engagement of a Professional, Licensed, Ex-Servicemen-Led Security Agency for Township Security, Anti-Encroachment, Asset Protection, and Contingency Response at BSL

Bokaro Steel Plant (BSL) invites Expressions of Interest (EOI) from reputed, financially sound, and professionally managed security agencies registered under the Private Security Agencies (Regulation) Act (PSARA). The engagement will be structured on a performance-linked Service Level Agreement (SLA) and Key Performance Indicator (KPI). Command and administrative control will be retained by Security Department,BSL under CGM (Town Administration).

Last Date of Submission: November 19, 2026 – 05:30 PM (through e-mail/ hard copy)

Date for presentation (either in person or through zoom link sent by SAIL, BSL): November 21, 2026 -10:30 AM , Address : Committee Room, 1st Floor, Administrative Building, BSL

Further details of EOI are available at **https://sailtenders.co.in/** website.

Registered Office : Ispat Bhawan, Lodhi Road, New Delhi 110 003
Corporate Identity Number : L27109DL1973GOI006454, Website : www.sail.co.in
There's a little bit of SAIL in everybody's life

Dr.Reddy's

NOTICE OF LOSS OF SHARE CERTIFICATES

Notice is hereby given that the following Share Certificates issued by the Company are reported to have been lost or misplaced and the registered Shareholders/Claimants thereto have applied to the Company for the issue of duplicate share certificates.

S No.	Folio No.	Name of the Shareholder	Certificate No(s).	No. of Shares	Distinctive Nos. From - To
1	S01871*	Sunil Ramanlal Parekh	22281	200	77711772-77711971
2	S05182**	Sunil Ramanlal Parekh	192006	100	19593485-19593584
3	N00311*	Nisar Ahmed Hussain Wagle Shehnaz Raziya	17116	250	54365527-54365776
4	J00919**	Jayshree N Shah	131697	100	9693929-9694028
5	N00341**	Nisar Ahmed Hussain Wagle	26519-26520	75	1765541-1765615
		Shehnaz	77775	50	5681271-5681320
		Raziya	14204-14205	100	1255051-1255150

*Shares of Rs.5/- face value **Shares of Rs.10/- face value

The public is hereby cautioned against dealing in any manner with the above share certificates. Any person(s) who has/have any claim in respect of the said share certificate(s) should lodge claim(s) at the Company's **Regd. Office: 8-2-337, Road No.3, Banjara Hills, Hyderabad - 500 034** within 15 days of publication of this notice after which no claim(s) will be entertained and the Company will proceed to issue duplicate share certificate(s).

Place : Hyderabad
Date : 10-11-2026

For Dr. Reddy's Laboratories Limited
K Randhir Singh
Company Secretary , Compliance Officer and Head - CSR

DR. REDDY'S LABORATORIES LIMITED
Regd. Office: 8-2-337, Road No.3, Banjara Hills, Hyderabad - 500 034
CIN: L85195TG1984PLC004507, Tel: 91 40 4900 2900; Fax: 91 40 4900 2999
email: shares@drreddys.com; website:www.drreddys.com

FORM G
INVITATION FOR EXPRESSION OF INTEREST FOR RANKINI POWER GENERATION PRIVATE LIMITED OPERATING IN "POWER GENERATION" AT KOLKATA
(Under regulation 36A(1) of the Insolvency and Bankruptcy Board of India (Insolvency Resolution Process for Corporate Persons) Regulations, 2016)

Sr.	RELEVANT PARTICULARS	
1	Name of the corporate debtor along with PAN/ CIN/ LLP No.	**CD -** Rankini Power Generation Private Limited **PAN No. -** AABCR1630B **CIN No. -** U40100WB1995PTC070451
2	Address of the registered office	**Registered office:** Room No. 701, 7th Floor, Sidco Global Tower, CN 8/2, Sector-V, Salt Lake City, Kolkata - 700091, West Bengal, India
3	URL of website	-
4	Details of place where majority of fixed assets are located	The corporate debtor holds stake in Abhijeet MADC Nagpur Energy Private Limited (AMNEPL) which has a 246 MW power plant with 25.6 MW DG Sets at Nagpur. However, post the initiation date/ CIRP Initiation Application filing date, certain dilutions in the shareholding of AMNEPL have taken place which are under legal scrutiny. Additionally, the Corporate Debtor's books reflect substantial financial assets and receivables, including: 1.Loans and recoverable amounts assigned from group entities. 2.Shareholding in Vikriti Power Limited (formerly India Power Corporation (Bodhgaya) Limited) 3.Investments and loans extended in India Power Corporation Ltd. (IPCL). 4.Other loans, advances and recoverable amounts from other companies
5	Installed capacity of main products/ services	N.A.
6	Quantity and value of main products/ services sold in last financial year	N.A.
7	Number of employees/ workmen	There is only 1 employee in the company.
8	Further details including last available financial statements (with schedules) of two years, lists of creditors are available at URL:	Further details about the Corporate Debtor or any additional information can be obtained from the Resolution Professional through the provided email: ip.rankinipower@gmail.com
9	Eligibility for resolution applicants under section 25(2)(h) of the Code is available at URL:	The information can be obtained from the Resolution Professional through email: ip.rankinipower@gmail.com
10	Last date for receipt of expression of interest	22-11-2026 (15 days extended from 07.11.2026)
11	Date of issue of provisional list of prospective resolution applicants	02-12-2026
12	Last date for submission of objections to provisional list	07-12-2026
13	Date of issue of final list of prospective resolution applicants	17-12-2026
14	Date of issue of information memorandum, evaluation matrix and request for resolution plans to prospective resolution applicants	22-12-2026 (subject to receipt of Non-Disclosure Agreement by Eligible PRAs)
15	Last date for submission of resolution plans	21-01-2027
16	Process email id to submit EOI	ip.rankinipower@gmail.com
17	Details of Corporate Debtors registration status as MSME	The Corporate Debtor is not registered with Ministry of Micro, Small and Medium Enterprise.

The above-mentioned dates are subject to receipt of approval for extension of the CIRP period by the Hon'ble NCLT, Kolkata Bench.
Further, the documents may be requested by sending an email to ip.rankinipower@gmail.com

For Rankini Power Generation Private Limited
Bhuvan Madan
Resolution Professional
Registration No: IBBI/IPA-001/IP-P01004/2017-2018/11655
AFA Valid upto 31-12-2026
Registered address with IBBI: A-103 Ashok Vihar Phase-3 (Behind Laxmi Bai College), New Delhi, National Capital Territory of Delhi -110052
Registered E-mail ID with IBBI: madan.bhuvan@gmail.com

Date: 11th November, 2026
Place: Kolkata

Suraksha Clinic & Diagnostics

SURAKSHA DIAGNOSTIC LIMITED
CIN: L85110WB2005PLC102265
Reg Office: 12/1, Premises No. 02-0327, DG Block, Action Area 1D, New Town, Kolkata-700 156, West Bengal, India
E-mail: investors@surakshanet.com I Website: www.surakshanet.com I Phone: (033) 6605 9750

STATEMENT OF UNAUDITED (STANDALONE AND CONSOLIDATED) FINANCIAL RESULTS FOR THE QUARTER AND SIX MONTHS ENDED 30 SEPTEMBER 2026

[Pursuant to Regulation 47(1)(b) read with Regulation 33 of the SEBI (Listing Obligations and Disclosure Requirements) Regulations, 2015]

The Board of Directors of the Company, at its meeting held on Tuesday,10 November 2026,has inter-alia, approved the Unaudited (Standalone and Consolidated) Financial Results of the Company for the quarter and six months ended 30 September 2026.

The aforesaid financial results together with the Limited Review Report issued by the Statutory Auditors of the Company are available on the website of the Company at www.surakshanet.com and may also be accessed by scanning the QR code below:

Place : Kolkata
Date : 11 November 2026

By order of the Board of Directors
For Suraksha Diagnostic Limited
Sd/-
Dr. Somnath Chatterjee
Chairman & Joint Managing Director
DIN: 00137075

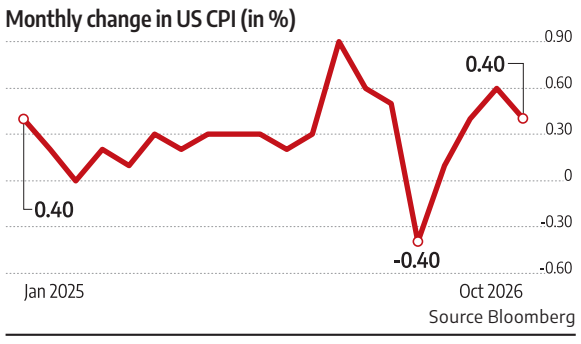
QUICK READ

SoftBank books $7 bn quarterly loss on US data centre hit



SoftBank Group, the Japanese investment giant with big bets on artificial intelligence (AI), said on Tuesday it had swung to a second-quarter net loss of $7 billion, hit hard by hefty buildout costs for data centres in the US and increases in financing payments. The pain inflicted this quarter by a subsidiary's advance payments for power generation equipment could, however, be offset by rebates for future purchases. SoftBank's borrowing may be of greater concern, with financing costs more than doubling during July-September. The group raised $56.5 billion during the period - its highest ever quarterly total - as founder Masayoshi Son (*pictured*) continues to aggressively invest in AI. REUTERS

US consumer price index rises by 0.4%, beats expectations



United States (US) consumer prices increased more than expected in October, leaving the Federal Reserve on course to raise interest rates next month. The Consumer Price Index (CPI) rose 0.4 per cent last month after advancing 0.6 per cent in September, the Labor Department's Bureau of Labor Statistics (BIL) said on Tuesday. Economists polled by *Reuters* had forecast the CPI climbing 0.3 per cent over the month. The BLS did not publish year-over-year inflation readings because last year's federal government shutdown prevented the collection of consumer price data in October 2025, leaving no comparison base. Annual consumer inflation jumped 3.7 per cent in September. Inflation is running well above the US central bank's 2 per cent target. REUTERS

China's trade surplus soars past $1 trn as AI boom powers exports

China's trade surplus surged past $1 trillion in the first 10 months as a global race to build artificial intelligence (AI) infrastructure buoyed sales of high-tech products and helped offset weak domestic demand, a dynamic likely to sharpen tensions with major trading partners. The figures highlight Beijing's growing reliance on overseas demand to support an economy hobbled by subdued consumption and a property slump. REUTERS

Hasina has no legal option but to face death sentence: B'desh govt

Ousted Bangladesh prime minister Sheikh Hasina has no legal option left but to face execution of her death sentence, the International Crimes Tribunal's Chief Prosecutor Md Aminul Islam said on Tuesday, rejecting the possibility of issuing her a passport or travel document. The remarks came amid reports that a London-based legal chamber has approached the Bangladesh High Commission in New Delhi seeking a new passport and national identity card for Hasina, who has expressed her intention to return to the country in December. AP/PTI

US 1st nation to fully shun UNHRC review

The United States is set to become the first country to fully shun a regular review of its human rights record at the UN's top rights body since it was created two decades ago. The Trump administration last year pulled the US out of the Human Rights Council, accusing it of an anti-US and anti-Israel bias. AP/PTI

US appoints Natalie Baker as Pak ambassador

United States (US) President Donald Trump has nominated Natalie Baker to be the next US ambassador to Pakistan, paving the way for the appointment of a permanent envoy to Islamabad after a gap of nearly two years. Baker is currently serving as charge d'affaires at the US Embassy in Islamabad. AP/PTI

Anthropic targets $1.4 trn value in blockbuster IPO

BLOOMBERG
10 November



Betting big

$90.4 bn will be raised in total through the public offering and private placement

$64.4 bn will be raised directly via the IPO, at the proposed share price range of $70-78

825 mn shares to be offered — 801.4 mn new shares and 23.6 mn from existing backers

$26 bn will be raised through private placement commitments from seven tech firms

Anthropic is seeking a fully diluted valuation of about $1.4 trillion in its initial public offering (IPO), in a bid to make history as the first frontier artificial intelligence (AI) lab to go public.

The Claude chatbot maker and its co-founders are seeking to raise as much as $90.4 billion in the IPO and a private placement. The base offering would raise up to $64.4 billion, with shares marketed for $70 to $78 each, according to a filing on Tuesday with the United States (US) Securities and Exchange Commission. Anthropic is offering 801.4 million shares, while backers are selling 23.6 million shares.

The figure also includes a private placement set to raise $26 billion in aggregate, to Advanced Micro Devices, Broadcom, Alphabet's Google, Micron Technology, Microsoft, Nvidia and Taiwan Semiconductor Manufacturing Co, the filing shows.

At the top of the price range, Anthropic would have a market value of about $1 trillion, based on the shares outstanding listed in the filing. Accounting for employee stock options, restricted shares and stock reserved for the company's charitable donation matching program, Anthropic would have a fully diluted value of about $1.4 trillion.

Anthropic's ambitious target, including the private placement, would hit roughly $100 billion when including a so-called over-allotment option or greenshoe, *Bloomberg News* calculations show. That would top SpaceX's $75 billion base offering, or the $86.2 billion it raised with the greenshoe.

The goal defies jitters from a sharp selloff in AI-related stocks last week, driven by expectations that politicians promising tougher regulation of data centres and related infrastructure will drive up costs and limit development of the technology.

Investors are under pressure to decide whether valuations in AI reflect a plausible trajectory for a technology that many expect to transform the economy and society as a whole, or overconfidence in an investment theme that hasn't yet proven its staying power.

The widespread adoption of Claude Code and rival tools by software developers point to the potential transformation of a wide range of professional activity, from discovering new miracle drugs to navigating complex legal and accounting rules to running a factory. Already, more than 90 per cent of contributions to Anthropic's code base were written by Claude, the filing shows.

Anthropic has introduced so-called vertical solutions in these areas, with particular emphasis on healthcare and life sciences. It counts Novartis Chief Executive Officer Vas Narasimhan as one of its board members.

The company's seven co-founders, including Chief Executive Officer Dario Amodei, are offering 3.38 million shares each in the IPO, the filing shows.

The IPO is set to price on Wednesday, November 18 and trade the following day, according to terms of the deal reviewed *Bloomberg*.

FBI probing Huang affair with 'Chinese agent', says Trump

AGENCIES
10 November



"I SUPPORT THE INVESTIGATION AND WILL COOPERATE FULLY. I LOVE OUR COUNTRY AND OUR COMPANY"

Jensen Huang, CEO, Nvidia

United States (US) President Donald Trump said Monday that the Federal Bureau of Investigation (FBI) is investigating Nvidia Chief Executive Officer (CEO) Jensen Huang's affair with an alleged Chinese government agent, but said he doesn't think the executive who has helped to develop artificial intelligence has a reason to worry.

"I know the FBI is looking into it in terms of something else, and I think that he'll be in good shape," Trump said. "I did speak to him today just to see if he's feeling all right, how you're doing," he added.

Trump suggested the step of directly involving himself in a counterintelligence investigation, a sign of his friendly relationship with Huang and the possible geopolitical stakes.

"I support the investigation and will cooperate fully. I love our country and our company. I am committed to protecting Nvidia and supporting America's national security," Huang said.

Nvidia and Jensen Huang were sued on Monday in a proposed class action accusing them of defrauding shareholders by concealing Huang's ties with a suspected Chinese spy. According to a complaint filed in federal court in San Jose, California, the defendants misled shareholders about Huang's alleged affair with Alice Huang and did not disclose that the matter raised national security concerns that threatened Nvidia's reputation.

US mediates Russia-Ukraine talks in Abu Dhabi

Kyiv vies for security guarantees; Moscow demands a broader European security framework

REUTERS
10 November

PHOTO: REUTERS



Jared Kushner, US Special Envoy for Peace , and UAE's Foreign Minister Sheikh Abdullah bin Zayed at the trilateral meet

Russian and Ukrainian officials met in Abu Dhabi on Tuesday for their first peace talks since February as United States (US) President Donald Trump's envoys launched a new push to end the war in Ukraine.

The US-brokered meeting followed US contacts with both sides in recent weeks that Trump's representative Jared Kushner said had narrowed the gaps between their positions.

Addressing delegates at the start of the meeting, Kushner said the US had some good ideas on how to make progress, and Trump was committed to achieving peace.

"He really has asked us to put extra effort into trying to find a solution that hopefully ends the war but also leaves both sides in a much stronger position" to realise their full potential, Kushner said.

Despite US optimism, the warring sides remain far apart on terms for a possible settlement, more than 4-1/2 years after Russia's full-scale invasion of Ukraine. Russia controls about a fifth of its neighbour's territory.

The first round of talks ended without any immediate statement from any of the parties. A second day of negotiations was scheduled for Wednesday.

Ukraine's chief delegate, Rustem Umerov, said in his opening remarks that Kyiv was focused on achieving security guarantees and a lasting peace.

Russian Foreign Minister Sergei Lavrov underlined Moscow's preference for negotiating a broad European security framework before tackling the specifics of the war.

"The idea of defining clear parameters for a future security architecture, and only then moving on to resolving the actual Russia-Ukraine conflict, is absolutely reasonable," he told reporters in Moscow.

European Commission President Ursula von der Leyen on Monday voiced the opposite view, saying wider security talks should come only after a ceasefire.

Lavrov again rejected the notion of a truce, saying the Europeans were trying to secure breathing space for Ukraine.

The new American drive for a deal has galvanised European officials into pushing for a place at the table to seek an end to Europe's deadliest conflict since World War Two.

Before the start of the main meeting, the Ukrainians met separately with European, North Atlantic Treaty Organization (Nato) and European Union representatives and the two American envoys, Kushner and Steve Witkoff. France said there could be no lasting peace in Ukraine without addressing European security.

Iran war is 'effectively over', says Trump after Qatar meet

REUTERS
10 November

United States (US) President Donald Trump on Monday told reporters he believes the war in Iran "militarily is effectively over," suggesting that — at least for now — he's not prepared to resume the bombardment that caused reverberations across the global economy.

The president made a surprise visit to the White House briefing room after meeting earlier in the day with Qatar's Prime Minister, Sheikh Mohammed bin Abdulrahman bin Jassim Al Thani.

"Iran militarily is effectively over," Trump said. "We're just keeping it the status quo."

He added that Iran has been "decapitated" but said he is still looking to make sure there's a long-term solution to ensuring that Iran's nuclear programme is defanged. It was some of Trump's most definitive comments about moving away from his threat to resume strikes on Iran after the US midterm elections had passed.

The president's Republican Party lost both chambers of Congress to Democrats in last week's elections. The elections were shadowed by dissatisfaction among the American electorate over the eight-month-old war, which has led to a surge in fuel prices that's impacted nearly ever sector of the global economy.

Trump, over the course of the conflict, has repeatedly said he is on the cusp of ordering US forces to escalate attacks if Iran's leaders don't quickly agree to US terms to end the war, only to back down. In earlier cycles, he has also edged away with a last-minute declaration, sometimes at the behest of Gulf allies, that he's going to give diplomacy more time.

In a posting on social media shortly before speaking to reporters, Trump once again asserted that West Asia allies — Qatar, Saudi Arabia, UAE, Bahrain, Kuwait and others — "would prefer the status quo."

No need for major combat operations on Iran: Rubio

United States (US) Secretary of State Marco Rubio said on Tuesday that he told G7 allies that the US economic sanctions and naval blockade are working so well that President Donald Trump does not need to conduct major combat operations in Iran.

Speaking to reporters in Paris after two days of meetings with G7 allies, Rubio repeatedly pushed back on the assertion that not returning to military action would amount to a stalemate or status quo.

"The economic pain that is being inflicted on Iran right now is extraordinary and it compounds. It's growing every day," Rubio said.

He added that Trump has also received input from regional allies in West Asia confirming this assessment. REUTERS

Hegseth calls moves to impeach him a farce

REUTERS
10 November

United States (US) Defense Secretary Pete Hegseth on Tuesday called an effort to impeach him over abuse of power in the Iran war a farce and sabotage that plays into the hands of adversaries.

Hegseth made the comments at a news conference a day after US Representative Thomas Massie, a Kentucky Republican, introduced eight articles of impeachment against him. In his first Pentagon news conference since May, Hegseth said past impeachments of President Donald Trump had ultimately failed and added:

"Both times he came back stronger, and the American people sent him back to the White House. Now they're trying a third time. This time against a member of his cabinet. "They will fail again, and if standing with President Trump puts me in that company, I'll take that company every day of the week." "This is not patriotism. This is sabotage," he said. "This process hands our adversaries a propaganda victory."

Referring to the Iran war, he said: "I stand beside every one of these operations. I was proud to execute them, and I would do it again tomorrow."

In a post on X, Massie said the House would hold a first vote on Tuesday on a procedural motion to kill the resolution.

"If we can overcome that effort, we will proceed to a real debate and vote on the Articles of Impeachment," he said.

John Harrison becomes first 'bona fide' sci-fi Booker Prize winner

ALEX MARSHALL
10 November

When M John Harrison began his writing career, in the 1960s, he sometimes spoke with other science fiction (SF) writers about the genre's poor reputation.

"Why shouldn't a well written SF be considered to be literary fiction?" he recalled asking, during a recent *BBC* interview.

Some 60 years later, the idea that sci-fi writing cannot hit heights of literature has long disappeared. And on Monday, Harrison's *The End of Everything*, a novel that imagines aliens overrunning Britain, won the Booker Prize, the prestigious literary award. Gaby Wood, the prize's chief executive, said in a news release that it is "the first Booker winner to have emerged from the bona fide SF world," as opposed to past winning books by authors like Margaret Atwood and Kazuo Ishiguro that "borrowed facets" of science fiction.

The classicist Mary Beard, who chaired this year's judging panel, said that Harrison had written a deft novel "that turns you upside down, raises a wry smile — and surprisingly, given the subject matter, leaves you with a twinge of optimism."

"I really didn't expect to be up here this evening, I honestly didn't — here at the end of everything. But here I am," said a visibly shaken Harrison — who, at 81, is the oldest author to win the Booker — when accepting the award.

In the novel, aliens called the iGhetti have taken over Britain. Harrison's main character is a beachcomber who finds an alien "artefact" in the surf, then travels around the coast as it grows. At times, he tries to get rid of it; at others, he seems to bond with it. No one around him knows what the iGhetti want, or even how they arrived.

"Most popularly, they were seen as having 'come out of the internet,'" Harrison writes. "Indeed, this was the favored theory of the internet itself; the medium still firmly — if a little desperately — casting itself as the message."

While drawing on certain themes that are mainstays of science fiction — like apocalyptic disaster, dystopian life and human-alien contact — *The End of Everything* largely resists the conventions of the genre. Harrison, for example, dispenses with much of the world-building that anchors readers in unfamiliar worlds, opting instead for ambiguous and sometimes conflicting descriptions that constantly throw the reader off balance.

PHOTO: NYT



At 81, M John Harrison is the oldest Booker winner

Jury lauds *The End of Everything*

"TURNS YOU UPSIDE DOWN, RAISES A WRY SMILE — AND SURPRISINGLY, GIVEN THE SUBJECT MATTER, LEAVES YOU WITH A TWINGE OF OPTIMISM"

Mary Beard,
Chair of the 2026 Booker Prize judging panel

"FELT LIKE MEETING THE REST OF YOUR LIFE"

Patricia Lockwood,
Booker Prize judge

Harrison has said in interviews that he started his novel as an attempt to write "a novel about the failure of explanation in society".

Harrison's novel won over two higher profile titles from past Booker winners: Marlon James's *The Disappearers* and Douglas Stuart's *John of John*. Elizabeth Strout's *The Things We Never Say*, Luke Kennard's *Black Bag* and Rebecca Perry's *May We Feed the King* were also finalists.

Patricia Lockwood, who was one of the judges of this year's prize, said she hadn't known who Harrison was before picking up his novel, but that reading his work felt "like meeting the rest of your life." "I've read it five times," she added. "I've written two essays about it, and a poem."

One of literature's major awards, the Booker Prize is awarded annually to the book selected by a panel of judges as the best novel written in English and published that year in Britain or Ireland.

Although relatively unknown in the United States, Harrison has long won acclaim in Britain with critics, some of whom have called him "the best writer you've never heard of." John Self, in a review of *The End of Everything* for The *Times of London*, said Harrison has "been writing confounding, brilliant books for more than 50 years," starting with his 1971 debut, *The Committed Men*.

Born in Rugby, England, in 1945, Harrison fed his growing love of literature while skipping school and reading novels in his local library. In the mid '60s, he began publishing stories in science fiction magazines.

Although science fiction fans are likely to celebrate Harrisons's Booker win, the framing of his victory might annoy Harrison himself. "I don't represent a category — I'm me," he said at a news conference held after the ceremony on Monday. "Genre cripples you as a writer," he added. "You limit your audience, and I don't want to do that. I want to talk to anybody, everybody."

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Business Standard
VOLUME XXXIII NUMBER 177
NEW DELHI | WEDNESDAY, 11 NOVEMBER 2026

Checks and balances

India should be prepared for AI-led investment volatility

The Democratic Party's resounding victory in last week's midterm elections in the United States (US) could have significant implications for the pace of development in artificial intelligence (AI). This was also reflected in the sharp correction in stock prices of AI-related companies. Although stocks have partially recovered, the tech-heavy Nasdaq Composite Index is still down over 7 per cent, compared to the level a month ago. Several of the elected Democrats, both in Congress and in gubernatorial offices, have spoken against the pace of AI development. One of the concerns is the ongoing investment in data centres, which put pressure on local resources like water and power. According to one of the poll findings, over 50 per cent of the American voters said that data centres were a crucial or major factor determining their congressional vote. Several local governments have reined in the construction of data centres, and such measures are likely to be adopted more widely in the US. There could also be closer scrutiny of AI development in general at the Capitol.

Although other factors such as the Iran war, which pushed up fuel prices considerably, contributed to the election outcome, there seems to be a genuine concern over AI and data centres among Americans. This could have various implications for the sector, and the impact of a possible policy shift will not remain limited to the US. One view is that greater scrutiny and opposition to data centres will drive investment away from the US and towards other countries, such as India, which should be prepared to attract such investment. It is possible that some of the investment may indeed come to India. However, it is worth debating whether India is in a position to absorb such water- and power-guzzling investment. Given that India is still in the early stages of building its own data-centre capacity, it would be prudent to have a clear water- and power-usage policy for such projects.

Besides, from India's point of view, the AI story is not limited to data centres. One of the stated reasons for capital outflows from India in recent periods was increasing investment all over the world in AI and related areas. Since India is not a major player in AI, it faced difficulties in attracting capital. It was also argued that once investment in AI peaked or slowed, foreign capital would again start coming back to India. Indeed, foreign portfolio investors (FPIs) have made significant investment in India over the past few days. In November, they bought stocks worth over ₹53,000 crore net, though part of this purchase could also be explained by a correction in oil prices. How long this trend sustains needs to be monitored by both market participants and policymakers.

It is likely that AI investment in the US may not stop, but could slow. It is worth remembering that trillions of dollars have been invested in this area, and, of late, a large part of it has been financed by debt and other complex instruments that are not easy for the markets to follow. If investor expectations begin to shift significantly, it could lead to a substantial decline in valuation with wider implications for all kinds of financing instruments. Investors are buying credit-default swaps to protect their investment in large tech companies. A significant increase in risk aversion or an unwinding of AI trades could lead to substantial volatility in global financial markets, if not a full-blown crisis. In such situations, capital tends to flow out of emerging markets. Given that India needs foreign investment to finance its current-account deficit, policymakers need to be prepared for such a possibility.

Data drive

More steps needed to improve official data collection

The Union Cabinet's recent approval of the ₹4,371 crore Viksit Bharat Initiative for Statistical Transformation, Analytics and Research (VISTAR) recognises that India's statistical infrastructure must keep pace with the changing economy. It needs information that is timely, reliable, comparable, and granular enough to capture differences across sectors and regions. VISTAR, which will run from 2026-27 to 2030-31, offers an opportunity to address longstanding weaknesses. The case for more frequent data collection is particularly strong at subnational level. A study published by the Reserve Bank of India (RBI) in its October 2026 bulletin illustrated the problem. Official annual gross state value-added estimates typically become available with a significant lag, limiting the ability to track regional economic conditions. The study developed a framework for estimating quarterly growth in Gujarat, Maharashtra and Karnataka by combining satellite-based night-time lights with Google Trends data. Changes in luminosity offer a proxy for economic activity, while online searches relating to jobs, consumption, credit and housing provide behavioural signals. Such approaches cannot replace official estimates, but show how alternative sources can bridge information gaps.

VISTAR's proposed expansion from 43 to 59 surveys during the 16th Finance-Commission cycle is significant. So are the planned headline index of services production and the index of unincorporated sector enterprises. The eighth economic Census, covering non-farm establishments and workers down to gram panchayat and ward levels, could provide a more comprehensive picture of the enterprise landscape. Its proposed National Statistical Business Register could offer a sampling frame for future surveys. The proposed use of mobile-phone records, scanner data, and ecommerce information is another promising feature. These sources can provide frequent signals and reduce the burden on respondents. Artificial intelligence and machine learning could assist data processing, validation and analysis, while common standards and sharing protocols could reduce duplication across departments.

However, technological sophistication should not be mistaken for statistical quality. Digital transactions and online searches do not represent all households or businesses; night-time lights, too, are an imperfect proxy for production. Estimates derived from such sources must be tested against representative surveys, while making methods, limitations and revisions transparent. Privacy safeguards must also govern the use of personal and commercially generated data. Equally important is the support for strengthening the statistical component. National estimates depend on the quality of information collected and compiled by states. Support for district-level and million-plus city estimates, state- and district-level gross domestic product, and state-level industrial production could reveal disparities concealed by state or national averages. Efforts must be made to build lasting capacity at different levels. VISTAR should also create opportunities for researchers to examine data, test methods, and develop indicators. Wider access to machine-readable datasets, subject to privacy protections, and timely publication of survey results would encourage independent scrutiny and strengthen public confidence. Better data collection and dissemination will help both policymakers and businesses to make informed decisions and improve outcomes.

Did delicensing boost growth?

Three decades after 1991, it is clear India needs a new policy approach

ILLUSTRATION: BINAY SINHA



The year 1991 is seen as a key point of transition in the Indian economy, from its earlier preference for the public sector to the promotion of the private sector. A popular explanation for this change is the removal of the industrial licensing Act in 1991. There is a widespread belief that this delicensing accelerated economic growth. How correct is this belief?

The shift from the public to the private sector has certainly taken place, not just in manufacturing but also in infrastructure. The share of the public sector in manufacturing investment had started declining from 1980-81, when it was around 40 per cent, to 24 per cent in 1991-92, owing to some early liberalisation moves. The decline in the public sector's share in manufacturing investment continued thereafter, falling further to 8 per cent in 2023-24. This is one measure of the shift from the public sector to the private sector.



NITIN DESAI

The other shift came in infrastructure development, with the private sector being promoted as the supplier of electricity, the constructor of roads, and the manager of airports and seaports. Because of this, there was a decline in the share of public-sector investment in infrastructure from around 69 per cent in 1991-92 to 44 per cent in 2023-24.

Did this shift from the public to the private sector accelerate manufacturing growth? The answer regrettably is that it did not do so. The share of manufacturing in gross value added (GVA), at current prices, rose from about 12 per cent in 1950-51 to 18-19 per cent by the mid-1990s, fluctuated a little and stayed at that level till 2010-11. It has since declined steadily to reach 14 per cent by 2024-25. The share of manufacturing in total investment has also fallen from 41 per cent in 2011-12 to 32 per cent in 2023-24. The percentage share of manufacturing in employment remains at 10-11 per cent. Only three Indian companies figure in the list of the top 100 non-US companies by market capitalisation. Frankly, the delicensing done in 1991 has not accelerated the contribution of manufacturing to growth.

Delicensing has had some impact on the advance of newcomers. It has also facilitated a major expansion of conglomerates — Tata, Reliance, Aditya Birla and Adani have expanded rapidly, with their market cap going up massively. The notable ones being a 1000-fold increase in the market capitalisation of Reliance and the emergence of Adani.

They have diversified their investment into a variety of mostly low-medium technology areas, including retailing. They do not have a substantial presence in the global economy. Some part of their expansion, particularly in infrastructure, is a product not of delicensing but of active support from the government. Government support for specific companies has not been eroded by delicensing.

If we look at emerging countries that have done well with exports and technology development, we find large firms that are specialised in a few areas rather than conglomerates with widely diverse activities. China is a remarkable example. In the early 1990s, the difference between India and China in terms of their share of manufacturing was marginal. Today, China's manufacturing output is nearly 10 times that of India's and includes a significant share of high-technology products. China has 17 companies in the list of top 100 non-US market companies, and many of them were new starters. The big difference between China and India lies in our much weaker performance in new technologically-led startups.

Compared to delicensing, the opening up of the financial system to the private sector has had a greater impact on private sector development. Private-sector banks have increased their share of total bank advances from 17 per cent in 2004-05 to 39 per cent in 2024-25. Their share of total bank employees has also risen substantially, from 10 per cent to 43 per cent over the same period.

The other big change was the liberalisation of private mutual funds, which now have shot up to a level where they are managing ₹87 trillion of assets. These two developments, along with a substantial simplification of trading in shares, have led to a transformed financial system, with market capitalisation rising close to 120 per cent of nominal GDP.

The most substantive post-1991 change has been the extraordinary boom in the export of software services. India's software exports have grown from just $400 million in 1991-92 (less than 2 per cent of total exports) to $240 billion in 2025-26 — a 600-fold increase. They now account for 28 per cent of exports and employ around 6 million people. However, the software boom that fuelled export and employment growth now faces a major global challenge from artificial intelligence.

The foundation for this software services boom was laid in a 1981 landmark report by a committee headed by V Rajaraman that proposed concessions for the import of computers in order to facilitate software exports. This proposal was accepted in 1983, reversing an earlier policy that focused on protecting mainly public-sector companies producing electronic goods. This import liberalisation also facilitated computerisation in banking, air and rail reservations. But the big economic impact came with the rise in software exports, particularly after the special role that Indian enterprises had in making the software changes required to cope with the millennial change at the end of the century.

There were several reports on liberalisation in the pre-1990 era, and some were partially implemented. One far reaching one was the report submitted in 1979 by the Committee on Controls and Subsidies chaired by Vadilal Dagli and commissioned by Morarji Desai. The report criticised the industrial licensing system, arguing that it had ceased to serve the goals of national planning. It recommended a shift from physical output quotas to fiscal and financial instruments, called for the dissolution of the Controller of Capital Issues (CCI), and criticised subsidies on food and fertilisers. However, the report was shelved after a new government came to power following the 1980 elections, and several of its recommendations were implemented only after 1991.

The drive for liberalisation and strengthening growth prospects goes back to the 1980s, while the substantive implementation came after 1991. However, average GDP growth since 1991 has not been significantly higher than in the 1980s. We must also recognise that we have fallen short in two crucial sectors — agriculture and manufacturing — and need to rethink our policy approach to both. We must also recognise that post-1991 policies supporting the private sector have not done enough to improve the lives of lower-income groups and generate employment. Hence, we need to rethink policies today because the reforms of the 1990s are no longer sufficient.

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West Asia crisis and India's fiscal health

One of the casualties of the West Asia crisis has been the stress on oil-importing nations. Higher commodity prices, especially crude oil, have been transmitted, to varying degrees, into external account balances as well as inflation metrics, spurring rate hikes by several central banks, including India's Monetary Policy Committee (MPC). Another market concern stems from the widening fiscal deficit, potentially raising sovereign borrowing requirements.

While crude oil prices have yo-yoed through the year, the average price for the Indian basket of crude oil in the financial year so far (up to November 6, 2026) stands at about $102 per barrel. This would result in adverse outcomes via multiple channels, although the recent cooling in oil prices following the mid-terms in the United States, if sustained, may provide some much-awaited respite.



ADITI NAYAR

The oil & gas industry has been a key source of support for the exchequer, contributing as much as ₹4.8 trillion to the Government of India's (GoI's) finances, and another ₹3.4 trillion directly to the States' exchequers in 2025-2026. Together, this amounted to a sizeable 2.4 per cent of gross domestic product (GDP), equivalent to one-third of the estimated combined fiscal deficit of the GoI and the states. These cash flows are expected to come under stress in the ongoing financial year.

The GoI had already cut excise duty on petrol and diesel at the end of March 2026, giving oil marketing companies (OMCs) headroom to compensate for refining losses. With every ₹1/litre cut in such duties resulting in an estimated annual shortfall of ₹15,000 crore-16,000 crore, this measure would compress the GoI's excise duty collections in FY27, although this would be partly offset by measures to shore up revenues from fuel exports.

Despite this, and the hikes in the retail selling prices of petrol and diesel through May 2026, the OMCs incurred substantial losses during Q1FY27. The sector's contribution to the GoI in the form of corporation taxes and dividend income, which had amounted to about ₹59,600 crore and ₹25,700 crore, respectively, in FY26, is set to reduce in the ongoing fiscal.

Additionally, under recoveries of OMCs on LPG, which stood at ₹62,000 crore by end-June 2026, are expected to exacerbate. The estimated loss per domestic cylinder was ₹500 in Q1 FY27 and remained at ₹300/cylinder in September 2026. Cumulative losses are likely to rise further if elevated international prices persist without a commensurate increase in domestic selling prices or additional government compensation, over and above the ₹30,000 crore approved in August 2025.

Further, the surge in prices of key raw materials, including LNG, and finished fertiliser prices, along with the depreciation of the USD/INR pair, render the GoI's budgeted fertiliser subsidy amount of ₹1.71 trillion inadequate. Given the prevailing natural gas prices and international commodity prices, the subsidy requirement for the sector is expected to exceed the Budget Estimates by ₹0.8 trillion-1 trillion, and Icra expects the GoI to make additional allocations during the year.

Overall, these revenue and spending pressures are estimated to result in a material fiscal gap of about ₹2.9 trillion in FY27, equivalent to 0.7 per cent of GDP.

However, a couple of shock absorbers could assuage a part of the pain. First, the Customs duty hikes on gold and silver to 15 per cent from 6 per cent earlier could net the GoI about ₹50,000 crore in the financial year.

Secondly, the GoI had allocated ₹1 trillion towards the Economic Stabilisation Fund (ESF) as a part of its spending in FY26. Besides, the GoI's stake sale in IDBI Bank is set to fetch it ₹26,000 crore, which would take the miscellaneous capital receipts past the budgeted target of ₹80,000 crore for FY27.

With this, we expect the fiscal slippage to be limited to 20 basis points above the budgeted target of 4.3 per cent of GDP for FY27. Additionally, the GoI could choose to pare discretionary expenditure, including capital spending, to further curtail the fiscal slippage, although this may dampen economic growth and be a sub-optimal solution. We estimate such savings, or the gap between approved and actual expenditure, to have amounted to ₹1.6 trillion-1.7 trillion in FY26.

Regardless, fiscal slippage may not entirely manifest itself in higher market borrowings. Inflows under savings deposits, certificates and the Public Provident Fund have surged by 54 per cent in the first half of FY27, portending a considerable overshooting of the budgeted target on this front. This would provide some buffer to the GoI, even if bank deposit rates start to rise with the onset of the repo-rate hike cycle.

At present, we are pencilling in another rate hike from the MPC in December 2026, given the bleak outlook for food inflation. Subsequent hikes, if any, would take a cue from whether the crude-oil price eases further in the next few months, and its implications for the inflation outlook.

The writer is chief economist and head-research & outreach at Icra

The ideal and future-ready board

BOOK REVIEW

PROSENJIT DATTA

Shefaly Yogendra's slim book is a handy guide for serving and aspiring directors of corporate boards. It also provides plenty of guidance to institutions on the considerations that should go into constituting a future-ready board. While it deals with boards across the globe, its lessons are particularly relevant to India currently, given how spectacularly our boards and far too many eminent directors, both executive and independent, have failed to exercise the fiduciary duties expected of them. More on that later.

Ms Yogendra draws extensively from her experience as a director on multiple boards. Her first board experience was as an executive director who set up a Swiss subsidiary for its multinational parent. The job entailed setting up and registering a formal commercial and legal entity in Switzerland from scratch — and building a board compliant with a complex regulatory regime. Since then, she went on to serve on boards from companies ranging from multinational financial institutions to high-profile charitable trusts.

Along the way, she got to work with some exceptional board chairs as well as some poor ones, and some outstanding directors as well as some pedestrian ones. She had extensive conversations with them, and captured their stories and anecdotes that covered practically every gamut of company and board actions. She has distilled these insights in her book.

Slightly over half of the book is focused on her experiences with different boards. This is of immense use because she can give concrete examples for the points she makes. She uses case studies as well as short snippets to illustrate critical issues.

As her examples show, far too many boards, even at big companies, do not function the way they should. Boards are, after all, as good as the chair and the directors who have been chosen. Individual biases, ambitions, and foibles play a big role. In one example, she writes, the chair of the board had ambitions to be the CEO — which led to disaster.

For boards to function properly, you need directors who are not only good and willing to work as a team and conscious of the board's responsibilities but who also bring specific special knowledge, experience or attributes to the table.

In some cases, one abrasive director can create problems for the entire board. Equally, a board where everyone is focused only on getting along and not bringing up different viewpoints is not a healthy sign either. Dissenting opinions are important as long as they do not lead to personal differences between directors.

Some board members do not prepare for a board meeting properly. And in some cases, the management does not provide the board members with the information they need to take a proper view.

The latter part of the book focuses on issues that companies and boards will need to debate and deal with in the near future — that is, if they aren't already dealing with it. These include artificial intelligence (AI), the geopolitics of minerals and data, and rapidly changing global regulations — apart from war and similar issues.

The book could not have been timed better. Though it has few India-specific cases, reading it makes it easy to understand how dysfunctional and problematic some Indian boards can be — even when it comes to big companies. It also illustrates that illustrious professional careers do not guarantee a transition to good directors either.



Uncharted Spaces: Reset the Agenda, Reimagine the Boardroom
by Shefaly M Yogendra
Published by Practical Inspiration Publishing
208 pages ₹986

This book is an important reminder of the actual role of an ideal board. Unfortunately, the Indian boards in news today have not covered themselves with glory. The Tata Sons board has always been made up of extremely accomplished professionals. And yet, the board hardly acted professionally during the bitter ouster of the late Cyrus Mistry, chairman of Tata Sons. The remuneration committee of the board had lauded his performance and recommended a hefty higher compensation for him only four months before the entire board turned on him. Nor does the current Tata Sons board come out looking good in the strange episode when it decided to give a fresh five-year term to its chairman, disregarding its own precedents and going against the express wishes of the person heading the Tata Trusts, which holds over 65 per cent share of Tata Sons.

Nor is it an isolated case. At different times, Infosys' board of directors' have taken decisions that might have suited its cofounders (all minority shareholders) rather than the company's future. The boards of Satyam, IL&FS and Yes Bank allowed their promoters and managements to do as they pleased, with little scrutiny, ultimately leading to the companies' collapse.

The problem with this extremely readable book is that while one appreciates what a good board should be, a lot of the advice is difficult to put into practice. After all, in the Indian context, one strong person, either the promoter or someone else, manages to pack the board with cronies — and thus the directors, even if eminent men and women, rarely do the job they are supposed to.

The reviewer is former editor of *Business Today* and *Businessworld*, and founder of Prosaic View, an editorial consultancy

Business Standard NEW DELHI | WEDNESDAY, 11 NOVEMBER 2026

The Smart Investor

STREET VIEW

"The Anthropic IPO is key for the future of the artificial intelligence trade and the risk is asymmetric: A failure would really hit hard, while a success just means the trade can carry on"

Olivier David,
Portfolio Manager, Vega Investment Solutions



Customs duty hike takes the shine off organised gold trade

Grey market strikes gold as smuggling jumps more than 16-fold in Q3CY26

SHILPA RANGARAJAN & PRAVIN PALANDE
Mumbai, 10 November

The cinematic Eighties are back. Airports and other entry points are on high alert for unauthorised gold entering India.

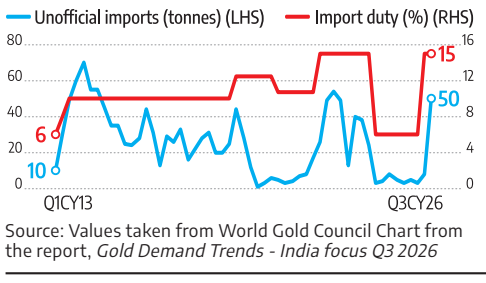
Gold smuggling rose to about 50 tonnes in the third quarter (July-September/Q3) of calendar year (CY) 2026, from about 3 tonnes a year earlier, after the government raised the import duty from 6 per cent to 15 per cent, according to the World Gold Council's (WGC's) Gold Demand Trends report for Q3 CY 2026. This is more than 16 times the volume recorded in the year-ago quarter and accounts for about 37 per cent of India's total gold supply of 136 tonnes during the quarter.

Net bullion imports, comprising both official and unofficial (smuggled) imports, totalled 114 tonnes, equivalent to around 84 per cent of supply. Official bullion imports fell to 64 tonnes, down 70 per cent from a year earlier. A kilogram (kg) of gold selling for about ₹1.40 crore in India carried an import duty of about ₹18.3 lakh. A smuggler evading the duty saves that amount, rising to about ₹22.5 lakh if the 3 per cent goods and services tax is also avoided.

Ashok Sonthalia, chief financial officer of Titan Company, told analysts during a November 5 call: "Since Customs duty increased, the Indian domestic gold market has been at a discount, and that gives a hint that there are channels which are active through which gold is also flowing into the country. No one has a good, correct estimate."

He further said the government would also review the Customs duty and "they will hopefully reduce that, so the grey channel attractiveness completely diminishes".

Unauthorised flows gain ground



Source: Values taken from World Gold Council Chart from the report, *Gold Demand Trends - India focus Q3 2026*

ILLUSTRATION: BINAY SINHA



Titan initially benefited from a windfall gain on gold purchased before the duty hike. But lower prices in the grey market are now hurting organised players across the industry.

Gold in India ended October at ₹1.39 lakh per 10 grams, down 5.3 per cent during the month and about 20 per cent below its record high of ₹1.75 lakh, hit on January 29, according to the WGC's October Gold Market Commentary. Prices in India are still up 5.4 per cent so far this year. Globally, gold ended October at $3,913 an ounce, down 6.3 per cent during the month and about 25 per cent below its January peak, the council said.

According to a *Deccan Herald* report, October saw the highest gold seizures, with 12 kg worth ₹18.38 crore recovered at one airport. In September, officials seized 8 kg worth ₹12.57 crore and made seven arrests.

"Gold has become inaccessible to buyers. There are controls on buying exchange-traded funds in the Indian market. But it is also the only dollar-denominated asset. Investors are going to figure out some way to buy gold, and it is not surprising to see that smuggling has gone up," said Sanjiv Arole, a senior bullion analyst. He added that higher duties eventually lead to smuggling, a pattern seen in the past.

A *Business Standard* analysis of 13 years of WGC and Reserve Bank of India data on gold prices shows that every 1 percentage point increase in import duty is associated with an average increase of 3 tonnes in quarterly gold smuggling. Between the July 2024 duty cut and the May 2026 hike, domestic gold prices roughly doubled, from about ₹71,500 to ₹1.51 lakh per 10 grams. Smuggling, however, remained between 3 and 8 tonnes a quarter. By contrast, between 2013 and 2019, when the import duty was 10 per cent and gold cost less than ₹33,000 per 10 grams, smuggling averaged about 34 tonnes a quarter.

The pattern has repeated itself. Smuggling peaked at about 70 tonnes in January-March 2014 following the 2013 duty hikes. It climbed to about 54 tonnes after the duty was raised to 15 per cent in July 2022. When the duty was cut in July 2024, smuggling fell from 24 tonnes to 3 tonnes within a quarter. The WGC report says gold in India traded at an average discount of $43 an ounce to its landed cost during Q3 CY 2026. This was the biggest gap on record. The council chalked up the discount to rising smuggling following the duty hike and sales of old jewellery.

Wall St slips as hot inflation data fuels rate-hike jitters

Brent briefly slips below $90; Nvidia down 4%

AGENCIES
10 November



Major global indices: A snapshot

	1-day chg %
Dow Jones	-0.5
S&P 500	-0.6
Euro Stoxx 50	0.9
Hang Seng	0.4
Kospi	4.4
Nikkei 225	2.9
Shanghai SE Composite	0.1
Taiex	2.5

Oil & Gold	Spot price	1-day chg %
Brent Crude ($/bbl)	90.1	-3.0
Gold ($/oz)	4,043.7	-2.3
Silver ($/oz)	57.1	-3.2

As of 8.16 pm IST — Source: Bloomberg

Wall Street's main indices retreated on Tuesday, pausing a two-day rebound in tech shares, after a hotter-than-expected October inflation reading reinforced fears that the Federal Reserve could keep interest rates higher for longer.

Earlier in the day, Fed Governor Christopher Waller said the central bank should raise interest rates by at least 25 basis points next month even if inflation cooled in October. If price pressures accelerated, policymakers should consider a half-percentage-point increase, he said. Traders are pricing in an almost 99 per cent chance of a hike in December, according to the CME FedWatch tool. "There are some fears that underlying price pressures are starting to build again. It creates some concern," said James McCann, senior economist at Edward Jones.

"Markets had been pricing out some of the Fed tightening in recent weeks. Now it's probably being forced to contemplate a bit more tightening."

At 09:47 a.m. ET, the Dow Jones Industrial Average fell 257.10 points, or 0.49 per cent, the S&P 500 lost 45.94 points, or 0.61 per cent, and the Nasdaq Composite lost 0.74 per cent. Among rate-sensitive sectors, financials rose 0.15 per cent, while utilities and real estate were among the laggards.

Shares of Nvidia, the second-most valuable company in the world, slipped 4.4 per cent. Jensen Huang's affair with Chinese businesswoman Alice Huang, alleged to be a spy for Beijing, facilitated the shipment of at least $7.5 billion worth of the company's chips through Chinese firms, The Information reported.

Brent crude futures fell over 3.2 per cent, dipping below the $90-a-barrel mark for the first time since late August, at $89.65 a barrel by 7.04 pm IST as investors pinned their hopes on possible peace talks between the US and Iran. US West Texas Intermediate futures fell $2.33, or 2.68 per cent, to $84.52.

The pan-European STOXX 600 was within 1 per cent of its all-time high as lower oil prices helped ease some of the inflation concerns that have been on investors' radar since the US-Israeli war with Iran erupted at the end of February.

South Korea's KOSPI rose 4.4 per cent, while Japan's Nikkei gained 2.9 per cent. MSCI's broadest index of Asia-Pacific shares pushed 2 per cent higher, moving away from the seven-month low it hit last week. Earnings reports due this week from tech companies will be another test for markets as investors fret about the cost of the AI buildout and its profitability.

DESPITE WEAKER EQUITY MARKET WEIGHING ON AUM GROWTH

Leading MFs' commission payout rose 12% in FY26

ABHISHEK KUMAR
Mumbai, 10 November

Commission payouts by large mutual funds (MFs) logged double-digit growth in financial year 2025-26 (FY26) despite equity market volatility weighing on their assets under management (AUM) growth and an increasing preference among investors for direct plans.

The 10 largest fund houses paid ₹16,551 crore in commissions in FY26, up 12 per cent compared to ₹14,797 crore paid out in FY25, shows commission disclosures by the asset management companies (AMCs).

Fund houses pay commissions to distributors based on the assets mobilised by them and retained in their schemes. The annual commission rate varies across schemes and can range from a few basis points (bps) to over 1 per cent of the assets, depending on the scheme. The disclosures show that commissions paid to sponsor banks or the largest distributors grew at a slower pace than overall payouts, as bank-sponsored fund houses continued to rely heavily on their parent banks' branch networks to sell their schemes.

SBI Mutual Fund paid ₹1,605 crore to its sponsor State Bank of India (SBI) in FY26, 10.4 per cent higher compared to FY25. Its overall commission payout rose 10.7 per cent to ₹3,159 crore in FY26. In the case of ICICI Prudential MF, the commissions to ICICI Bank rose 9.1 per cent to ₹379 crore vis-a-vis 17.5 per cent year-on-year (Y-o-Y) rise in total commissions to ₹2,783 crore.

HDFC MF paid ₹310 crore to HDFC Bank as commissions in FY26, up only 5 per cent. In comparison, its total commission payout rose 13.4 per cent to ₹2,471 crore. Kotak Mahindra Mutual Fund and Axis Mutual Fund also showed a similar trend.

Varied approach

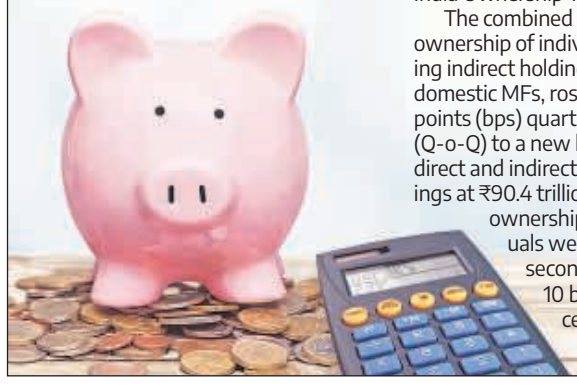
Some fund houses rely a lot on their sponsor/largest distributors, while others have a more diversified distributor mix

			Sponsor bank/ largest distributor		
Mutual Fund	Total commissions paid in FY26 (₹ cr)	Y-o-Y growth (%)	Name	Commission paid (₹ cr)	Y-o-Y growth (%)
SBI	3,159	10.7	State Bank of India	1,605	10.4
ICICI Prudential	2,783	17.5	ICICI Bank	379	9.1
HDFC	2,471	13.4	HDFC Bank	310	5.0
Nippon India	1,598	15.5	NJ IndiaInvest**	318	11.2
Kotak*	2,113	11.0	Kotak Mahindra Bank	142	8.5
Aditya Birla Sun Life	977	6.3	NJ IndiaInvest**	172	6.7
UTI	398	12.9	HDFC Bank**	29	84.9
Axis	1,221	2.0	Axis Bank	266	-5.0
DSP	871	17.1	NJ IndiaInvest**	178	17.3
Mirae Asset	960	6.9	NJ IndiaInvest**	80	16.6
Total	**16,551**	**11.9**		**3,479**	**9.0**

*Unlike other bank-sponsored AMCs, Kotak MF does not have its sponsor — Kotak Mahindra Bank — as its largest distributor. NJ IndiaInvest is its largest distributor and earned ₹321 crore (up 17% Y-o-Y) in gross commissions in FY 2026; **Largest distributor data considered as the AMC is not bank sponsored and other associate distributors have a small share in the total commissions

Source: Commission disclosure data from AMC websites

Individuals' combined ownership in NSE firms hits record 19.5%



Combined individual investors equity ownership in firms listed on the National Stock Exchange (NSE) rose to a record 19.5 per cent at the end of September quarter (Q2FY27), as households continued to add to their exposure through direct stock holdings and mutual funds (MFs), according to data from NSE's India Ownership Tracker.

The combined non-promoter ownership of individuals, including indirect holdings via domestic MFs, rose 26 basis points (bps) quarter-on-quarter (Q-o-Q) to a new high with direct and indirect equity holdings at ₹90.4 trillion. Direct ownership by individuals went up for a second quarter, up 10 bps to 9.6 per cent of the market in September, taking their holdings to ₹44.6 trillion.

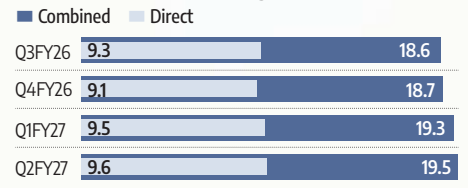
This is 20 bps below the post-pandemic peak of 9.8 per cent in December 2024.

The rise in direct ownership was backed by net purchases in the secondary market. Investors bought equities worth ₹42,700 crore in Q1FY27, a six quarter record, and net purchases of ₹4,900 crore in Q2FY27.

Whereas, FPI ownership in NSE-listed firms fell 38 bps Q-o-Q to 14.7 per cent in September, a 21-year low, below 15 per cent for the first time in 17.5 years. Total promoter ownership in such firms, rose to a seven-quarter high of 50.4 per cent in Q2FY27. "The increase was led by higher private Indian and foreign promoter holdings, partly offset by a dip in government share," the report noted. **KHUSHBOO TIWARI**

Combined Individual holdings at record high

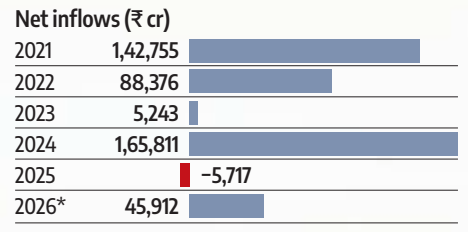
Individual investors' holdings (%)



Source: NSE India Inc Ownership Tracker

Net inflows by individual investors into NSE's cash market segment

Net inflows (₹ cr)



*(Jan–Oct); Source: NSE

THE COMPASS | DECODING MARKET DIRECTION

Attractive valuations could translate to gains in ONGC

DEVANGSHU DATTA

The Oil and Natural Gas Corporation's (ONGC's) standalone results for the second quarter of financial year 2026-27 (Q2FY27) were close to consensus at ₹43,900 crore. Crude oil and gas sales were at 4.4 million tonnes (mt) and 3.8 billion cubic metres (bcm), respectively.

This was lower than expected due to low production. However, oil prices averaged a high $92.3 per barrel (bbl). The standalone earnings before interest, taxes, depreciation, and amortisation (Ebitda) was above expectation at ₹26,300 crore, and adjusted net profit was at ₹15,500 crore.

Although dry well writeoffs and depreciation were high, they were offset by strong other income.

The Iran war and the blocking of the Strait of Hormuz have driven a price rally since February 2026.

Even if resolution of the conflict is possible after the US midterm results, crude oil prices would remain above $80-$85/bbl for another year or more, given damage in the region. This supports earnings for ONGC. On the policy front, the new oilfield regulations imply a low probability that new windfall taxes will be imposed.

In terms of production and capital expenditure (capex), ONGC awarded two western offshore development projects worth ₹11,800 crore—expected to unlock 22 mt of oil equivalent of hydrocarbons—alongside over ₹4,300 crore dedicated to replacing old undersea pipelines.

BP's (formerly known as British Petroleum) technical service provider (TSP) role has been extended to the entire Western Offshore, and TSP-1 has positive early results. The TSP role of BP across the entire Western Offshore may arrest decline in mature fields and speed up development.

Specific gains are hard to quantify but under the 10-year contract, ONGC hopes to achieve production upside.

The first well under the Samudra Manthan mission in the Mahanadi deepwater block is gas-bearing.

Two onshore discoveries were notified during Q2FY27. At KG-98/2, three gas wells will add 1.5 million standard cubic metres per day (mscmd) in Q4FY27.

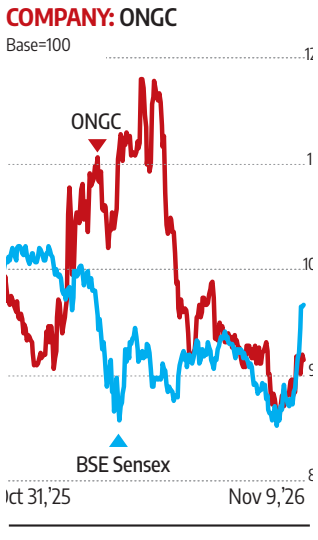
ONGC Petro additions or OPaL turned Ebitda-positive with ₹147 crore operating profit in Q2FY27 due to a rebound in petchem prices.

However, crude oil production declined 5 per cent and natural gas production fell 2 per cent year-on-year (Y-o-Y) due to a variety of technical reasons and disruptions at major consumer facilities.

The management is now guiding for FY27 production of 39 mt of oil equivalent, with only 0.5-1 mt of oil equivalent increase in FY28.

OPaL remains in net loss—Q2FY27 net loss of ₹494 crore—due to higher feedstock prices despite better realisations. OPaL should improve as feedstock prices stabilise.

COMPANY: ONGC



Venezuela legacy dues of around $500 million (roughly ₹5,000 crore) remain unresolved, with no profits repatriated.

According to the management, other expenses were up ₹600 crore, driven by a one-off provision of ₹1,561 crore for terminal excise duty receivable from the Directorate General of Foreign Trade (DGFT), which is under litigation.

The management is confident of winning the case but the provision is pending the court's decision.

The exchange losses were lower and dividend income was higher, the latter of which carried a tax benefit that lowered the overall tax impact. ONGC provided for impairment on 40 wells that had been carried for a long period in the depreciation.

The ONGC group has retired high-cost debt with a ₹18,000 crore infusion into OPaL. Interest costs are expected to ease.

Samudra Manthan will see four wells in FY27, and up to 13 in FY28, subject to rig availability in a tight, expensive market.

The mission is categorised as an exploratory scheme and while there are high expectations, the management cannot quantify benefits.

Two rigs have been hired, and ONGC is looking for more to complete 13 wells in FY28.

The rig market is charging very high rates, something that is driving up costs for completing Samudra Manthan wells in FY28. Wells due for completion in Q3FY27 were delayed by monsoon, and are expected to be completed in Q4FY27.

The Mozambique LNG is 49 per cent complete, with $7 billion invested so far. Force majeure was lifted last year, financing tieup is complete, and Mozambique's cabinet has approved sovereign guarantee.

Sakhalin-1 production is back near pre-2022 levels at 183,000 bpd (FY27 first half average) with no repatriation restrictions.

No ONGC money is stuck in Russia. In Venezuela, ONGC is in discussions with PDVSA, partners including Repsol, and the government for a new operating arrangement in two projects.

ONGC would be the sole operator at San Cristóbal and joint operator at Petrocarabobo.

The weakness in production is a serious concern since the company has been projecting higher production for many quarters now and failing to meet guidance.

This is leading many analysts to lower production estimates until FY28-end and, consequently, reduce Ebitda estimates as well.

But ONGC at current prices would be considered fair-value, with Brent crude prices of $62-65/bbl over the second half (H2) of FY27 and FY28.

This is well below likely Brent prices through the next six quarters and leaves room for share appreciation.

Downstream investments, including HPCL majority stake, and the OVL stake also add to the valuations.

Hence, there's a logical case for appreciation purely on valuations, despite ongoing concerns about production weakness.

The writer is a New Delhi-based independent journalist

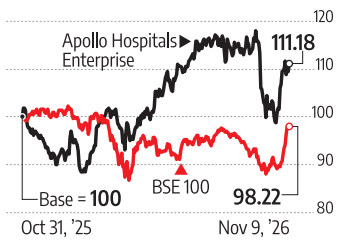
Brokerages see healthy gains in Apollo Hospitals

Q2 operating performance was robust despite new bed additions

RAM PRASAD SAHU
Mumbai, 10 November



Maintaining its lead



Financial scoresheet

	FY26 (in ₹ cr)	Y-o-Y chg %	FY27E (in ₹ cr)	Y-o-Y chg %	FY28E (in ₹ cr)	Y-o-Y chg %
Revenue	25,229	15.8	29,879	18.4	35,468	18.7
Ebitda	3,799	25.2	4,626	21.8	5,630	21.7
Net profit	1,898	36.3	2,464	29.8	3,129	27.0

E: Estimates, Ebitda: Earnings before interest, taxes, depreciation and amortisation
Compiled by *Business Standard* Research Bureau. Sources: Bloomberg,BSE

Apollo Hospitals Enterprise, the country's largest listed hospital chain, delivered a strong performance in the second quarter of the financial year (Q2FY27), supported by higher patient volumes and an improved case mix.

Its operating performance was also robust, with the chain managing to maintain margins despite adding new beds. Apollo is expanding capacity and expects to increase its overall bed count by around 60 per cent over the next five years. For the pharmacy business, maintaining financial performance beyond breakeven and navigating a proposed listing will be key catalysts. There is also potential for value unlocking in the health and lifestyle and diagnostics businesses over time. Most brokerages are positive about Apollo Hospitals' growth.

At ₹8,538, the stock has gained nearly 10 per cent over the past year and trades at 37–38 times its estimated FY28 earnings. The company's consolidated revenue grew 23 per cent year-on-year (Y-o-Y) in Q2FY27. About 85 per cent of analysts covering the stock have a "buy" rating, with a *Bloomberg* consensus target price of ₹9,868.

Hospital and pharmacy revenues rose 23 per cent each, while Apollo Health and Lifestyle Ltd (AHLL), the retail health care unit of the group, posted 20 per cent growth.

Apollo Hospitals' operating profit rose 29 per cent Y-o-Y though margin expansion was curbed by a 17 per cent jump in staff costs and a 24 per cent increase in selling, general and administrative expenses.

Operating margin improved 70 basis points Y-o-Y to 15.6 per cent.

Hospitals remained Apollo's most profitable segment, with a margin of 24 per cent, although this was down 60 basis points from a year earlier. Apollo HealthCo, which includes the pharmacy business and omnichannel digital health care platform Apollo 24/7, saw margins expand 174 basis points. AHLL's margins improved 480 basis points. In the hospital business, average revenue per operating bed increased 8 per cent Y-o-Y. Occupancy improved to 73 per cent from 69 per cent in Q2FY26.

Inpatient volumes rose 14 per cent Y-o-Y, while the average length of stay rose to just over three days. Apollo plans to add around 6,000 beds over FY27-31, expanding its current 10,000-bed network. The next major addition is likely to be 500 beds at its Gurugram facility in Q4FY27.

Choice Institutional Equities expects Apollo to sustain its strong growth, driven by hospital capacity expansion through FY29, 17 per cent growth in diagnostics, and steady pharmacy expansion supported by 20–30 per cent growth in digital orders. Deepika Murarka and Stuti Bagadia of the brokerage expect sustained revenue growth, operating leverage and margin expansion, supported by improving occupancy, higher clinical complexity, cross-selling and digital-physical synergies.

Choice has an "add" rating on the stock, with a target price of ₹9,600. HealthCo reported revenue growth of 23.5 per cent in Q2FY27, while operating profit margin improved 90 basis points Y-o-Y, excluding Apollo 24/7. Losses at Apollo 24/7 are declining and the business has reached breakeven at the operating level, the group said.

The scheme of arrangement with promoter entities is underway, paving the way for the vertical to list toward the end of FY27.

Elara Securities said HealthCo is improving, driven by margin expansion in the legacy business and reduced burn at Apollo 24/7. The vertical delivered steady growth — excluding the Cradle divestment — led by strong momentum in diagnostics and speciality care. Elara analysts led by Bino Pathiparampil retained an "accumulate" rating for the stock, with a target price of ₹9,470.

YOUR MONEY

What new motor insurance norms mean for you

HIMALI PATEL

A cheaper motor insurance quote may look like a bargain. But before you grab it, ask yourself: If you met with an accident, how much would you have to pay from your own pocket? From December 15, 2026, answering that question will become easier. Under a new four-layer framework introduced by the Insurance Regulatory and Development Authority of India (Irdai), buyers of motor insurance for private cars and two-wheelers will be able to see what each part of their policy costs and pick the optional covers they want.

Mandatory & optional covers
Under the new framework, third-party liability and owner-driver personal accident cover remain mandatory. You can choose whether to add occupant or pillion-rider liability; personal accident cover for occupants, pillion riders and other eligible persons; and own-damage cover.

Record your choices on the standard option form, which becomes part of the policy. At the point of sale, the insurer must give you a customer information sheet showing each section's cover and premium.

What buyers gain
Separate premiums for various sections will let you choose covers that suit your vehicle use, risks and budget. Uniform wording will make policies easier to compare across insurers.

The record of your choices will help establish what cover applies at claim time. "Clarifying the scope of passenger cover at the point of sale brings certainty to an issue that has led to litigation," says Raheel Patel, partner, Gandhi Law Associates.

Cheap cover can cost dearly
Cost-conscious buyers, especially two-wheeler owners, may buy only the mandatory covers. "A cheaper policy may eventually prove expensive if an accident occurs and the customer discovers that a particular risk was not covered," says Viral Bhatt, founder, Money Mantra.

Premiums may not change
The government will continue to fix the third-party premium, while insurers get to set the prices of optional covers. Dropping a layer may save money, while adding passenger liability and personal accident cover may increase the cost. The framework itself does not guarantee lower premiums. "If customers opt for broadly similar protection, the overall cost could be comparable, depending on insurer pricing and selected covers," says Bhatt.

Checks for new buyers
Read the option form before making your choices. "Customers should check the coverage and premium under each section before making their selection," says Minoo Mantri, executive vice-president, insurance, Anand Rathi Share and Stock Brokers. The decision to drop certain covers should be taken thoughtfully. "Check what financial exposure you may be taking on by opting out of certain covers," says Arun Ramamurthy, cofounder, Staywell.Health. If you regularly carry passengers, consider liability and personal accident cover.

Remove unwanted optional covers. "Ask the insurer to remove them and deduct the corresponding premium," says Pranjita Barman, partner, Cyril Amarchand Mangaldas.

Keep third-party cover active to meet the legal requirement for driving and retain own-damage cover for comprehensive coverage, especially in the case of a new or valuable vehicle. "Check the insured declared value (IDV), deductibles, add-ons and exclusions, and assess the insurer's claims servicing record," says Ramamurthy.

What to review at renewal
If you renew on or after December 15, 2026, review all four layers. Consider the vehicle's age and value, how you use it, and who travels in it. Consider occupant liability and personal accident cover. "Both may be useful if you carpool frequently," says Barman. This cover does not apply to commercial arrangements. To add occupant or pillion-rider liability cover mid-term, pay the additional premium to the insurer that issued your third-party policy. "Your existing third-party cover can continue. The endorsement specifies the date and time the added cover begins," says Mantri.

The writer is a Mumbai-based independent journalist

Mistakes to avoid

- Don't drop own-damage or occupant cover without weighing the risk
- Don't tick options without reading their coverage, exclusions and conditions
- Don't keep paying for unwanted covers added by default
- Don't assume cover added mid-term is active before the endorsement's start date and time
- Don't discard the option form, Customer Information Sheet, policy schedule or endorsements

Tax checks to run before accepting a job for higher salary

About to switch jobs for a higher salary? You must check the tax implications. A higher cost to company (CTC) may not translate into a higher take-home. Also, salary from both employers in the same financial year is considered while calculating total taxable income.

Five things to check:
1. Share details of your previous salary and tax deductions with the new employer through Form 122 under the Income Tax rules, 2026. This ensures correct tax deduction at source (TDS) and reduces the risk of an additional tax liability.
2. Calculate liability under both the old and new tax regimes. The old regime allows eligible deductions such as those on specified investments and house rent allowance, while the new regime offers lower tax rates but fewer deductions.
3. Review basic pay, allowances, employer's provident fund contribution, gratuity and performance-linked bonuses. They can affect taxable income and monthly take-home pay.
4. Examine whether your existing investments qualify for deductions under the chosen tax regime. Do not assume declarations submitted to your previous employer will automatically carry forward.
5. Account for pending salary, bonuses and leave encashment from your previous employer. Reconcile TDS details with Form 16, Form 26AS and the Annual Information Statement.

Compare the post-tax salary rather than relying on the CTC.

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बैंक ऑफ़ इंडिया Bank of India

Branch:- Haldwani

Appendix- IV (See rule-8 (1)) **POSSESSION NOTICE** (For Immovable property)

Whereas The undersigned being the authorized Officer of Bank of India under the Securitization and Reconstruction of Financial Assets and Enforcement of Security Interest Act, 2002 (Act No. 54 of 2002) and in exercise of powers conferred under Section 13(12) read with rule 3 of the Security Interest (Enforcement) Rules, 2002 issued demand notices on the dates mentioned against account (details of which have been mentioned below) calling upon the following borrower to repay the amounts mentioned in the notices within 60 days from-the date of receipt of the said notices. The borrower having failed to repay the amount, notice is hereby given to the borrower and the public in general that the undersigned has taken possession of the properties described herein below in exercise of powers conferred on him/ her sub-section (4) of Section 13 of the Act read with rule 8 of the Security Interest (Enforcement) Rules, 2002 on this mentioned the date. The borrowers in particular and the public in general is hereby cautioned not to deal with the property and any dealings with the property will be subject to the charge of **Bank of India** for notice amounts and interest thereon. The borrowers attention is invited to provisions of subsection (8) of Section 13 of the Act, in respect of time available, to redeem the secured asset.

Sl. No.	Name of the Borrower /Guarantor	Description of the Immovable Property	Date of Demand Notice	Outstanding as per Demand Notice	Date of possession
1.	**Branch: Haldwani** **Borrower:** Mrs. Shakuntala Joshi and M/s Riddhisiya Polymer (Partner & Guarantor- Mrs. Shakuntala Joshi)	Property situated at khata no. 00367 (1426-1431), Khasra No.- 51 Min village jaulasaal alias Karayal, Tehsil Haldwani Distt. Nainital Uttrakhand, 126 sqm in the name of Mrs.Shakuntala Joshi W/o Amit Mohan Joshi. Bounded: On the North by: House of Pandey Ji, On the South by :House of vendor, On the East by: Remaining land of vendor, On the West by: 30 ft Road (9.14 m broad road)	20.06.2026	Rs.94,42,231.08 and interest thereon	09.11.2026

Date: 10.11.2026 **Place: Haldwani** **Authorised Officer, Bank of India**

MRF LIMITED
Regd. Office:114, Greams Road, Chennai 600 006
CIN: L25111TN1960PLC004306; Website: www.mrftyres.com, Email: mrfshare@mrfmail.com
Ph: 044-28292777, Fax: 28290562

(₹ Crores)

STATEMENT OF UNAUDITED CONSOLIDATED FINANCIAL RESULTS FOR THE QUARTER AND HALF YEAR ENDED 30TH SEPTEMBER, 2026

Sl No.	PARTICULARS	Quarter ended 30.09.2026	Half Year ended 30.09.2026	Quarter ended 30.09.2025
		Unaudited	Unaudited	Unaudited
1	Total Income from operations	8,660.19	17,075.69	7,378.72
2	Net Profit for the period (before Tax, Exceptional and/or Extraordinary items)	521.81	1,171.50	700.45
3	Net Profit for the period before tax (after Exceptional and/or Extraordinary items)	521.81	1,171.50	700.45
4	Net Profit for the period after tax (after Exceptional and/or Extraordinary items)	386.99	882.34	527.43
5	Total Comprehensive Income for the period[Comprising Profit for the period (after tax) and Other Comprehensive Income (after tax)]	417.19	896.44	540.13
6	Paid up Equity Share Capital	4.24	4.24	4.24
7	Other Equity	-	-	-
8	Earnings Per Share (of ₹10/- each)			
	1. Basic (₹ Per share)	912.46	2,080.43	1,243.60
	2. Diluted (₹ Per share)	912.46	2,080.43	1,243.60

Key Unaudited Standalone Financial Information of the Company is as under :-

(₹ Crores)

Sl No.	PARTICULARS	Quarter ended 30.09.2026	Half Year ended 30.09.2026	Quarter ended 30.09.2025
		Unaudited	Unaudited	Unaudited
1	Total Income from operations	8,523.96	16,815.52	7,249.68
2	Net Profit for the period before tax (after Exceptional items)	498.13	1,122.67	682.41
3	Net Profit for the period after tax (after Exceptional items)	369.15	843.52	511.59

Note: a)The above financial results for the Quarter and Half year ended 30th September, 2026 were reviewed by the Audit Committee and approved by the Board of Directors at its meeting held on 10th November, 2026.

b)The above is an extract of the detailed format of Quarter and Half year ended 30th September,2026 Financial Results filed with the Stock Exchanges under Regulation 33 of the SEBI (Listing Obligations and Disclosure Requirements) Regulations, 2015.The full format of the quarter and half year ended 30th September,2026 Financial Results (Consolidated/Standalone) are available on the websites of The Bombay Stock Exchange ("www.bseindia.com") and National Stock Exchange ("www.nseindia.com") & on the Company's website at (URL: www.mrftyres.com/financial-results).The Same can be accessed by scanning the QR Code provided below:

For MRF LIMITED
RAHUL MAMMEN MAPPILLAI
Managing Director
DIN : 03325290

Place: Chennai
Date: 10th November, 2026

ARSS INFRASTRUCTURE PROJECTS LIMITED

Regd. Office : Plot No.: 38, Sector-A, Zone-D, Mancheswar Industrial Estate, Bhubaneswar, Odisha - 751010
Corp. Office : ARSS Mall, Plot no-40, Community Centre, Block-A,Paschim Vihar,Opp-Jwalaheri Market, New Delhi - 110063
E-mail : cs@arssgroup.in, Website: www.arssgroup.in, CIN: L14103OR2000PLC006230

EXTRACT OF UNAUDITED STANDALONE AND CONSOLIDATED FINANCIAL RESULTS FOR THE QUARTER AND HALF YEAR ENDED ON SEPTEMBER 30, 2026

Key numbers of Financial Results **(Rs. in Lakhs)**

Sl. No.	Particulars	Standalone						Consolidated					
		Quarter ended			Half year ended		Year ended	Quarter ended			Half year ended		Year ended
		30.09.2026	30.06.2026	30.09.2025	30.09.2026	30.09.2025	31.03.2026	30.09.2026	30.06.2026	30.09.2025	30.09.2026	30.09.2025	31.03.2026
		(Reviewed)	(Reviewed)	(Reviewed)	(Reviewed)	(Reviewed)	(Audited)	(Reviewed)	(Reviewed)	(Reviewed)	(Reviewed)	(Reviewed)	(Audited)
1.	Total Revenue from Operations	2,310.91	1,452.91	1,141.00	3,763.82	3,009.19	14,579.28	2,310.91	1,452.91	1,141.00	3,763.82	3,009.19	14,579.28
2.	Net Profit / (Loss) (before Tax, Exceptional and/or Extraordinary Items)	(896.58)	(1,093.12)	(415.98)	(1,989.70)	(11,932.88)	(11,847.24)	(897.87)	(1,094.13)	(417.55)	(1,991.99)	(11,938.43)	(11,853.54)
3.	Net Profit/(Loss) before Tax (after Exceptional and/or Extraordinary Items)	(896.58)	(1,093.12)	(322,734.60)	(1,989.70)	(334,251.50)	(355,260.30)	(896.47)	(1,087.46)	(322,702.72)	(1,983.92)	(334,221.51)	(355,119.73)
4.	Net Profit / (Loss) after Tax (after Exceptional and/or Extraordinary Items)	(806.96)	(1,095.64)	(322,770.03)	(1,902.60)	(334,322.51)	(355,498.04)	(806.85)	(1,089.98)	(322,738.15)	(1,896.82)	(334,292.52)	(355,357.47)
5.	Total Comprehensive Income [Comprising Profit / (Loss) after Tax and Other Comprehensive Income after tax]	(806.96)	(1,095.64)	(322,770.03)	(1,902.60)	(334,322.51)	(355,498.04)	(806.85)	(1,089.98)	(322,738.15)	(1,896.82)	(334,292.52)	(355,357.47)
6.	Equity Share Capital	9,011.85	9,011.85	1,511.85	9,011.85	1,511.85	9,011.85	9,011.85	9,011.85	1,511.85	9,011.85	1,511.85	9,011.85
7.	Earnings per share (of ₹10/- each) Basic & Diluted (Rs.)	(0.90)	(1.22)	(1,428.25)	(2.11)	(1,479.36)	(394.48)	(0.90)	(1.21)	(1,428.11)	(2.10)	(1,479.23)	(394.32)

Notes:

a) The above standalone & consolidated unaudited financial results of the Company for the quarter and half Year ended September 30, 2026 have been reviewed by the audit committee and approved by the Board of Directors of the Company at its meeting held on November 10, 2026. These results are being published in accordance with Regulation 33 of the SEBI (Listing Obligations and Disclosure Requirements) Regulations, 2015.

b) The above is an extract of the detailed format of the Statement of Standalone and consolidated unaudited Financial Results for the quarter and half year ended September 30, 2026 filed with the Stock Exchanges under Regulation 33 of the SEBI (Listing Obligation and Disclosure Requirements) Regulations, 2015. The full format of the Statement of Standalone and consolidated Unaudited Financial Results for the quarter and half year ended on 30th September, 2026 are available on the website of the Stock Exchanges - **www.bseindia.com & www.nseindia.com** as well as on the website of the Company - **www.arssgroup.in.**

http://arssgroup.in/PDF/QuarterlyResult/Board%20Meeting%20Outcome%2030.09.2026.pdf

Date : 10th November, 2026
Place : Bhubaneswar

-Sd-
(Dipti Ranjan Patnaik)
Chairman cum Managing Director
DIN : 00600887

NORTHERN RAILWAY

NOTICE FOR E-AUCTION

Senior Divisional Commercial Manager/FS, Delhi Division, Northern Railway, in terms of Railway Board letter no. 2022/TC(FM)/10/04 dated 13.06.2022, invites bids through **e-Auction module (www.ireps.gov.in) for the contract of Truck/Tempo/Cargo vehicles Parking cum management and Stacking of Parcels at both ends of Delhi Junction Railway Station i.e. towards Platform No. 16 & towards Machhali Godown and Platform no. 20** for a period of five years through E-Auction in IREPS module as per detail and schedule given below :

S. No.	Date & time of e-Auction	Assets to be auctioned
1.	17.11.2026 at 11:00 am	The contract of Truck/Tempo/Cargo Vehicles Parking cum management and Stacking of Parcels at Subzi Mandi (SZM) end of Platform No.16 with area measuring 394.64 square meters; And for only stacking of parcels at Kashmiri Gate end of Platform No.16 with area measuring 315.80 square meters at Old Delhi Junction Railway Station (DLI).
2.	18.11.2026 at 11:00 am	The contract of Truck/Tempo/Cargo Vehicles Parking cum management and Stacking of Parcels at Machhali godown with the area of 876.53 square meters and at Platform No.20 with area of 8736.55 square meters thus, total area measuring 9613.08 square meters at Old Delhi Jn. Railway Station (DLI).

Important notes: 1. For more information, requirement and various aspects regarding these e-Auctions, interested bidders are advised to visit **https://www.ireps.gov.in/html/helpdesk/learning_centre.html.** (E-Auction leasing section). **2.** Earnest Money Deposit (EMD): 10 % of the total contractual bid value to be deposited online during the auction. EMD of the successful bidder will be retained as Security Deposit. **3.** Railway Administration reserves the full and absolute rights to short terminate these contracts at any point of time and/or for taking any decision regarding the discontinuation/continuation of these contracts with modified/additional terms and conditions depending upon the situations. **3926/2026**

SERVING CUSTOMERS WITH A SMILE

IndusInd Bank

PNA House, 1st Floor, Plot No. 57 and 57/1, Street No. 17, Near ESIC Office, MIDC, Andheri (E), Mumbai- 400093

PUBLIC NOTICE

(Under Rule 3 (1) of Security Interest (Enforcement) Rules, 2002)

SUBSTITUTED SERVICE OF NOTICE U/s.13 (2) of SECURITISATION AND RECONSTRUCTION OF FINANCIAL ASSETS AND ENFORCEMENT OF SECURITY INTEREST ACT, 2002.

Notice is hereby given to the borrowers as mentioned below that since they have defaulted in repayment of the Credit facility availed by them from IndusInd Bank Limited (IBL), their loan credit facility has been classified as **Non-Performing Assets** in the books of the Bank as per RBI guidelines thereto. Thereafter, Bank has issued demand notices to below mentioned respective borrower under section 13(2) of the Securitization and Reconstruction of Financial Assets and Enforcement of Security Interest Act, 2002 (SARFAESI Act) on the last known addresses of the said borrowers thereby calling upon and demanding from them to pay the amounts mentioned in the respective Demand Notice/s within 60 days from the date of the respective Notice/s, as per details given below, together with further interest at the contractual rate on the below mentioned amount and incidental expenses, cost, charges etc. as stated in the said demand notices. However, the service is also being done by us by way of this publication as per Rule 3 of the Security Interest (Enforcement) Rules, 2002 (SARFAESI Rules)

Name and address of Borrower and Co Borrower/s	Description of the Secured Assets/Mortgaged Properties	Total Outstanding Dues (INR) as on below date*	Loan Account No.
1. Rakesh Bhagat S/o Sita Ram Bhagat 38881 UGF Gali No.08 Shanti Mohalla Old Seelampur Gandi Nagar Delhi Pincode: 110031 **Also At,** Rakesh Bhagat S/o Sita Ram Bhagat P. No-83/9, 3rd Floor (With Roof Right, Khasra No-1108/288-290 307, 1109/288, 190-307-291, And 1110/29-307-290-288, Gali No-9, East Azad Nagar, Shadara, Delhi, Pincode-110051 **...Borrower** 2. Sudhira Bhagat W/o Rakesh Bhagat 38881 UGF Gali No.08 Shantimohalla Old Seelampur Gandi Nagar Delhi Pincode: 110031 **...Co- Borrower**	**Description of the property:** Freehold Residential Third Floor with roof right Built on Property No. 83/9 area measuring 60 sq. Yard out of Khasra No. 1108/288-290-307, 1109/288-290-307-291 and 1110/29-307-290-288, Situated at abadi Gali No. 9 East Azad Nagar Krishna Nagar in the area of Village Ghondli Illaqa Shahdara Delhi-110051. (Hereinafter referred as "the Said Property") Four Corners of the said property: East: Other property, West: Gali, North: Other property, South: Other property	Rs. 29,10,808.51/- (Rupees twenty nine lakh ten thousand eight hundred and eight and fifty one paise Only) as on 18.06.2026.	DBHM04836 **Date of Demand Notice** 18/06/2026
1. Mr. Sunny Saini S/o Somdutt Saini 509/28, Lodhi Mandir ke samne, Shiv Shakthi Nagar, Meerut, Uttar Pradesh-250002. **Also At:** Mr. Sunny Saini S/o Somdutt Saini Khasra No 2426, Kasba Meerut, Mohalla Shiv Shakti Nagar, Meerut, Pincode- 250002 **...Borrower 2. Ms. Gango Saini W/o Somdatt Saini** 509/28, Lodhi Mandir ke samne, Shiv Shakthi Nagar, Meerut, Uttar Pradesh — 250002. **...Co- Borrower**	**Description of the property:** All the part and parcel of property situated at Land measuring 90 sq. yds., out of Khasra No. 2426, situated at Mohalla Shiv Shakti Nagar, Meerut, Uttar Pradesh with the following particulars : North : Land of other, East : Rasta 15 ft. wide, South : Rasta 18 ft. wide, West : House of Tyagi	Rs.12,03,651.29/- (Rupees Twelve Lakhs Three Thousand Six Hundred and Fifty One and Twenty Nine Paise Only)) as on 18/07/2026.	**Loan Account No.** DMM05040M **Date of Demand Notice** 20/07/2026

We hereby call upon the borrower stated herein to pay us within 60 days from the date of this notice, the outstanding amount of more particularly stated in respective Demand Notices issued, together with further interest thereon plus cost, charges, expenses, etc. thereto failing which we shall be at liberty to shall proceed against the above Secured Asset(s)/Immovable Property (ies) under Section 13(4) of the said Act and the applicable Rules not limited to taking possession and selling the secured asset entirely at the risk of the said borrower(s)/co borrower (s)/Legal Heir(s)/Legal Representative(s)at your own cost and consequences. Please note that as per section 13(13) of the SARAFESI Act, all of you are prohibited from transferring by way of sale, lease or otherwise, the aforesaid secured assets without prior written consent of the Bank. Any contravention of the said section by you shall invoke the penal provisions as laid down under section 29 of the SARFAESI Act and / or any other legal provision in this regard. Please note that as per sub-section (8) of section 13 of the Act, if the dues of IBL together with all costs, charges and expenses incurred by IBL are tendered to IBL at any time before the date fixed for sale or transfer, the secured asset shall not be sold or transferred by IBL, and no further step shall be taken by IBL for transfer or sale of that secured asset.

Date: 11.11.2026
Place: Delhi/NCR

Note: Kindly quote the Loan Agreement Number in all your further correspondence.

Sd/- For IndusInd Bank Limited, Authorised Officer

झारखण्ड सरकार
सूचना एवं जन-सम्पर्क निदेशालय

इच्छा की अभिव्यक्ति (Expression of Interest)
(2nd Call)

सूचना एवं जन–सम्पर्क निदेशालय, झारखण्ड, रांची द्वारा विभिन्न रेलवे स्टेशन पर अधिष्ठापित Digital Display Board के माध्यम से झारखण्ड सरकार के योजनाओं एवं उपलब्धियों का प्रचार–प्रसार करने का प्रस्ताव है। इस हेतु विभिन्न रेलवे स्टेशन का दर निर्धारण एवं एजेंसियों का चयन कर सूचीबद्ध किया जाना है। विभिन्न रेलवे स्टशनों के लिए Sole Right प्राप्त इच्छुक उमीदवारों / फर्मों से आवेदन आमंत्रित किया जाता है।

विभिन्न रेलवे स्टेशनों पर अधिष्ठापित Digital Display Board के माध्यम से प्रचार–प्रसार हेतु इच्छुक एवं योग्य एजेंसी सूचीबद्धता एवं विभागीय दर निर्धारण हेतु विहित प्रपत्र में निर्धारित तिथि तक ऑन–लाईन आवेदन समर्पित कर सकते है। इच्छुक एवं योग्य एजेंसी के पास उल्लेखित रेलवे स्टेशन का Sole Right/Authorization अथवा Agreement होना अनिवार्य है।

सूचना एवं जन–सम्पर्क निदेशालय, रांची द्वारा Digital Display Board के माध्यम से विभिन्न रेलवे स्टेशन के लिए दर निर्धारण एवं एजेंसियों का चयन हेतु दिनांक 18.11.2026 अपराह्न 01.00 बजे तक www.jharkhandtenders.gov.in पर ऑनलाईन आवेदन आमंत्रित किया जाता है। प्राप्त सभी आवेदनों को दिनांक 19.11.2026 के अपराह्न 01.00 बजे क्रय समिति के समक्ष समीक्षा की जाएगी।

इच्छा की अभिव्यक्ति के नियम एवं शर्तें www.jharkhandtenders.gov.in एवं prdjharkhand.in पर उपलब्ध है।

PR 393629 IPRD(26-27) D" **निदेशक**

UTTAR PRADESH GRAMIN BANK

(Scheduled Bank Owned by Government)
Information Technology Department
2nd and 3rd floor, NBCC Commercial Complex, Vardan Khand, Gomti Nagar Extension, Lucknow - 226010

TENDER NOTICE

Uttar Pradesh Gramin Bank invites :
Request for Proposal (RFP) for Supply, Installation and Maintenance of Sound Box devices (UPI QR) without Display
RFP ref no. GEM/2026/B/8181965 dated 03.11.2026
(Last date for receipt of the applications – November 25th, 2026 latest by 05.00 PM.)
Details are available under Tender Section on Bank's website: https://upgb.bank.in

Place: Lucknow **(General Manager)**

JHARKHAND URJA SANCHARAN NIGAM LIMITED

(CIN No. – U40108JH2013SGC001704)
GOVERNMENT OF JHARKHAND UNDERTAKING
OFFICE: General Manager (CRITL/O.E)
JUSNL Building, Kusai Colony, Doranda, Ranchi – 834 002 **(Jharkhand)**
(**E-mail**: cecritl.jusnl@rediffmail.com) **Website:** www.jusnl.in

e-Tender notice

e-NIT No. 673/PR/JUSNL/2026-27

Jharkhand Urja Sancharan Nigam Limited Invite Bids (to be submitted in the e-Procurement Portal) for the following works:

Name of work	Procurement of Thermovision Camera with Calibration & Servicing for the Period of 03 year after completion of warranty /guarantee period.
Estimated cost (Rs.)	Rs. 2,87,65,254.00 (Including All Taxes)
Earnest Money Deposit	Rs. 5,76,000/- On line mode only.
Delivery	Six (06) months
e-Tender fee	Rs. 11,800/- only including GST (online mode)
Start Date & Time of Download the Tender Documents	11.11.2026 at 4:00 PM
Start Date and time of upload of BID	11.11.2026at 5:00 PM
Pre Bid meeting	18.11.2026at 4:00 PM
End date and time of upload of BID	02.12.2026upto4:00 PM
BID Opening date for technical part	03.12.2026at 4:00 PM
BID Opening date for price part	Will be communicated
Procurement Officer and address for communication	General Manager, CRITL/Operation Efficiency, JUSNL Kusai Colony, Doranda, Ranchi – 834002

Detailed Invitation of Bids which includes instruction for submission of Bids and all other relevant information is available on http://www.jharkhandtenders.gov.in. Bidding Documents are also available online. Any details required in this regard can also be has from the office of the undersigned (+91-9430090855) during office hours.

The firms that technically qualify will be informed for date of opening for financial part of Bid.

Bidders are advised to note the minimum qualification criteria specified in bidding document. Interested bidders may participate in the bidding process as per instruction given in the bidding document.

OFFICER INVITING BIDS:

स्वहित एवं राष्ट्रहित में ऊर्जा बचावें। कृपया अपनी शिकयतों को 18003456570 (कॉल सेन्टर) पर दर्ज करायें।

Sd/-
General Manager (CRITL/O.E)
JUSNL, Ranchi

PR 393672 Jharkhand Urja Sancharan Nigam Ltd (26-27)_D

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जम्मू एवं कश्मीर ग्रामीण बैंक
JAMMU AND KASHMIR GRAMEEN BANK

Scheduled Bank Owned by Government

Ref. No: - JKGB/GAD/2026-27/6162 **Dated: 10.11.2026**

TENDER NOTICE

RATE CONTRACT FOR UPS SYSTEMS WITH SMF BATTERIES

Jammu and Kashmir Grameen Bank hereby invites sealed tender from eligible bidders for a Rate Contract regarding the Supply, Installation, Testing, and Commissioning (SITC) of 03 KVA and 05 KVA UPS Systems with Isolation Transformers, Sealed Maintenance-Free (SMF) batteries and battery stands at Branches/ Offices of the Bank across the UT of J&K and UT of Ladakh for a period of One (01) Year.

The detailed tender document containing eligibility criteria, technical specifications and terms & conditions can be downloaded from the Bank's official website **www.jkgrameen.bank.in** w.e.f **10.11.2026 to 01.12.2026**. For more information, visit **www.jkgrameen.bank.in**

Sd/-
HOD, General Administrative Department

Head Office: Near Fruit complex Narwal, Jammu-180006
Ph: 9797127377, Email: pdg.hoj@jkgb.bank.in

SBI STATE BANK OF INDIA

Home Loan Centre Etawah Branch : Shastri Chauraha, Etawah, Uttar Pradesh – 206001

POSSESSION NOTICE

[for immovable property Under Rule 8(1) of Security Interest (Enforcement) Rule 2002]

Whereas, the undersigned being the authorised officer of the State Bank of India under the Securitisation and Reconstruction of Financial Assets and Enforcement of Security Interest, Act 2002 (54 of 2002) and in exercise of powers conferred under Section 13(2) read with rule 8 & 9 of the Security Interest (Enforcement) Rules 2002, issued demand notices and calling upon the under mentioned borrowers/guarantors to repay the amount mentioned in the notice with further interest expenses and other charges, etc. thereon within 60 days from the date of said notice.

The borrowers/guarantors having failed to repay the amount, notice is hereby given to the borrowers/ guarantors and the public in general that the undersigned has taken possession of the properties described herein below in exercise of powers conferred on him under section 13(4) of the said act read with rule 8 of the Security Interest (Enforcement) Rules, 2002

The borrowers/guarantors in particular and the public in general is hereby cautioned not to deal with the property and any dealing with the property will be subject to charge of the State bank of India for amount mentioned in the notice with further interest, expenses and other charges etc thereon.

The borrower's attention is invited to provisions of sub-section (8) of section 13 of the Act, in respect of time available, to redeem the secured assets. **Account wise full description as under-**

S. N.	Name & addresses of the Borrower/ Guarantors Account	Description of the Properties Mortgaged	Outstanding Amount	Demand Notice Date / Date of Possession
1.	**Gajendra Singh Parmar S/o Ram Karan Singh Parmar & Smt. Kiran Parmar** R/o H.No.45 Ranveer Nagar, ITI Crossing Etawah-206001 **HOME LOAN ACCOUNT NO-33031426530**	**1. Property owned by Sri Gajendra Singh Parmar S/o Ram Karan Singh Parmar & Smt. Kiran Parmar** Registerd sale deed No -956 dated - 05.01.2024 Bahi no-1 Jild No-25949 Page no 321 to 350 Total Area 104.42 Sq mtr Situated At Stellar Jeevan Flat no.S-1001, Plot no. GH-03, Sector-1, Greater Noida, U.P. **Consolidated Boundry :- North by:** As per floor plan, **South by:** As per floor plan, **East by:** As per floor plan, **West by:** As per floor plan **2. Property owned by Sri Gajendra Singh Parmar S/o Ram Karan Singh Parmar** Registered sale deed no 4389, Dt 20.08.1992, Page No 263 to 372, Total Area 1800 Sq Ft, Situated at Mohalla House No 45, Ranveer Nagar, ITI Crossing, Etawah **Consolidated Boundry:-North by:** Plot No 46, **South by:** Plot No 44, **East by:** 5 Ft Wide gallery after that plot no 54, **West by:** Kaccha Rasta	**Rs. 20,32,796/-** +Int. (Rupees Twenty lacs thirty two thousand and seven hundred ninty six + Intt Only) -Any recovery thereafter as on 24.08.2026 and further interest from costs etc	**24.08.2026** **05.11.2026** **24.08.2026** **06.11.2026**

Date: 06.11.2026 **Place: Etawah** **Authorised Officer**

M.P. STATE ELECTRONICS DEVELOPMENT CORPORATION LTD.

State IT Centre, 47-A, Arera Hills, Bhopal-462011 (M.P.)
www.mpsedc.mp.gov.in, 0755-2518300, marketing@mpsedc.com

NOTICE FOR INDUSTRY CONSULTATION

Onboarding of Consent Manager(s) under the DPDP Act, 2023

Madhya Pradesh State Electronics Development Corporation Limited (MPSeDC), Bhopal, invites interested firms/agencies, technology providers and industry stakeholders to participate in an Industry Consultation on the proposed RFP for onboarding of Consent Manager(s) for Government of Madhya Pradesh in accordance with the Digital Personal Data Protection Act, 2023 and applicable DPDP Rules, 2025.

MPSeDC is developing various e-Governance solutions for Government departments and agencies, in which consent management facilities are envisaged to be implemented, wherever required, as per the provisions of the DPDP Act, 2023. As different departments and applications may require consent management services simultaneously, the proposed framework may provide for onboarding of multiple eligible Consent Managers.

The consultation will seek industry inputs on the proposed scope, onboarding/engagement model, technical architecture, interoperability, integration with Government applications, security, regulatory compliance, service levels and commercial framework.

Date of Consultation : 18.11.2026, Time: 03:00 PM
Mode : Online/Offline
Last Date for Submission of suggestions/comments : 17.11.2026

Interested participants may submit their suggestions/ comments to **marketing@mpsedc.com.** The draft consultation document and further details will be available at **https://mpsedc.mp.gov.in/**

M.P. Madhyam/129034/2026 **MANAGING DIRECTOR**

केनरा बैंक Canara Bank
भारत सरकार का उपक्रम A Government of India Undertaking
सिंडिकेट Syndicate

BRANCH: KASNA
Email: cb19453@canarabank.com

Notice issued under Section 13(2) of the Securitisation & Reconstruction of Financial Assets & Enforcement of Security Interest Act, 2002.

We the Canara Bank has issued demand notice as mentioned below dates u/s 13(2) of chapter III of the Securitization & Reconstruction of Financial Assets & Enforcement of Security Interest Act 2002 by our Branch/me, the Authorised officer, The contents of the same are the defaults committed by you in the payments of instalments of Principal interest etc. The Outstanding are as mentioned below. Further Demand Notice issued to below mentioned borrowers/owners /guarantors is delivered. You are hereby called upon to pay Canara Bank with in Period of 60 Days from the date of Publication of this demand notice the aforesaid amount along with up to date interest. Failing which Canara Bank will take necessary action under Provision section 13(4) of the said act against all or any one or more of the secured assets including taking possession of the secured Assets of the borrower/ owner/ mortgagors/ guarantors. Further you are prohibited U/s 13(13) of the said act from transferring either by way of the sale, lease or otherwise any of the secured Assets as mentioned below.

Borrower: Ashish Agarwal S/o Ashok Kumar, C 268 Delta 1 Gr Noida, Uttar Pradesh 201306.

Guarantor: Anirudha Agrawal, C 268 Delta 1 Gr Noida, Uttar Pradesh 201306.

Total Outstanding Amount Rs. 4,86,064.71 (Rs. Four Lakh Eighty Six Thousand Sixty Four and Seventy One Paisa only) is due as on 28.10.2026 together with further interest and incidental expenses and costs, NPA Date 23.10.2026.

Detail of Hypothecated Vehicle, Toyota Urban Cruiser (Premium MT)

Regn No.: UP 16 DD 5129, Chassis No. MA3PYGJ1SNC922178, Engine No. K15BN4248176, Colour: ICONIC GREY.

Notice Date: 28.10.2026 **Authorized Officer, Canara Bank**

केनरा बैंक Canara Bank
भारत सरकार का उपक्रम A Government of India Undertaking
सिंडिकेट Syndicate

BRANCH: YAMUNA GAUR CITY
Email: cb7556@canarabank.com

Notice issued under Section 13(2) of the Securitisation & Reconstruction of Financial Assets & Enforcement of Security Interest Act, 2002.

We the Canara Bank has issued demand notice as mentioned below dates u/s 13(2) of chapter III of the Securitization & Reconstruction of Financial Assets & Enforcement of Security Interest Act 2002 by our Branch/me, the Authorised officer, The contents of the same are the defaults committed by you in the payments of instalments of Principal interest etc. The Outstanding are as mentioned below. Further Demand Notice issued to below mentioned borrowers/owners /guarantors is delivered. You are hereby called upon to pay Canara Bank with in Period of 60 Days from the date of Publication of this demand notice the aforesaid amount along with up to date interest. Failing which Canara Bank will take necessary action under Provision section 13(4) of the said act against all or any one or more of the secured assets including taking possession of the secured Assets of the borrower/ owner/ mortgagors/ guarantors. Further you are prohibited U/s 13(13) of the said act from transferring either by way of the sale, lease or otherwise any of the secured Assets as mentioned below.

Borrower: Mr. Sanjay Jain S/o Mr. Uday Ram Jain, Villa A-13/14, Block-13/14, Amrapali Dream Valley Greater Noida, U.P -201306, **Mr. Sanjay Jain** S/o Mr. Uday Ram Jain, 146 H DDA LIG Flats Pocket 3 Mayur Vihar Ph 3 Vasundhra Enclave Delhi Delhi 110096, **Mr. Sanjay Jain** S/o Mr. Uday Ram Jain, D-311 D Block, Aditya Apartment, Vijay Nagar, S.O Ghaziabad, Uttar Pradesh- 201009, **Sanjay Jain PVC And Decor Work,** N-95/233 Shahjada Bagh, Inderlok North West Delhi-110035, **Mr. Sanjay Jain** S/o Mr. Uday Ram Jain, Near ESI Hospital Sector 24, Village- Choura Raghunath Pur Sector 22 Gautam Budh Nagar Noida Uttar Pradesh - 201301, **Mr. Sanjay Jain** S/o Mr. Uday Ram Jain, D-311 Aditya Apartment, D Block, Uni One Residency Baharampur, Vijay Nagar, Ghaziabad, Uttar Pradesh- 201009.

Total Outstanding Amount Rs. 12,62,271.61 (Rs. Twelve Lakhs Sixty Two Thousand Two Hundred Seventy one and Sixty One Paisa only) is due as on 30.10.2026 together with further interest and incidental expenses and costs, NPA Date 27.10.2026.

Detail of Hypothecated Vehicle, THAR LXT D MT 2WD 4S HT XJ

Regn No.: UP 16 FU 7736, Chassis No. MA1UJ2TZ2T2F43600, Engine No. TZTZF08422, Colour: Stealth Black.

Notice Date: 30.10.2026 **Authorized Officer, Canara Bank**

केनरा बैंक Canara Bank
भारत सरकार का उपक्रम A Government of India Undertaking
सिंडिकेट Syndicate

Regional Office I, 71, MG Road, Agra

Auction Sale Notice

The under mentioned persons are hereby informed that they have failed to pay off the liability in the loan accounts. You have acknowledged your liability under the said credit facility by your letter. Now there is due and payable by you to the bank under the credit / loan facility a sum mentioned below inclusive of interest. Despite repeated requests you have failed and neglected to pay the said outstanding dues and interest thereof.

We hereby finally call upon you to pay to the bank the said sum with interest as mentioned compounded quarterly/half yearly from till payment OR arrange to pledge the extra gold ornament(s) in consultation with the Branch within 15 days from the date of receipt hereof, failing which the Bank will be constrained to sell the gold ornaments pledged by you with the Bank by following due procedure and appropriate the sale proceeds to your loan account by conducting auction on the date and place as mentioned hereunder.

S.N.	Name & Address of Borrower	Loan A/c Number	Amount Due
Branch: Jaipur House Colony, Agra (Auction at Branch)			
1.	Laxmi Upadhyaya, Add.: 46 95 A 1 Bhim Nagar, Jagdishpura, Agra	164117407527	98,867.34 + Interest From 06-11-2026 at 9.20% & Other Expenses
Branch: Baroli Ahir (Auction at Regional Office, Agra)			
2	Lalita C/o Bhupendra Singh, Add.: Vill-Barauli Gujjar, Fatehabad, Agra	164035847540	95,732/- + Interest From 06-11-2026 at 8.25% & Other Expenses
Branch: Akola (Online Auction)			
3.	Smt. Dipti Soni CO Mukesh Soni, Add.: Jagner Road, Main Market, Akola, Agra	164099748878	88,418/- + Interest From 07-11-2026 at 10.90% & Other Expenses
Branch: Barara (Online Auction)			
4.	Sri Devidas Dhangar S/o Omprakash VPO Barara, Agra	180214152345	1,57,218.75 + Interest From 07-11-2026 at 10.70% & Other Expenses

Date of Auction: 26-11-2026

Identification of jewellery for auction is at the sole discretion of the Bank. Auction Charges: Rs 470.00+GST per bid. (Applicable in case of Online mode of Auction). Kindly contact the undersigned for further information, if any required.

Date: 11-11-2026 **MANAGER**

पंजाब नैशनल बैंक punjab national bank
.....भरोसे का प्रतीक ...the name you can BANK upon!

General Services Administration Section, Circle Office Noida, C-13, 3rd Floor, Sector 1, Noida
Telephone No 0120-4818138/104, Mob. 9650240477, Email: conoidagad@pnb.bank.in

PREMISES REQUIRED

Punjab National Bank requires suitable ready built and well-constructed hall type building having Carpet Area including space for ATM (1400 sq.ft. to 1800 sq.ft.) on lease /rental basis premises should be preferably in Ground Floor and if in first floor, lift facility at **(Sector 22, Noida).** Premises offered should have all clearance certificates from statutory authorities. Interested owners / registered Power of attorney Holders of such premises in the desired locality who are ready to lease out their readily available premises on long term lease basis preferably for 15 years or more may send their offers in the prescribed format available on Bank's Web Site **www.pnb.bank.in** or the same may be obtained from the above address during office hours. Last date to apply is **23.11.2026 upto 05.00 PM**. The complete offer duly sealed & signed and should reach the undersigned on or before (**23.11.2026 before 05:00PM**) at the above address.

No brokerage will be paid by the Bank. Bank reserves the right to accept or reject any or all offers at its sole discretion without assigning any reasons whatsoever.

-sd-,
Date: 11.11.2026 **Circle Head,**

pnb पंजाब नैशनल बैंक punjab national bank
.....भरोसे का प्रतीक ...the name you can BANK upon!
(A GOVERNMENT OF INDIA UNDERTAKING)

B.O: - MCC ASHOK VIHAR, NEAR KULACHI HANSRAJ PUBLIC SCHOOL, 1ST FLOOR, PHASE-I, BLOCK-H, ASHOK VIHAR, NEW DELHI- 110052
Enuail: clpc6349@pnb.bank.in

POSSESSION NOTICE
(For Immovable Property)
(As per Appendix IV read with rule 8(1) of the Security interest (Enforcement) Rules 2002)

Whereas,

The undersigned being the Authorized Officer of the **PUNJAB NATIONAL BANK,** under the securitization and Reconstruction of Financial Assets and Enforcement of Security Interest Act, 2002 and in exercise of powers conferred under section 13(12) read with Rule 3 of the security Interest (Enforcement) Rules, 2002, issued a demand notice dated 31-08-2026 calling upon the **borrower M/S KRISHNA GLOBAL Through its PROPRIETOR/GUARANTOR/MORTGAGOR SMT. PREETI GARG W/O SH. AMIT GARG** to repay the amount mentioned in notice being **Rs.4,37,21,332.10 (Rupees Four Crores Thirty-Seven Lakhs Twenty-One Thousand Three Hundred Thirty-Two and Ten Paise Only)** as on **29-08-2026** along with further interest with incidental expenses, cost, charges etc. Within 60 days from the date of receipt of the said notice.

The borrower / guarantors / mortgagors have failed to repay the amount, notice is hereby given to the Borrowers / Guarantors / Mortgagors and the public in general that the undersigned has taken symbolic possession of the property described herein below in exercise of power conferred on him her under Sub-section (4) of Section 13 of Act read with rule 8 of the security interest Enforcement rules 2002 on this **10th day of November of the year 2026.**

The borrowers / guarantors / mortgagors in particular and the public in general are hereby cautioned not to deal with the property mentioned here under and any dealing with the said property will be subject to the charge of the **PUNJAB NATIONAL BANK, (B.O:- MCC ASHOK VIHAR, SOL ID- 634900)** for an amount **Rs.4,37,21,332.10** due and outstanding as on **29.08.2026** along with future interest cost and expenses thereon.

The Borrower's/Guarantor's/Mortaagor's attention is invited to provisions of sub-section (8) of section 13 of the Act in respect of time available to redeem the secured assets.

Description of the Immovable Property

BUILT UP SOCIETY FREEHOLD FLAT BEARING NO. B-14, ON 3RD FLOOR, HIG, IN THE LAYOUT PLAN OF THE SAHYOG CO-OPERATIVE GROUP HOUSING SOCIETY LIMITED, PRESENTLY KNOWN AS "PARWANA VIHAR APARTMENTS" SITUATED AT PLOT NO. 52, SECTOR-9, ROHINI, DELHI-110085 IN THE NAME OF SMT. PREETI GARG W/O SH. AMIT GARG. (PLINTH AREA MEASURING 89.90 SQR. MTRS.)

Date: 10/11/2026 **Authorized Officer,**
Place: Delhi **Punjab National Bank**

Form No. INC-26

[Pursuant to rule 30 the Companies (Incorporation) Rules, 2014]
Advertisement to be published in the newspaper for change of registered office of the company from one state to another

Before the Central Government
Regional Director, Northern Region, New Delhi

In the matter of sub-section (4) of Section 13 of Companies Act, 2013 and clause (a) of sub-rule (5) of rule 30 of the Companies (Incorporation) Rules, 2014

AND

In the matter of **Bharti Airtel Services Limited** having its registered office at Bharti Crescent, 1, Nelson Mandela Road, Vasant Kunj, Phase - II, New Delhi, India, 110070,

……..Applicant Company/Petitioner

Notice is hereby given to the General Public that the Company proposes to make application to the Central Government under section 13 of the Companies Act, 2013 seeking confirmation of alteration of the Memorandum of Association of the Company in terms of the special resolution passed at the Extra ordinary general meeting held on **November 02, 2026**, to enable the company to change its Registered Office from National Capital Territory **"NCT of Delhi"** to **"State of Haryana"**.

Any person whose interest is likely to be affected by the proposed change of the registered office of the Company may deliver either on the **MCA-21 portal (www.mca.gov.in) by filing investor complaint form** or cause to be delivered or send by registered post of his/her objections supported by an affidavit stating the nature of his/her interest and grounds of opposition to the Regional Director at the address **B-2 Wing, 2nd Floor, Pt. Deendayal Antyodaya Bhawan (Paryavaran Bhawan), CGO Complex, Lodhi Road, New Delhi – 110003** within fourteen days of the date of publication of this notice with a copy to the applicant company at its registered office at the address mentioned below:

Bharti Airtel Services Limited
Address: Bharti Crescent, 1, Nelson Mandela Road, Vasant Kunj, Phase - II, New Delhi – 110070

For **Bharti Airtel Services Limited**
Sd/-
Pankaj Tewari
Director
Date: November 10, 2026 **DIN: 08006533**
Place: New Delhi

केनरा बैंक Canara Bank
भारत सरकार का उपक्रम A Government of India Undertaking
सिंडिकेट Syndicate

ARM BRANCH , AGRA

E-AUCTION NOTICE

E-AUCTION SALE NOTICE FOR SALE OF IMMOVABLE PROPERTIES UNDER THE SECURITISATION AND RECONSTRUCTION OF FINANCIAL ASSETS AND ENFORCEMENT OF SECURITY INTEREST ACT, 2002 READ WITH PROVISON TO RULE 9(1) and 8 (6) OF THE SECURITY INTEREST (ENFORCEMENT) RULES, 2002

Notice is hereby given to the public in general and in particular to the Borrower (s) and Guarantor(s) that the below described immovable property mortgaged/charged to the Secured Creditor, the Physical/Symbolic possession of which has been taken by the Authorised Officer of Canara Bank, Secured Creditor, will be sold on **"As is where is", "As is what is", and "Whatever there is"** for the recovery of dues to the Bank. The details are describe herebelow.

S. No.	Name & Address of Borrowers & Guarantors	Amount due (Rs.) as per demand notice	Description of Properties	Type of Possession	Reserve Price (Rs.) EMD 10% (Rs.)
Date & Time of e-auction : 27.11.2026 from 11:00 AM to 1:00 PM (With extension of 5 min. duration each till the conclusion of sale) & EMD deposit date : 26.11.2026 upto 05:00 PM					
1.	**Borrower-** 1. M/s Yukti Ice and Milk Chilling Plant Pvt Ltd, Add.- 1019 Village Bakhtpura,Tehra, Saiyan, Kheragarh, 2. Smt Rekha Devi W/o Shri Mahendra Singh, Add.- VPO Kakrauli, Pinahat Agra, 3. Shri Harendra Singh, Add.- VPO Bhaktpura, Tehra Kheragarh, Agra **Sale Notice Letter Date: 05.11.2026**	79,01,119.20 as per demand notice dt. 22.07.2025 + interest & Other Exp. thereon (less recovery, if any)	Residential Building at part of gata no. 231, situated at Shivdham Colony Revenue mauza Fatehabad, Tehsil Fatehabad & District Agra, Area- 170.23 Sq. Mtr., Property in the name of Smt Rekha Devi W/o Shri Mahendra Singh, Bounded as: East- Other's property, West- Other's property, North- 18' wide road, South- Agriculture Land	Symbolic	46,20,000/- 4,62,000/-
2.	**Borrower-** M/s Mittal Enterprises, Add.- 7/33, Fafala Street, Nr. Patthar Bazar, Koil, Aligarh, Porp.- Shri Yogesh Chandra Mittal S/o Shri Dinesh Chandra Mittal, Add.- 19/32, Krishn Vihar, Pala Road, Aligarh, Guarantor/ Mortagaor- Shri Veer Singh Yadav S/o Late Shri Babulal Yadav, Add.- Behind D.A.V. Girls College, Nr. Vishnupuri, Extension Surendra Nagar, Aligarh **Sale Notice Letter Date: 05.11.2026**	1,52,81,395.24 as per demand notice dt. 25.08.2023 + interest & Other Exp. thereon (less recovery, if any)	EMT of Land and Building property no. 7/35 Phaphala Street, Nr. Patthar Bazar, Koil, Aligarh, Area- 41.80 Sq. Mtr., in the name of Shri Veer Singh Yadav S/o Late Shri Babulal Yadav, Bounded as: East- House of Suresh Chandra, West- House of Mukir, North- Rasta/Gali, South- House of Mukir	Symbolic	88,55,000/- 8,86,000/-

EMD amount is to be deposited in E-Wallet of M/s PSB Alliance Private Limited (BAANKNET) portal directly or by generating the Challan therein to deposit the EMD through RTGS/NEFT in the account details as mentioned in the said challan before above mentioned dates respectively. After depositing of EMD amount intending bidder/s may select the property and place the bid.

Note: 1. No interest will be claimed on the bid/subsequent amount. 2. Authorised officer is entitled to cancel the bid at any stage without assigning any reason whatsoever. 3. All charges for conveyance, stamp duty/GST registration charges etc., as applicable shall be borne by the successful bidder only.

For details terms and conditions of the sale and participating in E Auction, please go through the website https://baanknet.com/ or Canara Bank's Website or may contact ARM Branch, Canra Bank (Mob. 9084688622 e-mail id cb7315@canarabank.com) OR to the service provider M/S PSB Alliance Ltd (baanknet) contact on 8291220220.

Place : Agra Date : 11-11-2026 **Authorised Officer**

Department of Consumer Affairs
Bureau of Indian Standards
National Standards Body of India

BRAND CHECK ✓
FEATURES CHECK ✓
SAFETY ??? ✓



You Must Check
BIS MARK

How to verify BIS Quality Mark?

Scan to Download BIS CARE APP


Click on Verify R-Number


Enter the Registration Number

Register complaints regarding safety of Product of or misuse of BIS marks by using 'Complaints' feature.

Follow us on: @Indianstandards

CBC 08103/13/0008/2627

केनरा बैंक Canara Bank
भारत सरकार का उपक्रम A Government of India Undertaking
सिंडिकेट Syndicate

Regional Office 2 : Padam Businus Park Sec. 12 A Aavas vikas, Agra

E-AUCTION NOTICE

E-AUCTION SALE NOTICE FOR SALE OF IMMOVABLE PROPERTIES UNDER THE SECURITISATION AND RECONSTRUCTION OF FINANCIAL ASSETS AND ENFORCEMENT OF SECURITY INTEREST ACT, 2002 READ WITH PROVISO TO RULE 8 (6) OF THE SECURITY INTEREST (ENFORCEMENT) RULES, 2002

Notice is hereby given to the public in general and in particular to the Borrower (s) and Guarantor(s) that the below described immovable property mortgaged/charged to the Secured Creditor, the Constructive / Symbolic / Physical possession of which has been taken by the Authorised Officer of Canara Bank, Secured Creditor, will be sold on **"As is where is", "As is what is", and "Whatever there is"** for the recovery of dues to the Bank. as per Demand Notice under Section 13(2) & further interest thereon, charges and costs due to the Canara Bank, as detailed in the table below.

S. N.	Name & Address of Borrowers & Guarantors	Amount due as per notice (Rs.)	Description of Properties	Type of Possession	Reserve Price (Rs.) EMD 10% (Rs.)
Date & Time of e-auction : 30-11-2026 from 11.00 AM to 1.00 PM (With extension of 5 min. duration each till the conclusion of sale) & Last date for EMD deposit: 29-11-2026 upto 05:00 PM					
Branch: Tundla, Firozabad					
1.	**Borrower-** M/S Shailendra Farming, Prop. Shailendra Kumar S/o Jay Kumar Gulab Nagar, Add.- Anamika Takij Road, Tundla Tehsil- Tundla Firozabad, Guarantor- Jay Kumar S/o Matru Lal Balmik, Add.- Gulab Nagar, Tundla Tehsil-Tundla Firozabad **Sale Notice Letter Date: 07.11.2026**	24,51,430.76 as on 06.11.2026 + interest & Other Expenses thereon	EMT of Residential House No- 40 & 41 & Part of Khasra No. 222, Situated at Gulab Nagar, Mauza- Tundli Tehsil- Tundla Firozabad, Area- 232.15 Sq Mtrs, Property in the name of Jay Kumar S/o Matru Lal, Bounded as: East- Plot No 39 & 32, West- Rasta, North- Plot No 42, South- Plot No 31 Chanda Devi Details of Property	Symbolic	20,00,000/- 2,00,000/-
Branch: Shikohabad, Firozabad					
2.	**Borrower-** M/s Leeyansh Trading Company, (Prop. Shri Manish Rajaani S/o Moolchand Rajaani), Guarantor- Mrs Mohini Devi W/o Moolchand Rajaani, Add. of all- Pakka Talab Kambal Taakij, Shikohabad, Firozabad **Sale Notice Letter Date: 07.11.2026**	39,92,197.69 as on 06.11.2026 + interest & Other Exp. thereon	EMT of Resi. Land and Building Situated at House No. 2660 & 1979, On Plot No 875, Mohammadmah, Tehsil- Shikohabad & Distt- Firozabad, Area- 75.89 Sq. Mtr., Property in the name of Mrs Mohini Devi W/o Shri Mool Chandra, Bounded as: East - Property of Bachchu & Devendra, West - Property of Sudhir & Vimal, North - Property of Ram Sevak, South - 5' 6" Wd Gali & Property of Chatur Singh Details of Property	Symbolic	19,50,000/- 1,95,000/-
Branch: Tilak Nagar, Firozabad					
3.	**Borrower-** 1. Priti Verma C/o Rajiv Verma, 2. Mr. Rajeev Verma C/o Dayashankar Verma, Add. of both- Nai Abadi Rehana, Shri- Rampuram Tehsil & Distt- Firozabad **Sale Notice Letter Date: 07.11.2026**	22,78,918.62 as on 06.11.2026 + interest & Other Exp. thereon	Emt One Land and Building Property at House No. 625, Mohalla Shri Ram Puram (Indira Nagar), Mauza Rahna Firozabad, Area- 37.94 Sq Mtrs, In Name of Priti Verma, Bounded as: East- 12 ft Wide Road, West- Others Plot, North- Property of Harbhe Ji, South- Property of Bhagwan Singh Details of Property	Symbolic	20,50,000/- 2,05,000/-
4.	**Borrower-** M/s IA Traders (Prop.- Irshad), Proprietor- Mr. Irshad S/o Asharaf, Add. of Both- R Glass Ke Aage Shati Road Hasmat Nagar, Firozabad, Guarantor & Mortgagor- Ameena Begum W/o Irshad, Add.- 648/3 Near Mohammad Masjid Kashmiri Gate Firozabad **Sale Notice Letter Date: 07.11.2026**	21,93,060.74 as on 06.11.2026 + interest & Other Exp. thereon	Residential Property Situated Near Mohammad Ganj Kashmiri Gate Firozabad, Area: 93.00 Sq Mtrs., Property in the name of Ameena Begum W/o Irshad Ali, **Bounded as:** East- Gali/Rasta 16 Feet, West- Others Property, North- Property of Riyazuddin, South- Property of Shri Irshad Ali Details of Property	Symbolic	17,00,000/- 1,70,000/-
5.	**Borrower-** M/s India Scrap Traders Prop. Iftakhar Ali S/o Mr Mukhtar Ali, Add.- Urdu Nagar Near CNG Pump Station, Bye Pass Road, Firozabad, Guarantor- 1) Mukhtar S/o Ziauddin Ansari, Add.- H No-221,Yakub Khan Road, Nai Basti, Near Karbala Chauraha, Firozabad, 2) Muvina Begum S/o Mukhtar Ali, Add.- H No-755, Yakub Gali, Near Karbala Chauraha, Nai Basti, Firozabad **Sale Notice Letter Date: 07.11.2026**	20,86,564.25 as on 06.11.2026 + interest & Other Exp. thereon	"A Residential Property House No. 755, Mohalla Yakub Gali, Near Karbala Chauraha, Nai Basti, Firozabad, Area- 1200 Sq ft., Property in the name of Mukhtar S/o Ziauddin Ansari & Mrs Muvina Begum W/o Mr. Mukhtar Ali, Bounded as: East- House of Arjun Singh, West- Rasta 12" Ft Wide, North- House of Banali Khan, South- House of Puti Bhai Details of Property	Symbolic	23,50,000/- 2,35,000/-

EMD amount is to be deposited in E-Wallet of M/s PSB Alliance Private Limited (baanknet) portal directly or by generating the Challan therein to deposit the EMD through RTGS/NEFT in the account details as mentioned in the said challan before above mentioned dates respectively.

Note: 1. No interest will be claimed on the bid/subsequent amount. 2. Authorised officer is entitled to cancel the bid at any stage without assigning any reason whatsoever. 3. All charges for conveyance, stamp duty/GST registration charges etc., as applicable shall be borne by the successful bidder only.

For details terms and conditions of the sale and participating in E Auction, please go through the website https://baanknet.com or Canara Bank's Website or may contact Recovery Section, Regional Office 2, Agra, (Mob. 6398017937, e-mail id roagra2rec@canarabank.com) OR to the service provider M/S PSB Alliance Ltd, contact details a). Karan Modi (7016716557, karan@procure247.com) b).Vasu Patel (9510974587, vasu.patel@procure247.com)

Place : Agra Date : 11-11-2026 **Authorised Officer**

Brokerages' Diwali picks for Samvat 2083



ILLUSTRATION: BINAY SINHA

November rally has brought a festive glow to equities. Brokerages identify their potential winners for Samvat 2083, report **Krishna Kant & Ram Prasad Sahu**

A surprise rally on Dalal Street last week lifted the benchmark BSE Sensex 9 per cent month to date in November, restoring optimism after a weak start to 2026.

The index fell nearly 15 per cent between January and September and lost 4 per cent during Samvat 2082 (October 20, 2025, to November 6, 2026), its worst Samvat performance since 2014. By comparison, the index gained 6.3 per cent during Samvat 2081. The latest rally, driven by foreign portfolio investor (FPI) buying, has turned brokerages bullish on Samvat 2083.

Brokerage estimates suggest the benchmark could gain nearly 14 per cent over the next year, supported by continued FPI buying and earnings growth. The Sensex has delivered a compound annual growth rate of 9.66 per cent over the past 12 Samvat years, from October 22, 2014, to November 6, 2026.

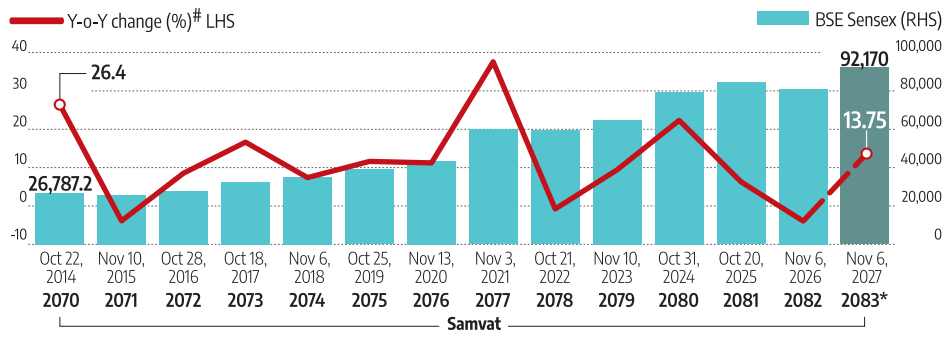
Brokerages expect the Sensex to reach 92,170 by November 6, 2027, against 81,028 at the close of Samvat 2082 on November 6, 2026.

The index's underlying earnings per share is forecast to rise 13 per cent over the next 12 months, to around ₹4,440 from ₹3,933 on November 9, 2026, based on Bloomberg's blended one-year forward estimate. This would exceed the 7.3 per cent growth recorded over the previous 12 months. The projections imply a one-year forward price-to-earnings (P/E) multiple of 20.8x for the Sensex in November 2027, marginally above its current trailing P/E of 20.6x.

Brokerages' 2026 Diwali picks suggest that several stocks could outperform the benchmark, driven by earnings growth and valuation rerating. Analysts see continued bullishness in industrial metals and energy prices, while expecting capital expenditure-led growth to benefit sectors such as capital goods, engineering, and construction. They also expect credit growth to remain firm, supporting earnings and share prices of fast-growing banks and other lenders.

Here are 10 stocks that could shine in Samvat 2083.

Sensex at the end of Samvat every year



#change over previous Samvat; *2083 Samvat numbers are based on Bloomberg's 12-month forward target price and over previous Samvat; Compiled by *Business Standard* Research Bureau

Source: Bloomberg

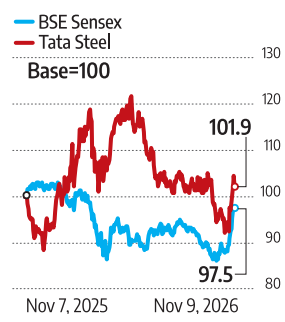
Tata Steel

(As on November 9)

Share price (₹)	1-year change (%)	Target price (₹)	Upside (%)	P/E (x) Current (TTM)	P/E (x) Blended forward 12 mths	RoNW (%)	TTM Y-o-Y chg (%) Revenue	TTM Y-o-Y chg (%) PAT
185	1.9	218	17.9	21.4	12.2	11.4	11.2	70.4



- The stock of steel major Tata Steel barely moved over a one-year period though the potential upside from these levels is a healthy 17.9 per cent
- In Q2FY27, the Tata group firm's operating performance was in line with strong India earnings offset by persistent weakness in Europe business
- An increasing focus on downstream expansion and strategic sales of surplus iron ore should aid domestic margins in the medium term
- In the Netherlands, unresolved regulatory resolutions continue to cloud visibility on decarbonisation investments
- Motilal Oswal Research expects operating profit improvement for Europe's operations in the coming quarters on account of improving prices, along with regulatory measures (carbon border adjustment mechanism/reduction in import quotas) and improving operational efficiency
- FY28 earnings growth, according to Emkay Research, is likely to accelerate on capacity ramp-up and improved operating leverage



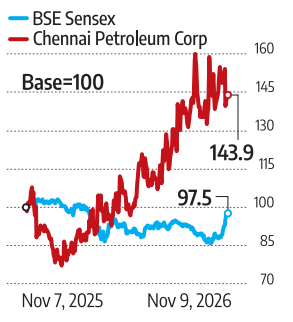
Chennai Petroleum Corp

(As on November 9)

Share price (₹)	1-year change (%)	Target price (₹)	Upside (%)	P/E (x) Current (TTM)	P/E (x) Blended forward 12 mths	RoNW (%)	TTM Y-o-Y chg (%) Revenue	TTM Y-o-Y chg (%) PAT
1,461	43.9	1,840	25.9	3.8	2.6	32.1	31.2	387.4



- An oil refining subsidiary of Indian Oil Corporation, CPCL gained handsomely from a cut in excise duty on diesel and petrol in March this year and a rise in refining margins on transport fuels due to the West Asia conflict
- The firm's adjusted net profit more than tripled in Q2FY27 on a year-on-year (Y-o-Y) basis, marking its fifth consecutive quarter of high double-digit earnings growth
- CPCL's excise duty payout in Q2FY27 was down 60 per cent Y-o-Y, the lowest in 47 quarters. Meanwhile, net sales were up 26 per cent Y-o-Y and profit before interest, depreciation, and taxes (PBIDT) increased by 177 per cent Y-o-Y
- Brokerages expect refining margins and PBIDT margins to stay firm in the forthcoming quarter as the US-Iran conflict continues to simmer
- Bull case for CPCL also gets support from its low valuation, with a trailing price-to-earnings multiple of 3.8x and a price-to-book value of 1.9

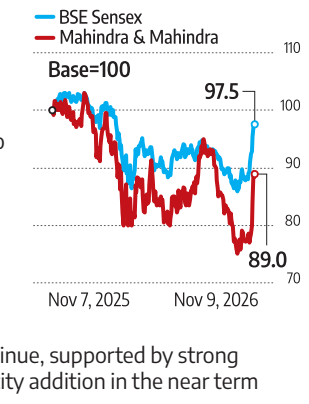


Mahindra & Mahindra

(As on November 9)

Share price (₹)	1-year change (%)	Target price (₹)	Upside (%)	P/E (x) Current (TTM)	P/E (x) Blended forward 12 mths	RoNW (%)	TTM Y-o-Y chg (%) Revenue	TTM Y-o-Y chg (%) PAT
3,284	-11.0	3,965	20.7	21.5	22.3	21.9	26.8	36.2

- The outlook for Mahindra & Mahindra's (M&M's) two key segments of auto and tractors offers divergent trends. While demand trends in the underlying auto industry continue to remain robust, tractors are likely to see muted traction owing to rainfall deficit and drought conditions in key regions
- In the auto segment, ICICI Securities expects M&M's healthy performance to continue, supported by strong traction for its models, capacity addition in the near term and new launches
- Nearly half a dozen launches are expected in M&M's passenger vehicle division over the next few months
- The company reduced FY27 tractor industry growth guidance from 5 per cent to flat. This translates to a double-digit decline in H2FY27 and is weighed down by demand dip in Maharashtra and Karnataka
- According to Systematix Research, the company offers healthy medium-term growth visibility, underpinned by its strong SUV franchise, expanding EV portfolio, capacity additions and improving earnings diversification



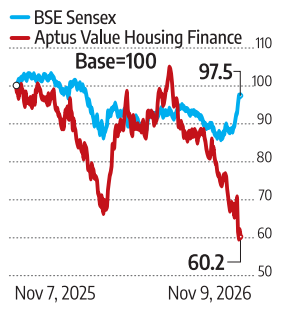
Aptus Value Housing Finance

(As on November 9)

Share price (₹)	1-year change (%)	Target price (₹)	Upside (%)	P/E (x) Current (TTM)	P/E (x) Blended forward 12 mths	RoNW (%)	TTM Y-o-Y chg (%) Revenue	TTM Y-o-Y chg (%) PAT
176	-39.8	306	73.7	9.3	7.3	20.1	17.7	21.6

- With a 39.8 per cent fall, Aptus is the worst-performing stock in this list. Conversely, it also offers the highest potential upside at 73.7 per cent
- In Q2, the home loan financier's assets under management (AUM) saw a growth of 20.5 per cent year-on-year (Y-o-Y) and this was powered by healthy disbursements
- Spreads remained resilient at 8.9 per cent though asset quality was soft, particularly in NBFC. The management is strengthening NBFC underwriting, collections, and legal recovery, and expects asset quality to normalise by FY27-end, while raising FY27 credit-cost guidance by 5-10 basis points
- Choice Institutional Equities expects Aptus to deliver AUM and net interest income or NII annual growth of 21.5 per cent and 17.9 per cent, respectively, during FY26-28, supported by a sustained disbursement momentum and a healthy spread profile





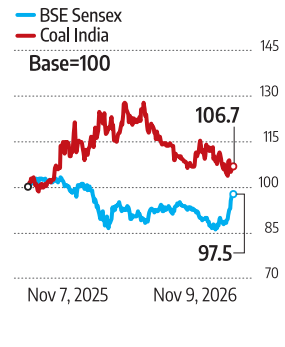
Coal India

(As on November 9)

Share price (₹)	1-year change (%)	Target price (₹)	Upside (%)	P/E (x) Current (TTM)	P/E (x) Blended forward 12 mths	RoNW (%)	TTM Y-o-Y chg (%) Revenue	TTM Y-o-Y chg (%) PAT
401	6.7	464	15.7	8.0	7.1	28.1	11.5	7.1



- Coal India reported a healthy Q2FY27 performance, with revenue growing 20.9 per cent, supported by 12.9 per cent growth in offtake and a 6.4 per cent improvement in blended realisation
- India's largest coal miner, according to Elara Securities, has multiple long-term tailwinds including rising acceptance of coal as a dominant fuel mix and good volume delivery in the past few quarters, along with better evacuation infrastructure in terms of first-mile connectivity projects
- Its diversification strategy is another positive as the company is going beyond its core coal business, with progress across renewable energy and critical minerals
- A healthy balance sheet and a likely annual dividend payout of ₹26-27 per share with a 6 per cent yield are other triggers

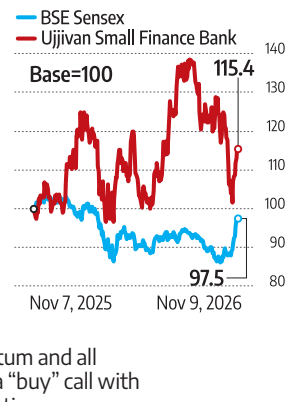


Ujjivan Small Finance Bank

(As on November 9)

Share price (₹)	1-year change (%)	Target Price (in ₹)	Upside (%)	P/BV (x) Current (TTM)	P/BV (x) Blended forward 12 mths	RoNW (%)	TTM Y-o-Y chg (%) Net interest income	TTM Y-o-Y chg (%) PAT
60	15.4	86	42.3	1.6	1.3	10.7	28.4	175.5

- Ujjivan Small Finance Bank is also on brokerage's radar this Diwali as the lender continues to deliver double-digit growth in revenues and profits
- The lender's gross interest income was up 28 per cent year-on-year (Y-o-Y) in Q2FY27 while its adjusted net profit was up 200 per cent Y-o-Y in the quarter
- Brokerages expect the bank to continue its growth momentum and all 21 brokerages tracking it have a "buy" call with no "hold" or "sell" recommendations
- According to Axis Securities, Ujjivan's disbursement momentum remained healthy, growing by 33 per cent Y-o-Y in Q2FY27 and up 14 per cent Q-o-Q led by a strong momentum in the non-Microfinance segment
- Its net interest income (NII) was up 35 per cent Y-o-Y in Q2FY27 owing to better growth in the microfinance segment and lower interest reversals, while the net interest margin was 8.4 per cent compared to 8.5 per cent in Q1FY27

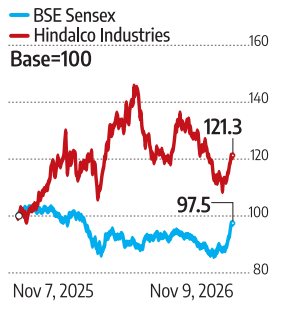


Hindalco Industries

(As on November 9)

Share price (₹)	1-year change (%)	Target price (in ₹)	Upside (%)	P/E (x) Current (TTM)	P/E (x) Blended forward 12 mths	RoNW (%)	TTM Y-o-Y chg (%) Revenue	TTM Y-o-Y chg (%) PAT
959	21.3	1,135	18.4	15.9	8.5	13.0	26.7	8.0

- A fully integrated aluminium producer, Hindalco Industries is one of the top Diwali picks in the largecap space thanks to a continued bullishness in base metal prices
- There are 19 "buy" and 10 "sell" recommendations on the stock and brokerages expect a further 21.5 per cent upside in its stock price from the current level, building on a similar return last year
- The consolidated adjusted net profit of Aditya Birla group's metals flagship firm was up 50.4 per cent Y-o-Y while its net sales were up 38.8 per cent Y-o-Y in Q2FY27, driven by a 23 per cent Y-o-Y rise in aluminium realisations and broad-based volume growth
- According to Axis Securities, Hindalco's aluminium dispatches were up 3 per cent Y-o-Y and 6 per cent Q-o-Q in Q2FY27 while copper shipments were up 3 per cent Y-o-Y and 10 per cent Y-o-Y in the quarter
- The firm's upstream Aluminium business' Ebitda per tonne was up 40 per cent Y-o-Y in USD while the copper segment Ebitda surged 164 per cent Y-o-Y to a record high level in Q2FY27, according to Axis Securities



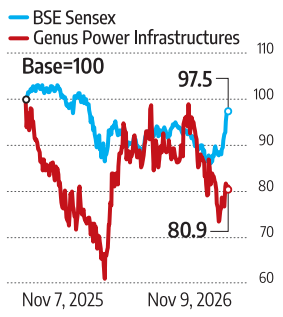
Genus Power Infrastructures

(As on November 9)

Share price (₹)	1-year change (%)	Target price (₹)	Upside (%)	P/E (x) Current (TTM)	P/E (x) Blended forward 12 mths	RoNW (%)	TTM Y-o-Y chg (%) Revenue	TTM Y-o-Y chg (%) PAT
286	-19.1	450	57.2	13.4	10.9	27.7	74.2	62.8



- The Street expects 57 per cent upside in Genus Power's stock over the next 12 months from the current levels driven by a continued traction in its earnings growth
- The company's adjusted net profit was up 43.2 per cent while its net sales were up 44.8 per cent year-on-year (Y-o-Y) in Q2FY27
- Brokerages expects earnings growth to stay strong driven by expansion in renewal power generation and roll out of smart metering by power distribution companies
- The company reported an executable order book of ₹24,020 crore as of June 30, 2026, worth more than 5x its net sales in FY26 according to ICICI Direct
- The stock is currently trading at a trailing price-to-earnings (P/E) ratio of 13.4x and a price-to-book value of 3.9
- The company's high net working capital equivalent to nearly 11-month worth of company's net sales in FY26, could severely strain its balance sheet



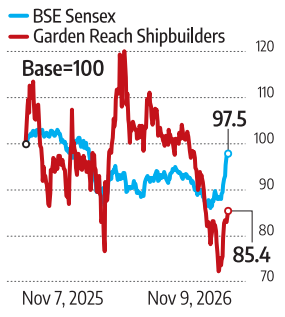
Garden Reach Shipbuilders & Engineers

(As on November 9)

Share price (₹)	1-year change (%)	Target price (₹)	Upside (%)	P/E (x) Current (TTM)	P/E (x) Blended forward 12 mths	RoNW (%)	TTM Y-o-Y chg (%) Revenue	TTM Y-o-Y chg (%) PAT
2,199	-14.6	2,783	26.5	33.7	25.6	31.8	39.6	42.9

- Garden Reach Shipbuilders & Engineers is a defence shipbuilding major with strong execution across complex naval platforms and a growing order pipeline. The stock was down 14.6 per cent over the past year but offers a healthy upside of 26.5 per cent
- In Q1, the firm surprised positively on both sales and profitability, likely due to faster execution for P17A and anti-submarine shallow water crafts, points out Elara Securities. Q2 results are scheduled for November 11
- The recent trigger for the stock was the order earlier this month for the construction of five Next Generation Corvettes (NGCs)' with the Indian Navy at a total value of ₹32,000 crore
- The management expects an order pipeline of ₹1.5 trillion in defence in the upcoming 12-18 months, led by large tenders of P17B (next generation stealth frigates) worth ₹70,000 crore, landing platform docks of ₹35,000 crore, mine countermeasure vessels of ₹32,000 crore and smaller tenders





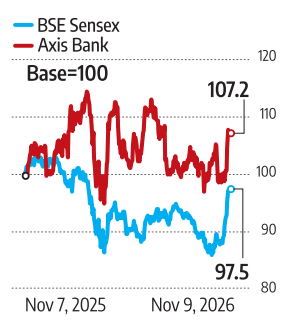
Axis Bank

(As on November 9)

Share price (₹)	1-year change (%)	Target Price (in ₹)	Upside (%)	P/BV (x) Current (TTM)	P/BV (x) Blended forward 12 mths	RoNW (%)	TTM Y-o-Y chg (%) Net interest income	TTM Y-o-Y chg (%) PAT
1,311	7.2	1,588	21.1	1.8	1.6	13.2	7.4	13.8

- Brokerages are bullish on Axis Bank as they expect the lender to outperform its peers in terms of loan and deposit growth
- The stock has 49 "buy" and 3 "sell" recommendations from brokerages. Axis Bank sits firmly in the upper tier of largecap bank stocks
- Brokerages expect the stock to deliver 20 per cent upside from current level compared to 7.4 per cent rise in the last 12 months
- The bank's adjusted net profit was up 37.6 per cent Y-o-Y while gross interest income was up 17.6 per cent Y-o-Y in Q2FY27
- According to Motilal Oswal Securities (MOSL), loan book was up 23 per cent Y-o-Y led by the corporate and SME segments
- The bank's deposits were up 21 per cent Y-o-Y aided by FCNR (B) deposits while low-cost Casa deposits' share was stable at 36 per cent according to MOSL





Share price and target price (rounded-off) related data as on Nov 9, 2026; chg: Change; P/E: price-to-earnings ratio; P/BV: price-to-book value; PAT: Profit after tax; RoNW: Return on net worth; Financial data is for trailing 12 months (TTM) ended Sep 2026, except for Genus Power Infrastructure and Garden Reach Shipbuilders for which TTM ended Jun 2026; Compiled by *Business Standard* Research Bureau

Sources: Bloomberg, Capitaline, Exchange

Lessons from a heist

Hackers are patient. India's financial ecosystem cannot afford to be



ILLUSTRATION: BINAY SINHA

SHIVANI SHINDE
Mumbai, 10 November

On October 29, the world's largest crypto exchange, Binance, reported a security hack. Roughly $6.3 billion was drained from the exchange platform, more than four times the previous record. In February 2025, Bybit reported a heist of $1.5 billion. These incidents point to the dangers of cyber-attacks from not only nation-state-backed actors but also from gaps in the increasing use of artificial intelligence.

In India, the Binance raid would have brought back memories of the WazirX security incident. The platform in July 2024 suffered a major cyberattack and lost about $235 million.

While cyberattacks on crypto exchanges have increased in recent times, the Binance hack stands out for several reasons. For one, it is the largest heist so far. Two, Binance is one of the largest players as the liquidity provider behind futures trading, especially in India. Three, users will now increasingly evaluate platforms based on their wherewithal to deal with such hacks.

However, there has been no panic among users, probably because of the swiftness with which Binance took responsibility and assured users that their investments will not be impacted.

Binance in a post on X was quick to say that it will absorb the financial impact of the stolen funds. "We have already set aside more than 100 per cent of the funds required to cover the loss. As of October 31, 2026, 98 per cent of the impacted token assets have been replenished and are verifiable on our Proof of Reserves page. We are in the process of purchasing the outstanding, more illiquid assets," said the company.

In a subsequent comment, it said: "We have taken immediate action to contain the incident and strengthen the systems involved. The entry points identified as having been used in the attack have been closed. Systems touched in the attack path have been rebuilt or replaced. We have also implemented tighter device controls, enhanced wallet-service risk controls and expanded AI-based behavioural anomaly detection."

Binance also said that investigations highlighted the fact that the attack was sophisticated, and part of a multi-stage campaign. It was not an isolated breach or a simple phishing incident. The attackers combined a range of techniques, including social engineering by carrying out fake recruitment interviews, malicious software downloads, compromised internal AI tooling, endpoint compromise, and an advanced transaction-authorisation method.

The human factor

With social engineering, too, playing a role, it again brings forth the role of humans in such attacks.

An investigation by the Federal Bureau of Investigation (FBI) pointed the Binance hack to North Korea's TraderTraitor, an alleged state-sponsored hacking collective.

This brings up the question as to how nation-state actors have succeeded in hacking systems in spite of strong key management. Jayant Dave, CISO, APAC, Check Point Software Technologies, a security expert who has seen at least seven major crypto thefts since 2024, said that the cryptography was not broken.

His findings were that five thefts/incidents began with a staff member's or supplier's device, token or session. Four ran through a supplier. In four, people approved the malicious transaction.

"State-linked groups are patient and well- funded, and they go where the defence is thinnest. Strong key management makes the vault hard to crack. So they target what is allowed to ask the vault to open: an engineer's laptop, a supplier's tool, an approval screen. The FBI attributes Binance to North Korea's TraderTraitor. US and Japanese authorities have warned for years about this group's lures aimed at engineers," he said in an email response to *Business Standard*.

Binance, in its post on the modus-operandi, said that social engineering was also part of the hack. The attackers used a fake job interview, an internal AI tool and a stolen deployment token to reach the internal wallet signing service, and started transactions outside the normal withdrawal process.

Saurabh Sharma, lead security researcher, Global Research and Analysis Team (GReAT), at Kaspersky agreed that in such cases attackers rarely break the keys. "They target the people and systems that are already trusted to use those keys. That is why these groups focus on engineers, developers and executives," he said.

In 2025, Kaspersky researchers detailed how BlueNoroff, a subgroup of Lazarus, a notorious cybercrime group linked to Pyongyang, used fake video calls and fake recruiters to compromise people working in the crypto industry. Even experienced specialists can be caught out, according to Kaspersky.

"Once inside a trusted device, attackers can work through the organisation's own approval processes. Technology alone cannot stop that if one compromised system is allowed to carry too much authority," he added.

State-linked groups are known for their patience: Kaspersky's analysis of Lazarus's Operation FlashHole found a campaign active since at least July 2025, with tools reworked over time.

"For investigators, it means the first compromised device is rarely the full story. Every access point has to be traced and closed before systems can be trusted again. Exact timelines, however, can only be confirmed once the investigation is complete," said Sharma.

Lessons for Indian players

Experts say Indian crypto-exchanges are already a target. Sharma said that The GhostCall and GhostHire campaigns that were uncovered by Kaspersky have targeted Web3 and cryptocurrency organisations in India since at least April 2025.

"The priority should be to make sure no single compromise can move funds. Developer and DevOps machines should be kept separate from systems that approve withdrawals, with independent checks for high-value transfers. This matters because valid accounts and trusted relationships remain leading entry points in the attacks our teams investigate," he said.

Major crypto thefts in recent years

$6.3 bn	Binance, 2026
$1.4 bn	Bybit, 2025
$235 mn	WazirX, 2024
$305 mn	DMM Bitcoin, 2024

Source: News reports and company announcements

This is not just an India issue — every market faces this challenge. "Rules and audits confirm the right controls exist. The attackers behind these thefts test whether those controls hold under pressure. They are patient, and they work through people, devices and suppliers. That calls for testing alongside compliance," Dave said.

According to him, India has built one of the more structured frameworks in the region, and keeps strengthening it.

He points to the 2022 directions by CERT-In (Indian Computer Emergency Response Team) that require incidents to be reported within six hours and logs to be kept for 180 days. "Crypto service providers must keep KYC (know your customer) and transaction records for five years. FIU-IND (Financial Intelligence Unit-India) registration brings exchanges into the anti-money laundering framework. Its 2026 guidelines add a cyber security audit by a CERT-In-empanelled auditor. Fast reporting and good logs are exactly what investigators need after an incident like this," he said.

Though security experts have set out what needs to be done, it is finally the players who have to get serious on security.

"At CoinSwitch, we follow a risk-based approach to managing wallet exposure and withdrawals, with a focus on minimising potential vulnerabilities. This includes limiting exposure to online wallets, implementing layered access controls, transaction monitoring and withdrawal safeguards," said Balaji Srihari, vice president - business, India, CoinSwitch.

"We also emphasise segregation of duties and restricted access to critical systems to reduce insider-related risks. These controls are periodically reviewed and tested through security assessments and audits, helping us strengthen our preparedness against evolving external threats as well as potential internal risks," he added.

Nischal Shetty, founder of WazirX said security cannot be treated as a one-time exercise or a box to be ticked. It needs to be an ongoing priority, embedded into the way businesses operate.

"Cybersecurity is not a crypto-specific challenge; it is a financial ecosystem-wide concern. Traditional banking, fintech and cryptocurrency are all exposed to an increasingly sophisticated threat landscape. However, the scrutiny on the crypto industry is understandably higher, given the direct involvement of funds and the greater difficulty of recovering stolen assets compared to traditional banking. This makes security an especially critical responsibility for the industry."

Shetty added that with the rapid advancement of AI, WazirX is also seeing an expanding vulnerability landscape, with new risks emerging across software libraries, operating systems, browsers and server infrastructures that underpin modern products.

"This makes it increasingly important for companies to look beyond preventive security measures and have a plan in place for worst-case scenarios," he said.

ASSAM POWER GENERATION CORPORATION LTD.

NOTICE INVITING TENDER

E-Tenders are invited from the intending contractors/firms/suppliers for execution of ***"Supply of 01 (one) no. of New Cartridge Assembly (Without Mechanical Seal, Without CAN) for KSB Limited make Condensate Extraction Pump (CEP) (Vertical Five Stage Centrifugal Pump, Pump Type: WKT 150/5) for Namrup Replacement Power Plant (NRPP), APGCL, Namrup, Assam"***. An amount of **Rs. 1,03,500.00 (Rupees One Lakh Three Thousand Five Hundred Only)** is to be submitted as EMD/Bid Security. The tender documents can be downloaded from www.assamtenders.gov.in w.e.f. **10:00 Hrs 11/11/2026.**

- Pre-bid Meeting shall be conducted in the Office of CGM (Gen), APGCL, 3rd Floor, Bijulee Bhawan, Paltan Bazar, Guwahati-1. **The date and time of the pre-bid meeting shall be 12:00 Hours of 19/11/2026.**
- Last date of submission of tender document is up to **12:00 Hours of 01/12/2026.**
- The Technical Bid will be opened online on e-procurement portal at **16:00 Hrs. of 04/12/2026.** (The date of opening of the price bid shall be intimated later on the Portal.)

The TIA reserves the right to accept or reject any bid/tender, and to cancel/annul the bidding process and reject all bids at any time prior to contract award.

Name of the TIA: Chief General Manager (Gen), APGCL
Address of the TIA: 3rd Floor Bijulee Bhawan, Paltanbazar, Guwahati-1

Sd/-
Chief General Manager (Gen)
APGCL, Bijulee Bhawan, Guwahati -1

FC/25-26/51

The Singareni Collieries Company Limited
(A Government Company)
Regd. Office: Kothagudem– 507101, Telangana.

E-PROCUREMENT TENDER NOTICE

The following tenders have been floated through the Telangana State e-Procurement Portal/Conventional. For further details, please visit **http://tender.telangana.gov.in/** and **https://scclmines.com/**

NIT/Enquiry No. - Description/Subject - Last date and time.

EST26O0113 – Procurement of Generator carbon brushes for 600MW generator rotor earth fault detection system and shaft earthing system at STPP, Jaipur, Mancherial, Telangana – **21.11.2026 – 12:01 PM.** **GM (E&M) PC&S, STPP**

E0426O0174 – Procurement of High Speed Diesel(HSD) on Rate Contract basis for a period of two years – **27.11.2026 – 05:00 PM.**

E0926O0162 – Procurement of Miner Safety Shoes Type 1 on Rate Contract basis for a period of two years – **27.11.2026 – 05:00 PM.**

E0326O0151 – Procurement of Ophthalmic Intraocular Lenses(IOLs) of specific makes on Rate Contract basis for a period of 2 years – **27.11.2026 – 05:00 PM.**

E0226O0165 – Procurement of Flight Bars for 500TPH Feeder Breakers working at various CHPs of SCCL on Rate Contract for a period of 2 years – **27.11.2026 – 05:00 PM.** **GM (MP)**

NIT/Enquiry No. - Description/Subject-Estimated Contract Value - Last date and time.

MMR/CVL/E-MM/T-28/2026-27 – Maintenance of Filter beds near KKOCP office and Maintenance of water supply lines at Mandamarri Area for the year 2026-2027 and 2027-2028 – Rs. 35,05,635/- – **20.11.2026 – 04:30 PM.** **GM MMR**

CRP/CVL/MMR/TN-29/2026-27, Dt.06.11.2026 – Maintenance of Ramakrishnapur Railway siding served by Mandamarri Railway Station on Kazipet-Balharshah section of SC Railways for a period of Two (02) years i.e., for 2026-27 & 2027-28 at Ramakrishnapur, Mandamarri Area, Mancherial Dist., T.G. – Rs. 81,55,703/- – **21.11.2026 – 04:30 PM**

CRP/CVL/RG-I/TN-30/2026-27, dt: 06.11.2026 – Re-organisation of water supply lines inlet and outlet connections from existing water supply lines for Rapid Gravity Filters (under construction) in RG-I Area, Godavarikhani, Peddapalli (Dist), Telangana State –Rs. 2,37,17,613/- – **23.11.2026 – 04:30 PM.** **GM (Civil)**

E-FORWARD AUCTION NOTICE

The following e-forward auction has been floated through TGTS e-auction portal. For more details, please visit **https://auction.telangana.gov.in**

Auction ID - Description of Subject - Date of Auction

32001 - Disposal of 3,00,000 MT Fly Ash from Pond, STPP - 24.11.2026 GM (E&M) Stores

PR/2026/ADVT/STPP/MP/MMR/CVL/CHS/109

DIPR R.O.No.752-PP/CL-AGENCY/ADVT/2026-27 Dt:10.11.2026

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SIGMA ADVANCED SYSTEMS LIMITED
(FORMERLY MEGASOFT LIMITED)
CIN: L24100TN1999PLC042730
Registered Office: No.43/1 (# 129 to # 140), Prestige Palladium, 8th Floor, Greams Road, Nungambakkam, Chennai, 600006, Tamil Nadu, India **Corporate Office:** Survey No 1/1, Plot No 24/A, Hardware Park, Srisailam Road, Kancha Imarat, Raviryala Village, Maheswaram Mandal, Hyderabad, 501510 Telangana, India
Email: investors@sigmaadvsys.com https://sigmaadvsys.com

POSTAL BALLOT NOTICE AND REMOTE E-VOTING INFORMATION

NOTICE is hereby given that pursuant to the provisions of Sections 110 and 108 of the Companies Act, 2013 (the 'Act') read with Rules 22 and 20 of the Companies (Management and Administration) Rules, 2014 and amendments thereto, Secretarial Standard-2 on General Meetings (the 'SS-2'), Regulation 44 of the Securities and Exchange Board of India (Listing Obligations and Disclosure Requirements) Regulations, 2015 (the 'SEBI Listing Regulations') including any statutory modification(s), clarification(s), substitution(s) or re-enactment(s) thereof for the time being in force, guidelines prescribed by the Ministry of Corporate Affairs (the 'MCA'), vide Circular No. 14/2020 dated April 8, 2020, Circular No. 20/2020 dated May 05, 2020, Circular No. 2/2022 dated May 05,2022, Circular No. 10/2022 and Circular No. 11/2022 dated December 28,2022, Circular No. 02/2021 dated January, 13, 2021 and General Circular No. 09/2023 dated September 25, 2023 and General Circular No. 09/2024 dated September 19, 2024 and No. 03/2025 dated September 22, 2025 read along with SEBI circular no. SEBI/HO/CFD/CFD-PoD-2/P/CIR/2024/133 dated 3rd October, 2024 and other connected circulars issued from time to time in this regard (the 'MCA Circulars') and any other applicable law, rules and regulations (including any statutory modification(s) or re-enactment(s) thereof, for the time being in force and as amended from time to time), the items as set out in this Notice are proposed for consideration by the Members of Sigma Advanced Systems Limited (the 'Company') and for approval by means of Postal Ballot by voting through electronic means ('remote e-voting') only.

Item	Description of the Resolution
1.	To consider and approve enhancement in overall Borrowing Limits of the Company.
2.	To consider and approve creation of security on assets of the Company.
3.	To consider and approve enhancement of limits for the purpose of Granting of Loan (s), making Investment(s) and Providing Guarantee(s)/ Security(ies) under section 186 of Companies Act, 2013.
4.	To approve the Appointment of Mr. Galla Jayadev (DIN:00143610), as an Independent Director (Non-Executive) of the Company for a Term of Five Consecutive years w.e.f November 06, 2026.
5.	To approve the Appointment of Ms. Urkavalan Jeya Santhi (DIN:11338879), as an Independent Women Director (Non-Executive) of the Company for a Term of Five Consecutive years w.e.f November 06, 2026.
6.	To approve the change in designation of Mr. Sunil Kumar Kalidindi (DIN: 02344343) from Whole-Time Director to Managing Director of the Company.
7.	To Consider and Approve the Proposal for Change in Designation of Mr. Kartheek Raju Chintalapati (DIN:02921819) from Non-Executive Director to Whole-Time Director (Executive, Promoter Category) of the Company for a term of five consecutive years w.e.f. November 06, 2026 and fix remuneration thereof.
8.	To consider & approve raising of funds by way of issuance of equity shares and/or any other eligible securities through a further public offer, preferential allotment, rights issue, private placement, qualified institutions placement, or any other permissible method or combination thereof, in accordance with the applicable laws.

In Compliance with the MCA circulars, the Company has completed the dispatch of Notice along with Explanatory Statement through an email on November 10th, 2026 to the members of the Company holding Equity Shares as on Friday, November 06th, 2026 ("Cut-Off Date"). Voting rights shall be reckoned on the paid-up value of Equity shares registered in the name of Members as on the Cut-Off date. A person who is not a member as on Cut-Off date to treat the Notice for information purpose only. Kindly note that in terms of the Applicable Laws, physical copy of the Postal Ballot Notice along with Postal Ballot form and pre-paid business reply envelope will not be sent to the Members. The Communication of the assent or dissent of the Members would take place through remote e-voting system only.

Members may note that Postal Ballot Notice is also available on the website of the Company at https://sigmaadvsys.com/investors-services/announcements/ and can also be accessed from the website of the stock exchanges i.e. BSE Limited at www.bseindia.com and National Stock Exchange of India Limited at www.nseindia.com. The Notice is also available on the website of CDSL at www.evotingindia.com.

As required under section 108 of the Companies Act, 2013 read with Rule 20 of the Companies (Management and Administration) Rules, 2014, as amended from time to time, the Company has engaged the services of Central Depository Services (India) Limited to provide e-voting facility to the shareholders of the Company. Members holding shares in dematerialized form as on the cut off date i.e. Friday, November 06th, 2026, may cast their votes electronically on the business as set forth in the Postal Ballot through the electronic voting systems of NSDL/CDSL (remote e-voting). Members are hereby informed that:

a) The business set forth in the Postal Ballot Notice may be transacted through remote e-voting systems.
b) The remote e-voting shall commence on Wednesday, November 11th, 2026 (at 9.00 AM IST) and ends on Thursday, December 10th, 2026 (at 5.00 PM IST). Members may note that once the votes are cast on a resolution, the members shall not be allowed to change it subsequently.
c) The cut-off date for determining the eligibility to vote by remote e-voting shall be Friday, November 06th, 2026.
d) Remote e-voting module will be disabled after 5.00 PM IST on Thursday, December 10th, 2026.
e) In case of queries, Members may refer to the Frequently Asked Questions (FAQs) for Members and e-voting user manual for Members at the Downloads Section www.evotingindia.com or write an email to helpdesk.evoting@cdslindia.com. Members may also write to the Company at investors@sigmaadvsys.com E-mail ID or at the Corporate office address of the Company at Hyderabad i.e., Survey No 1/1 Plot No 24/A Hardware Park Srisailam Road Kancha Imarat, Raviryala Village Maheswaram Mandal, Hyderabad, Telangana, India, 501510.
f) The Board of Directors of the Company has appointed Mr. M. Damodaran, Managing Partner of M. Damodaran & Associates LLP, Practicing Company Secretaries, to act as Scrutinizer to scrutinize the e-voting process in a fair and transparent manner. The results declared along with the Scrutinizer's report shall be communicated to the stock exchanges and will also be displayed on the Company at https://sigmaadvsys.com within 2 working days of conclusion of e-voting period.

For Sigma Advanced Systems Limited
(Formerly Megasoft Limited)

Sd/-
Krishna Chaitanya Sadhu
Company Secretary & Compliance Officer

Date: November 10, 2026
Place: Hyderabad

WEBFIL LIMITED

Regd. Office: "YULE HOUSE", 8, Dr. Rajendra Prasad Sarani, Kolkata – 700001, Phone: 033 2242 8210/8550/1988, 2248 4671, 2243 1555; FAX: +91 33 2242 1335
E-mail: webfil@webfilindia.com; Website: www.webfilindia.com
CIN: L36900WB1979SGC032046

Extract of the Statement of Unaudited Standalone Financial Results for the Quarter and Half Year ended 30th September, 2026 (Rs. In Lakhs)

Particulars	Quarter ended 30.09.2026 (Unaudited)	Quarter ended 30.06.2026 (Unaudited)	Half Year ended 30.09.2025 (Unaudited)	Half Year ended 30.09.2026 (Unaudited)	Year ended 31.03.2026 (Audited)
Total Income from Operations(net)	1,378.79	941.98	2,232.04	2,320.77	5,079.95
Net Profit/(Loss) for the period (beforeTax, Exceptional and/or Extraordinary items)	101.26	47.46	135.24	148.72	383.37
Net Profit/(Loss) for the period before tax (after Exceptional and/or Extraordinary items)	101.26	47.46	135.24	148.72	383.37
Net Profit /(Loss) for the period after tax (after Exceptional and/or Extraordinary items)	70.71	38.32	102.86	109.03	272.59
Total Comprehensive Income for the period [Comprising Profit / (Loss) for the period (after tax) and Other Comprehensive Income (after tax)]	72.30	38.32	102.86	110.62	275.77
Paid-up Equity Share Capital (Face value Rs. 10/- per Equity Share)	853.25	853.25	853.25	853.25	853.25
Reserves(excluding Revaluation Reserve) As shown in the Audited Balance Sheet	–	–	–	–	1,215.08
Earnings Per Share (Face value Rs. 10/- per Equity Share)					
1. Basic (Rs.):	0.83	0.45	1.21	1.28	3.19
2. Diluted (Rs.):	0.83	0.45	1.21	1.28	3.19

Extract of the Statement of Unaudited Consolidated Financial Results for the Quarter and Half Year ended 30th September, 2026 (Rs. In Lakhs)

Particulars	Quarter ended 30.09.2026 (Unaudited)	Quarter ended 30.06.2026 (Unaudited)	Half Year ended 30.09.2025 (Unaudited)	Half Year ended 30.09.2026 (Unaudited)	Year ended 31.03.2026 (Audited)
Total Income from Operations(net)	1,378.79	941.98	2,232.04	2,320.77	5,079.95
Net Profit/(Loss) for the period (before Tax, Exceptional and/or Extraordinary items)	101.26	47.46	135.24	148.72	383.37
Net Profit/(Loss) for the period before tax (after Exceptional and/or Extraordinary items)	101.26	47.46	135.24	148.72	383.37
Net Profit /(Loss) for the period after tax (including share of Profit of Associates/ Joint Ventures*)	260.92	181.93	487.51	442.85	980.07
Total Comprehensive Income for the period [Comprising Profit / (Loss) for the period (after tax) and Other Comprehensive Income(after tax)]	262.51	181.93	487.51	444.44	983.25
Paid-up Equity Share Capital (Face value Rs. 10/- per Equity Share)	853.25	853.25	853.25	853.25	853.25
Reserves(excluding Revaluation Reserve) As shown in the Audited Balance Sheet	–	–	–	–	5,376.79
Earnings Per Share (Face value Rs. 10/- per Equity Share)					
1. Basic (Rs.):	3.06	2.13	5.71	5.19	11.49
2. Diluted (Rs.):	3.06	2.13	5.71	5.19	11.49

Notes:

a) The above extract of standalone and consolidated financial results of the detailed format of Unaudited Financial Results for the Quarter ended 30th September, 2026 filed with the Stock Exchanges under Regulation 33 of the SEBI (Listing and Other Disclosure Requirements) Regulations, 2015 as amended. The full format of the Unaudited Financial Results for the Quarter ended 30th September, 2026 are available on the Company's website (www.webfilindia.com) and on the website of The Calcutta Stock Exchange Ltd. (www.cse-india.com).

b) The above results have been reviewed by the Audit Committee and approved by the Board of Directors of the Company at their meetings held on 10th November, 2026.

c) The figures of the corresponding previous period/year have been regrouped wherever considered necessary, to make them comparable.

(*)The proportionate share of Associates/Joint Ventures in the net profits/losses has been recognised without elemination of profit in the Consolidated Financial Results. However, strict compliance as per Ind AS 28 and Ind As 12 could not be considered due to practical difficulties in identifying the transaction-wise cost which mandate the group's share of profit to be eleminated and the carrying value of the investment is adjusted by a like amount (referred as 'equity method') based on the un-audited Financial Statement of the Joint venture as available. The ascertainment of the amount of impact is presently not practible and necessary action may be taken at the year end.

For and on behalf of
WEBFIL LIMITED
SEKHAR BHATTACHARJEE
DIRECTOR (DIN: 05125932)

Place: Kolkata
Date: 10.11.2026

Businesses were dissatisfied with UPA 2: Sonia in memoir

Cong leader says they backed BJP because of perceived 'policy paralysis'

ARCHIS MOHAN
New Delhi, 10 November

In her long-awaited autobiography, '*Belonging: A Journey of Love,*' which hit the stands on Tuesday, former Congress president Sonia Gandhi has given her assessment on India's economic growth.

In her memoirs, published by HarperCollins India, Gandhi, who is currently a member of the Rajya Sabha, says India's first prime minister Jawaharlal Nehru pursued the mixed economy model. It was done to create an industrial base that post-colonial India desperately needed.

She adds that her husband Rajiv Gandhi was committed to economic reforms, which his successors PV Narasimha Rao and Manmohan Singh took up, and that this context also saw the establishment of the National Advisory Council (NAC).

Gandhi also shared her perspective on the reasons for the decline of the United Progressive Alliance (UPA) government.

According to Gandhi, towards the end of the UPA government, it faced "a problem of anti-incumbency."

"The business world was also dissatisfied with what was termed our 'policy paralysis', seen as a delay in pushing through further economic reforms. They threw their weight behind the Bharatiya Janata Party (BJP)," she says. "The mainstream media is largely owned by corporate houses, and their management consistently gave the advantage to our opponents in shaping public opinion," Gandhi says.

She added that "the UPA's achievements were overshadowed by the BJP's successful use of both the mainstream and social media to propagate charges of corruption in our government."

Gandhi's reasons for setting up the NAC stem from her experiences during her campaign trail across the country for the 2004 Lok Sabha polls.



Former Prime Minister Manmohan Singh, along with then Congress chief Sonia Gandhi, speaking to the media after staking their claim to form the government, in New Delhi on May 19, 2004 FILE PHOTO: REUTERS

Gandhi writes that she met scores of people whose lives had become more difficult with prices of essential commodities increasing, "while the few poverty alleviation programmes the government was supposed to provide them had as always been seized by others more powerful in the village."

"I could sense their deep disappointment that the benefits claimed by the BJP had not brought a change for the better in their daily struggles." Referring to the BJP's 2004 LS campaign slogan, she writes, "No, there was no "India Shining" for them."

Once the UPA government was formed, she writes, "It was a fine balance our government had to maintain, between promoting economic prosperity and social justice." According to Gandhi, Nehru's government took on the enormous task of repairing the ravages of colonialism. It fostered industrial growth in a poor agrarian society through a mixed economy of private and public enterprises, with an emphasis on the public sector.

The Congress leader says Nehru's policies rapidly created a much-needed industrial base for India across sectors and also set up institutions, such as the Indian Institutes of Technology, Indian Space Research Organisation and Indian Institutes of Management. These became the foundation for India's information technology revolution.

"However, as over the decades, the economy evolved and diversified, state controls became a drag on growth," she writes. "Recognising this, Rajiv took the first steps towards liberalisation. PV Narasimha Rao's Congress government, with Dr Manmohan Singh as his finance minister, paved the way for the next stage of rapid growth. Our UPA continued with the reforms, putting India on the map as one of the world's fastest-growing economies."

Gandhi says that "while the UPA was of course in favour of economic reforms, my primary duty as Congress president, as I saw it, was to make sure that the promises made in our manifesto concerning poverty alleviation were implemented." The NAC, set up in June 2004, was tasked with suggesting social policies and drafting legislations concerning the Congress' manifesto guarantees, such as the Right to Information, Right to Work, Right to Food, Right to Education and the rights of forest-dwelling communities.

While the NAC was continuously reviled, "and yet I feel it was the combination of both factors — economic growth and social justice — that gave our party a second term in the general election of 2009," Gandhi says in her 526-page autobiography.

She credits Singh's "wise leadership' in India weathering the global economic crisis of 2008, and his "prudent management" halving the country's fiscal deficit.

The UPA's policies stimulated the economy and also provided a safety net for the poor, created new jobs and increased investment at home, which lifted 270 million people out of poverty and economic growth was higher than ever before, Gandhi says. She adds, "all the while maintaining an open society committed to respecting fundamental human rights and the rule of law."

Gandhi says the developments over the decades took place against the backdrop of a fierce contest between two visions of India, one represented by Mahatma Gandhi and the other by Vinayak Damodar Savarkar, the Rashtriya Swayamsevak Sangh (RSS), and its numerous affiliates, including the BJP, or the Sangh Parivar.

She says the Hindutva ideology, espoused by these forces, "favours the centralisation of power and wealth."

"During these past four decades, they have come to win the financial and political support of large business houses who share their economic agenda," she says.

More on business-standard.com

FIRST YAMUNA CRUISE SERVICE IN NATIONAL CAPITAL



Union Minister of Ports, Shipping and Waterways Sarbananda Sonowal *(left)* and Delhi Chief Minister Rekha Gupta flag off Delhi's first Yamuna cruise service at Sonia Vihar, on Tuesday. The cruise named Namo Yamuna River Safari will operate between Sonia Vihar and Jagatpur, covering a stretch of 4-5 kilometres. Each ride, carrying up to 30 passengers, will take approximately 40 minutes. PTI
PHOTO:@CMODELHI/X

EC extends model code restrictions to retired officials

PRESS TRUST OF INDIA
New Delhi, 10 November

The Election Commission (EC) on Tuesday said restrictions and prohibitions applicable to serving government employees under the Model Code of Conduct (MCC) will also apply to retired government officials and other individuals engaged by state and Union territory governments.

In a letter to the chief secretaries and chief electoral officers of Goa, Manipur, Punjab, Uttar Pradesh and Uttarakhand, all five of which will go to polls early next year, the Election Commission said such individuals must maintain political neutrality and refrain from participating in election campaigns or canvassing.

The provisions of the MCC apply to all organisations, committees, corporations/commissions, funded wholly or partially by the government, and their employees. The relevant Conduct Rules, in the states, prohibit government servants from taking part in political activities and elections, the letter said.

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Corp. Office: No: 148, Acropolis, Dr.Radhakrishnan Salai, Mylapore, Chennai - 600004. Tel: 044 47886700
Website: www.starhealth.in Email: investors@starhealth.in
CIN: L66010TN2005PLC056649 IRDAI Registration No. 129

UNAUDITED FINANCIAL RESULTS FOR THE HALF-YEAR ENDED SEPTEMBER 30, 2026

REVENUE ACCOUNT FOR THE HALF-YEAR ENDED SEPTEMBER 30, 2026

(Rs. in Lakhs)

Sl No	Particulars	For the Half-Year Ended September 30, 2026	For the Half-Year Ended September 30, 2025
		Miscellaneous	Miscellaneous
1	Premium earned (Net)	9,27,898	8,01,909
2	Profit / (Loss) on Sale / Redemption of Investments	-	66
3	Interest, Dividend & Rent - (Gross)	44,783	35,784
4	Other		
	(a) Other Income	-	-
	(i) Foreign Exchange gain / (loss)	(11)	57
	(b) Contribution from Shareholders' Account		
	(i) Towards excess Expense of Management	-	-
	(ii) Towards remuneration of MD/CEO/WTD/Other KMPs	881	274
	TOTAL (A)	**9,73,551**	**8,38,090**
5	Claims Incurred (Net)	6,38,819	5,65,666
6	Commission	1,29,538	1,19,872
7	Operating Expenses related to Insurance Business	1,35,900	1,29,609
8	Premium Deficiency	-	-
	TOTAL (B)	**9,04,257**	**8,15,147**
9	**Operating Profit / (Loss) C = (A - B)**	**69,294**	**22,943**
10	**APPROPRIATIONS**		
	Transfer to Shareholders' Account	69,294	22,943
	Transfer to Catastrophe Reserve	-	-
	Transfer to Other Reserves (to be specified)	-	-
	TOTAL (C)	**69,294**	**22,943**

PROFIT AND LOSS ACCOUNT FOR THE HALF-YEAR ENDED SEPTEMBER 30, 2026

(Rs. in Lakhs)

Sl No	Particulars	For the Half-Year Ended September 30, 2026	For the Half-Year Ended September 30, 2025
1	OPERATING PROFIT / (LOSS) -- Miscellaneous Insurance	69,294	22,943
2	INCOME FROM INVESTMENTS		
	(a) Interest, Dividend & Rent - (Gross)	22,491	20,771
	(b) Profit on Sale of Investments	-	43
	(c) Loss on Sale of Investments	-	-
	(d) Amortization of Premium / Discount on Investments	3,084	2,492
3	OTHER INCOME		
	(a) Provision written back	15	42
	(b) Interest on Income Tax Refund	-	-
	(c) Others	990	24
	TOTAL (A)	**95,874**	**46,315**
4	PROVISIONS (Other than Taxation)		
	(a) For diminution in the value of investments	-	-
	(b) For doubtful debts	90	-
	(c) Others (to be specified)	-	-
5	OTHER EXPENSES		
	(a) Expenses other than those related to Insurance Business	-	-
	(b) Bad debts written off	49	-
	(c) Interest on subordinated debt	2,050	2,073
	(d) Expenses towards CSR activities	960	606
	(e) Penalties	3	339
	(f) Contribution to Policyholders' A/c	-	-
	(i) Towards Excess Expenses of Management	-	-
	(ii) Towards remuneration of MD/CEO/WTD/Other KMPs	881	274
	(iii) Others	-	-
	(g) Others	58	52
	TOTAL (B)	**4,091**	**3,345**
6	**Profit / (Loss) Before Tax (A - B)**	**91,783**	**43,970**
7	Provision for Taxation		
	(a) Current Tax	23,946	13,220
	(b) Deferred Tax	(414)	(2,295)
	(c) Tax relating to earlier years	88	303
8	**Profit / (Loss) After Tax**	**68,163**	**31,743**
9	**APPROPRIATIONS**		
	(a) Interim Dividends paid during the year	-	-
	(b) Final Dividend Paid	-	-
	(c) Transfer to any Reserves or Other Accounts	-	-
	Balance of Profit / (Loss) brought forward from last year	**91,625**	**35,926**
	Balance carried forward to Balance Sheet	**1,59,787**	**67,668**

This Public Disclosure is made in accordance with the IRDAI Circular No: IRDAI/F&A/CIR/MISC/256/09/2021 dated 30th September 2021 on Public Disclosure by Insurers

The above financial information were reviewed by the Audit Committee and approved by the Board of Directors in their meeting held on October 27, 2026 and the Joint Statutory Auditors of the Company have reviewed the same.

IRDAI Registration No. 129 Dated 16th March, 2006

SHAI/2026-27/PRINT/001. Insurance is the subject matter of solicitation. For more details on risk factors, terms and conditions please read the sales brochure carefully before concluding a sale. IRDAI clarifies to public that IRDAI or its officials do not involve in activities like sale of any kind of insurance or financial products nor invest premiums. IRDAI does not announce any bonus. Public receiving such phone calls are requested to lodge a police complaint along with details of phone call, number.

BALANCE SHEET AS AT SEPTEMBER 30, 2026

(Rs. in Lakhs)

Particulars		As At Sep 30, 2026	As At Sep 30, 2025
SOURCES OF FUNDS			
Share Capital		58,862	58,795
Share Application Money Pending Allotment		-	-
Reserves and Surplus		7,68,625	6,75,540
Fair Value Change Account			
- SHAREHOLDERS' FUNDS		6,346	10,192
- POLICYHOLDERS' FUNDS		11,113	15,679
Borrowings		7,000	47,000
TOTAL		**8,51,946**	**8,07,206**
APPLICATION OF FUNDS			
Investments - Shareholders		7,79,614	7,35,622
Investments - Policyholders		13,65,135	11,31,605
Loans		-	-
Fixed Assets		19,183	19,006
DEFERRED TAX ASSET (NET)		36,020	37,415
	(1)	**21,99,952**	**19,23,648**
Current Assets			
-- Cash and Bank Balances		95,942	24,932
-- Advances and Other Assets		2,55,996	1,78,379
Sub-Total (A)		**3,51,938**	**2,03,311**
Current Liabilities		7,01,559	4,43,676
Provisions		9,98,385	8,76,077
Sub-Total (B)		**16,99,944**	**13,19,753**
NET CURRENT ASSETS = (A - B)	**(2)**	**(13,48,006)**	**(11,16,442)**
MISCELLANEOUS EXPENDITURE (to the extent not written-off or adjusted)	**(3)**	-	-
DEBIT BALANCE IN PROFIT & LOSS Account	**(4)**	-	-
TOTAL (1 + 2 + 3 + 4)		**8,51,946**	**8,07,206**

KEY ANALYTICAL RATIOS

Sl No	Particulars	RATIO / PERCENTAGE For the Half-Year Ended September 30, 2026	For the Half-Year Ended September 30, 2025
1	Gross Direct Premium Growth Rate	19.31%	2.57%
2	Gross Direct Premium to Networth ratio	1.16	1.09
3	Growth rate of Networth	9.04%	4.56%
4	Net Retention Ratio	95.40%	95.96%
5	Net Commission Ratio	14.20%	15.59%
6	Expense of Management to Gross Direct Premium Ratio	29.08%	32.68%
7	Expenses of Management to Net Written Premium Ratio	29.00%	32.40%
8	Net Incurred Claims to Net Earned Premium	68.85%	70.54%
9	Claims Paid to Claims Provisions	71.85%	78.01%
10	Combined Ratio	97.85%	102.94%
11	Investment Income Ratio	3.28%	3.23%
12	Technical Reserves to Net Written Premium ratio	132.22%	133.58%
13	Underwriting balance ratio	2.55%	(1.65%)
14	Operating Profit Ratio	7.47%	2.86%
15	Liquid Assets to liabilities ratio	55.42%	58.41%
16	Net earning ratio	7.47%	4.13%
17	Return on net worth ratio	8.24%	4.32%
18	Available Solvency Margin to Required Solvency Margin Ratio	2.05	2.15
19	NPA Ratio :		
	Policyholders' Fund		
	Gross NPA Ratio	NA	NA
	Net NPA Ratio	NA	NA
	Shareholders' Fund		
	Gross NPA Ratio	NA	NA
	Net NPA Ratio	NA	NA
20	Debt Equity Ratio	0.01	0.06
21	Debt Service Coverage Ratio	2.23	21.73
22	Interest Service Coverage Ratio	45.76	21.73
23	Equity Holding Pattern		
	No. of Shares (nos.)	58,86,23,619	58,79,49,881
	Percentage of Shareholding		
	Indian	83.59%	86.03%
	Foreign	16.41%	13.97%
24	Earnings per share	Basic: ₹ 11.58 Diluted: ₹ 11.56	Basic: ₹ 5.40 Diluted: ₹ 5.38
25	Book value per share	140.58	124.88

For & on behalf of the Board
Sd/-
Anand Roy
Managing Director & Chief Executive Officer
DIN: 08602245

Place: Chennai
Date: October 27, 2026